Full Score

Anson Yeung

Lost in time

for piano quintet
(2025)

MOVEMENTS

I. The relentless flow of time
II. Distant memories
III. Time is a matrix

INSTRUMENTATION

two violins, viola, cello and piano

DURATION

ca. 15 minutes

PERFORMANCE NOTES

ord.	*ordinario,* return to the normal bow position
col legno battuto	Strike the strings with the wood of the bow
+	Pizzicato with left hand
p.s.p.	*poco sul ponticello*, position the bow near the bridge, producing a slightly glassy timbre without being as extreme as *motlo sul ponticello*
m.s.p.	*molto sul ponticello*, position the bow very close to the bridge, emphasizing higher overtones for a harsh, metallic sound.
p.s.t	*poco sul tasto*, position the bow slightly over the fingerboard

An arrow placed between two techniques indicates a gradual change from one playing method to another, rather than a sudden switch.

For piano, octave markings apply only to the staff on which they are written, as is standard practice. This remains true even in cases of cross-staff notation or beaming.

PROGRAM NOTES

"Why do we need literature and art? They reveal a reality behind appearances, closer to the essence of life—where, beyond deep rational insight, an intuitive revelation of beauty occurs" - Lung Ying-tai

On the surface, time appears as a continuous flow from past to present to future. Yet beneath this rational logic lies a more subjective dimension of time, one shaped by memory, emotion and perception which differs from person to person. This three-movement work explore the various ways time is experienced and felt.

<u>I. The relentless flow of time</u>

Often it feels like time is unstoppable, like a river rushing towards an unseen horizon. Though time flows continuously, its pace can vary subjectively, sometimes rushing and sometimes slowing. This is reflected by the (3+3+4)/16 time signature of the piece, where each beat feels familiar yet subtly shifted.

Harmonics are used extensively in this movement, producing a delicate, shimmering sound. When combined with the piano's high register, they evoke a dreamy, almost otherworldly atmosphere.

II. Distant memories

Sometimes, distant memories suddenly surface in our minds, whether bittersweet, joyful, or tinged with sadness, and it is easy to lose track of how much time has passed since these moments. In this movement, I aim to capture that sensation, where distant memories surface vividly then slips away quitely.

Unlike the first movement, more traditional textures and harmonies are used. A lyrical, bittersweet melody is presented initially by piano solo, but it never resolves to the tonic chord, leaving a sense of incompleteness, as if the memory itself remains just out of reach. Unexpected modulations and exotic modes later in the movement further deepens the feeling.

III. Time is a matrix

This movement is highly geometrical, built from precise, interlocking patterns. Rapidly shifting time signatures create a sense of constant motion, while canon-like textures, inspired by minimalism, layer multiple lines that echo and overlap each other. Accents and beats phase in and out of alignment, producing a shift of rhythmic perspective.

Moreover, polyrhythms are used in the latter half of the piece, producing sound that feel simultaneously ordered and unpredictable. The complex and intricate structure invites the listener to experience time not as a steady flow, but as a dynamic, multi-dimensional matrix.

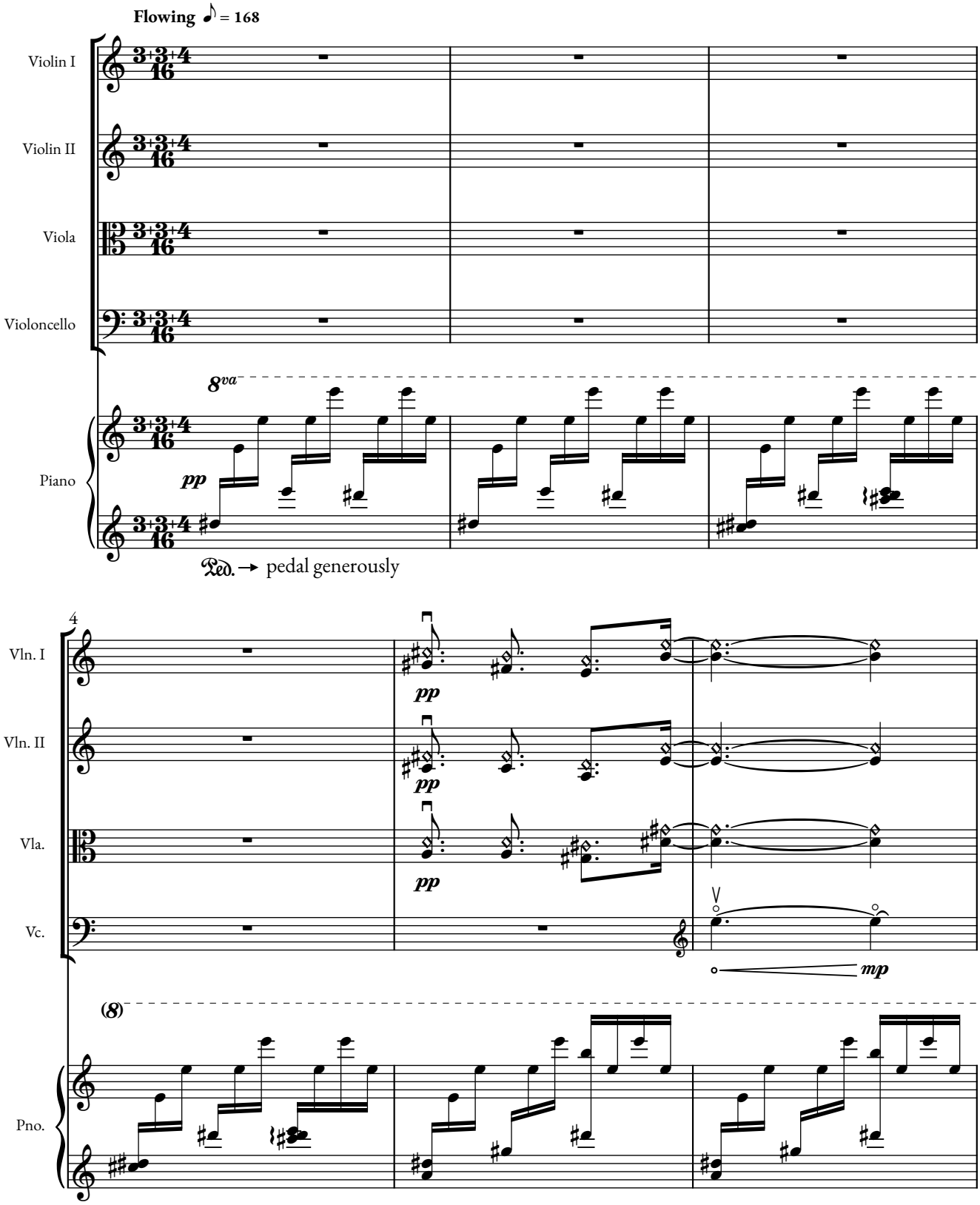
Anson Yeung

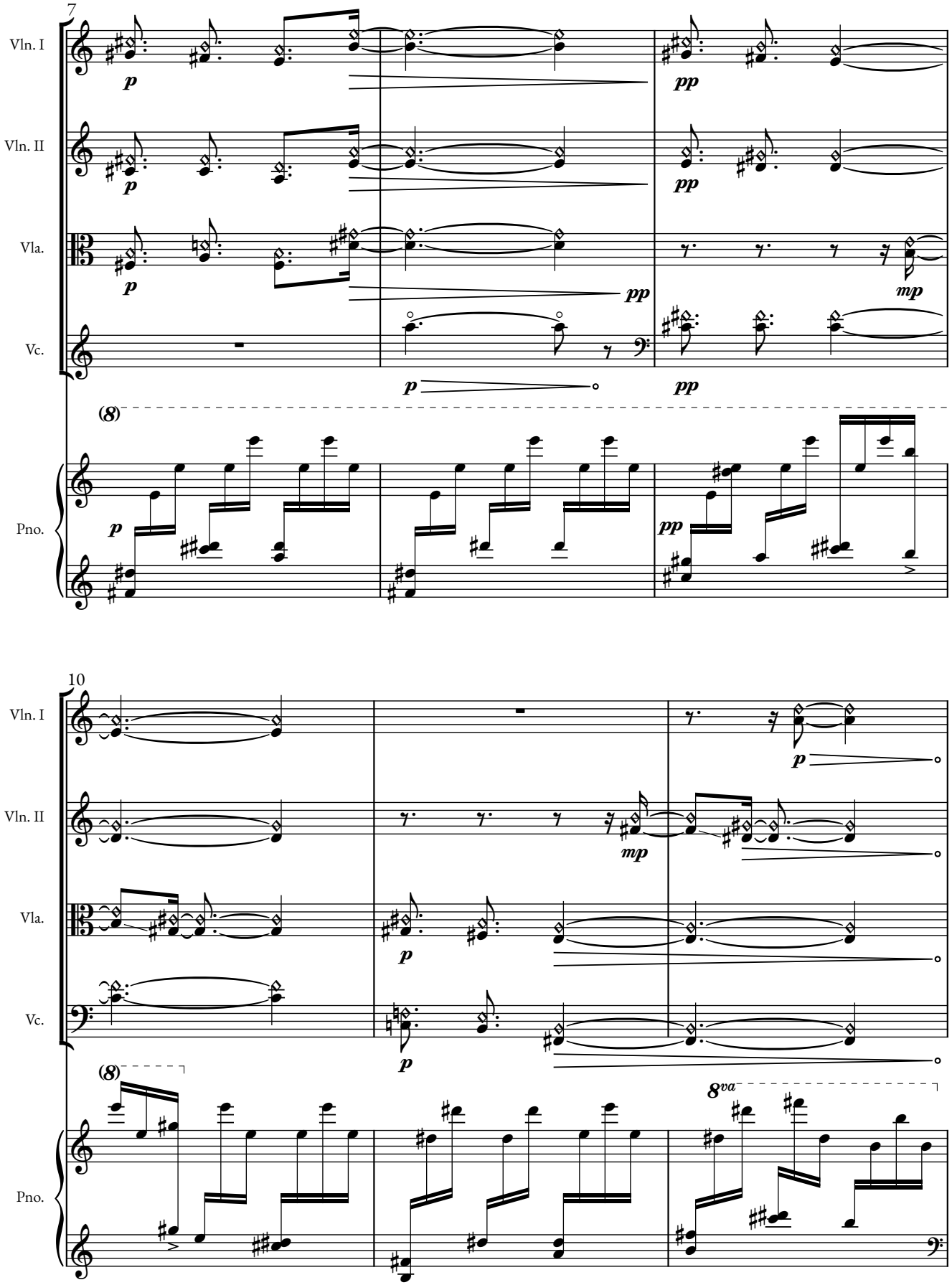
LOST IN TIME

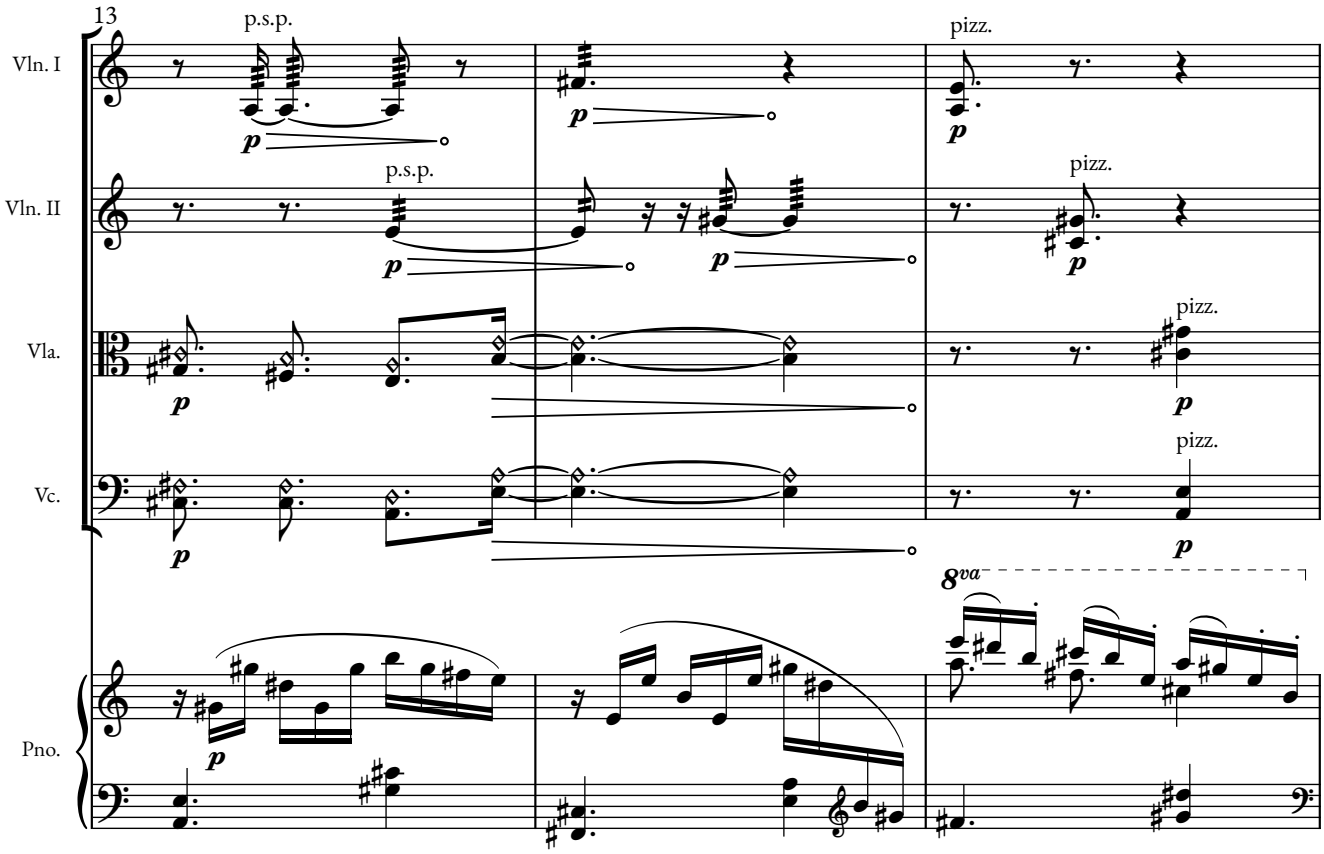
for piano quintet

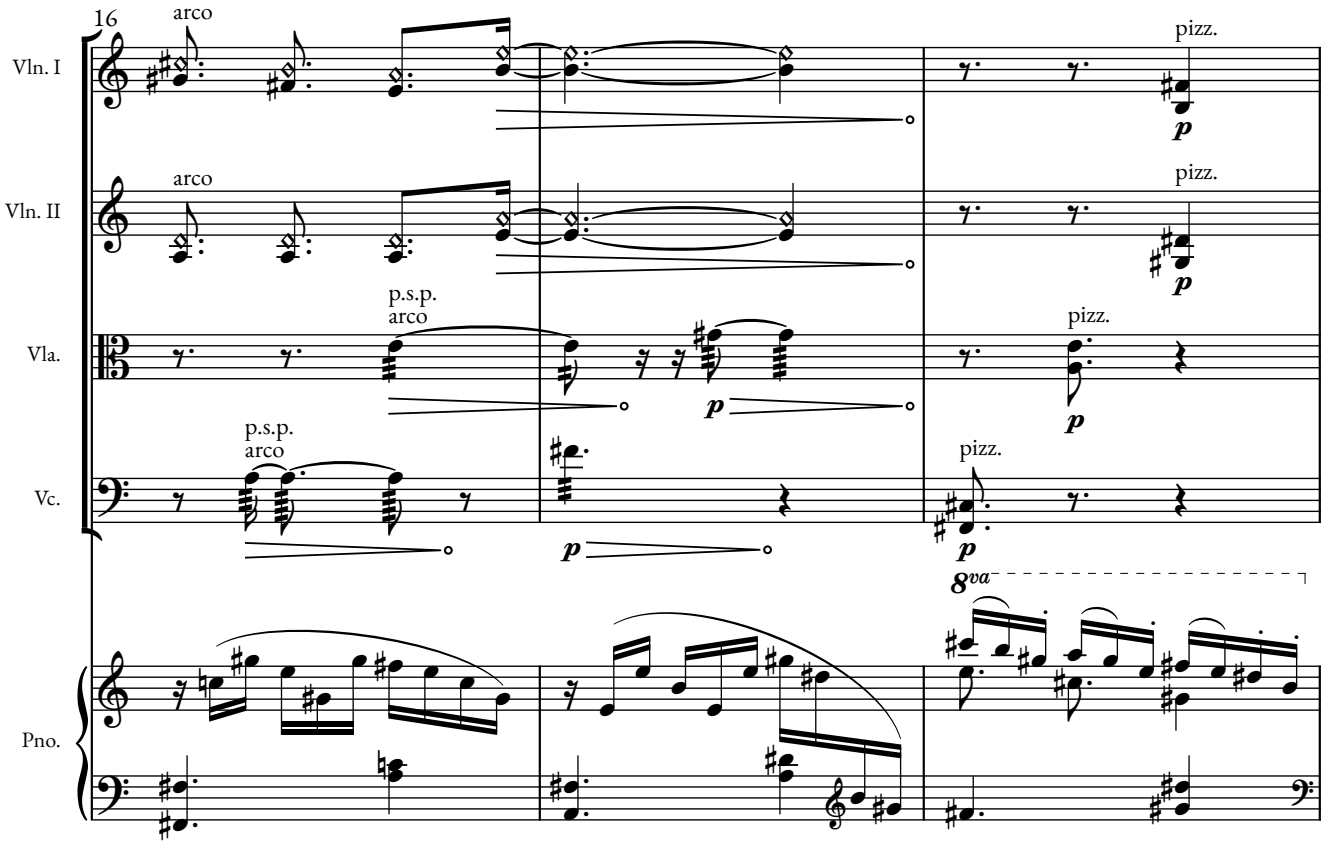
A. Yeung
(2025)

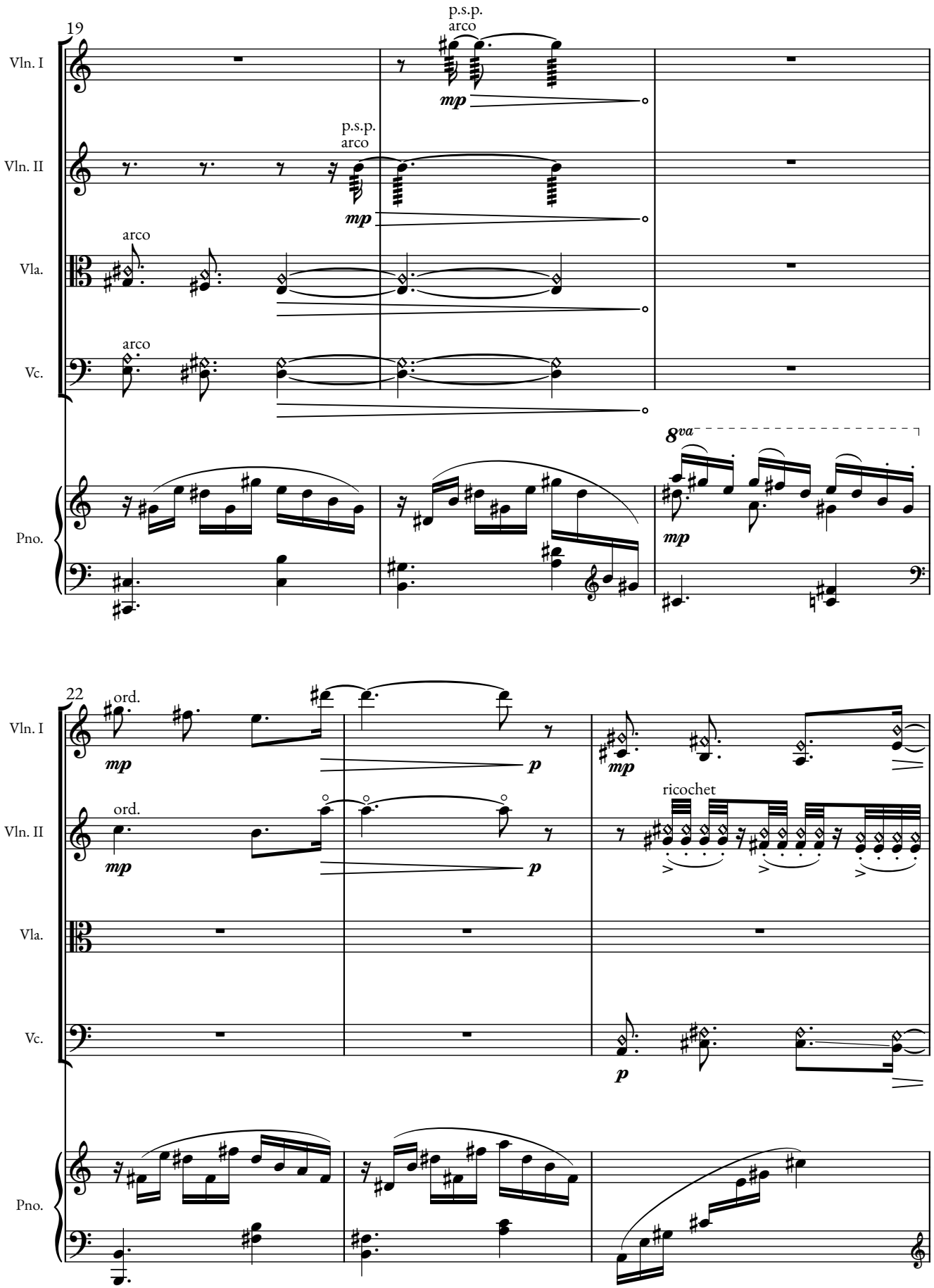
I. The relentless flow of time

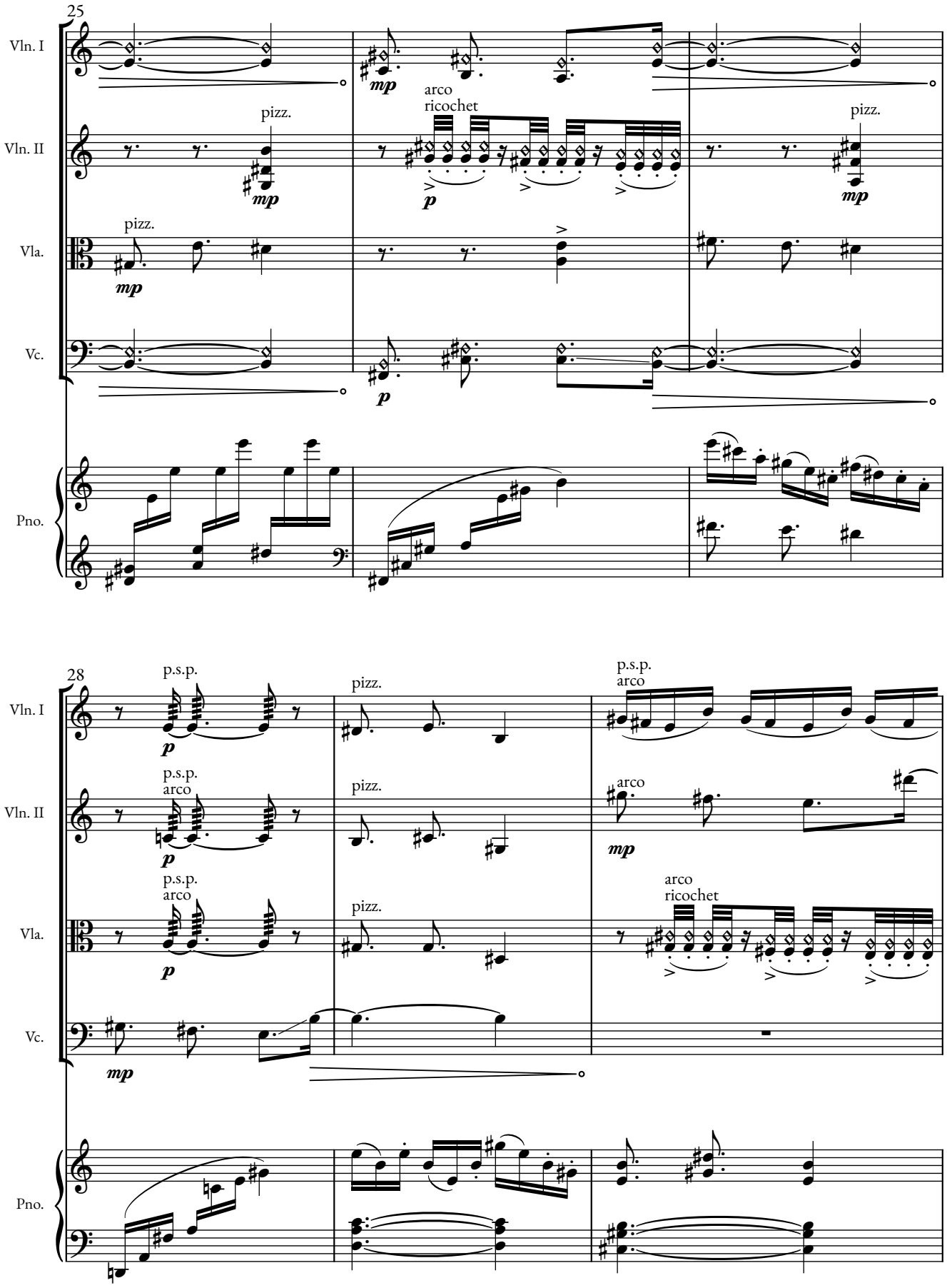


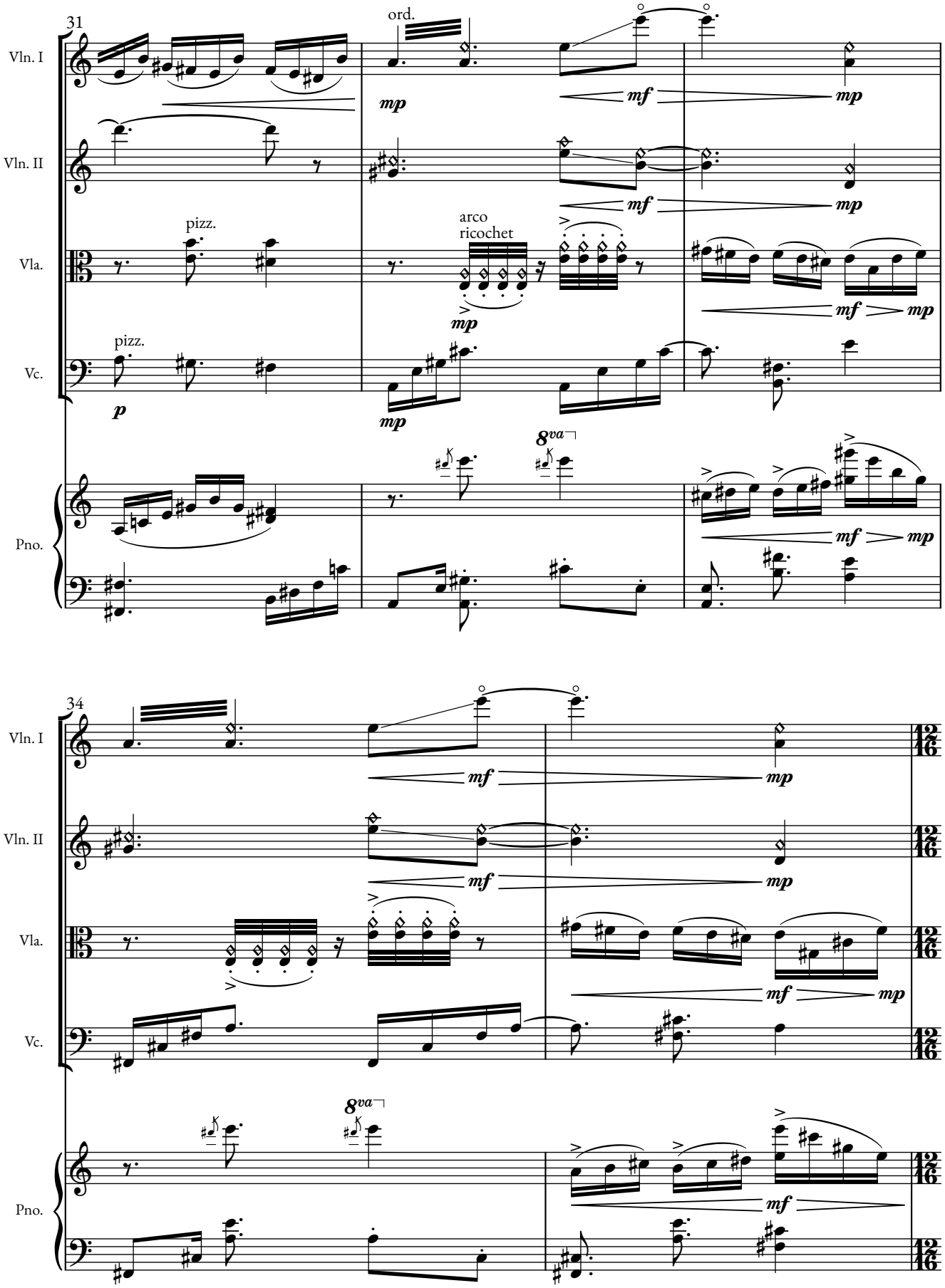

7
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p
pp
mp
(8)
10
8va

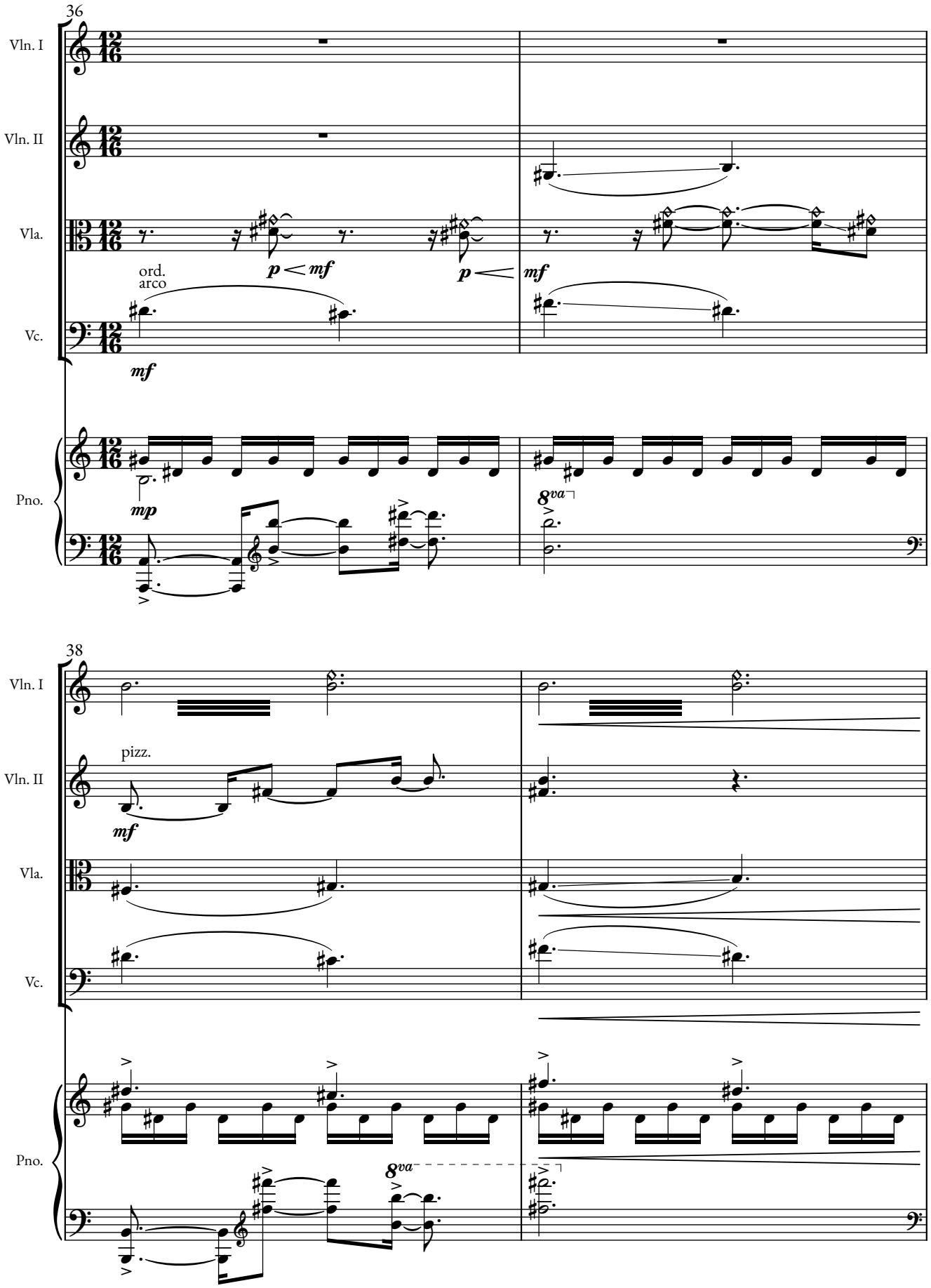

13
Vln. I
p.s.p.
pizz.
Vln. II
p.s.p.
pizz.
Vla.
pizz.
Vc.
pizz.
8va
Pno.

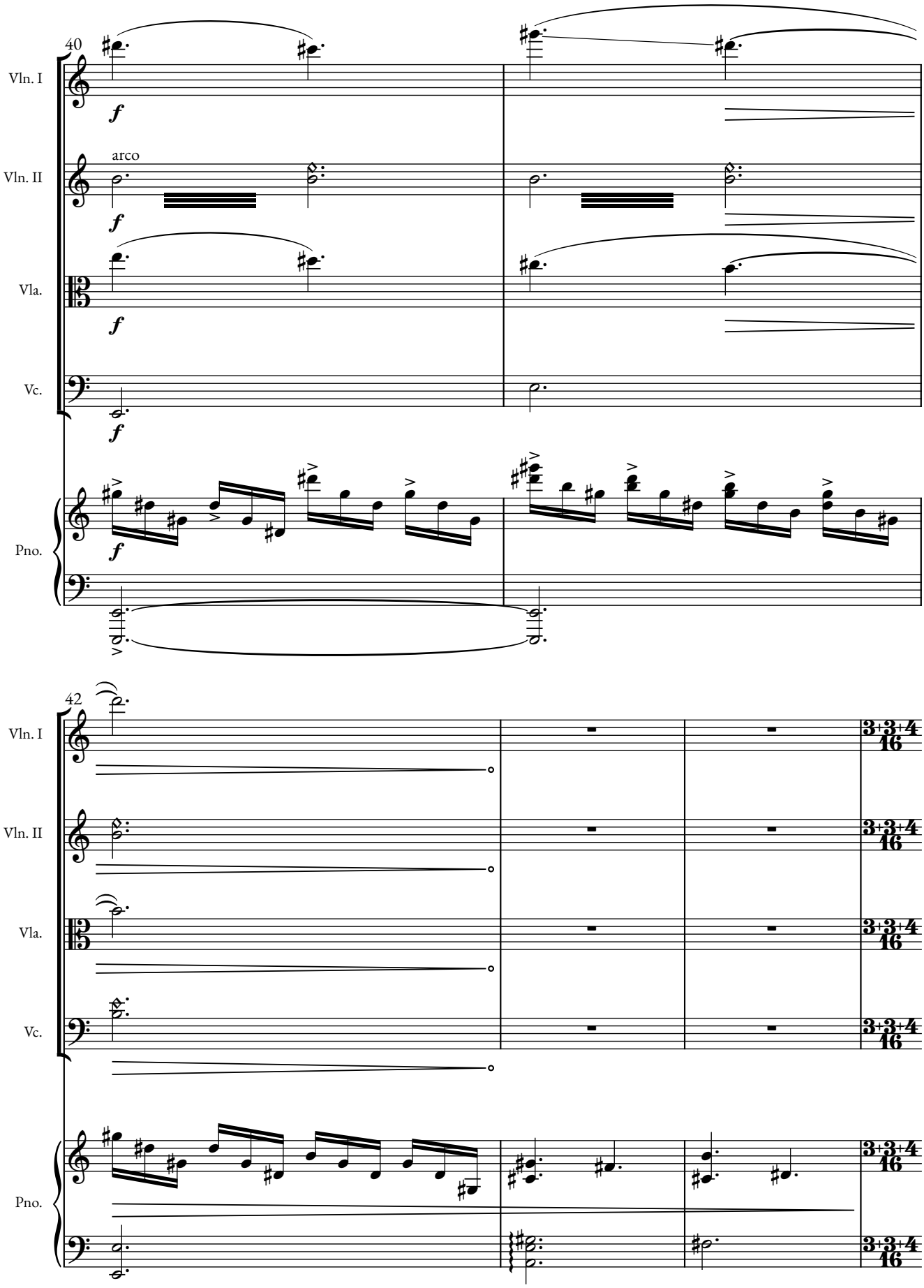

16
Vln. I
arco
pizz.
Vln. II
arco
pizz.
Vla.
p.s.p.
arco
pizz.
Vc.
p.s.p.
arco
pizz.
8va
Pno.

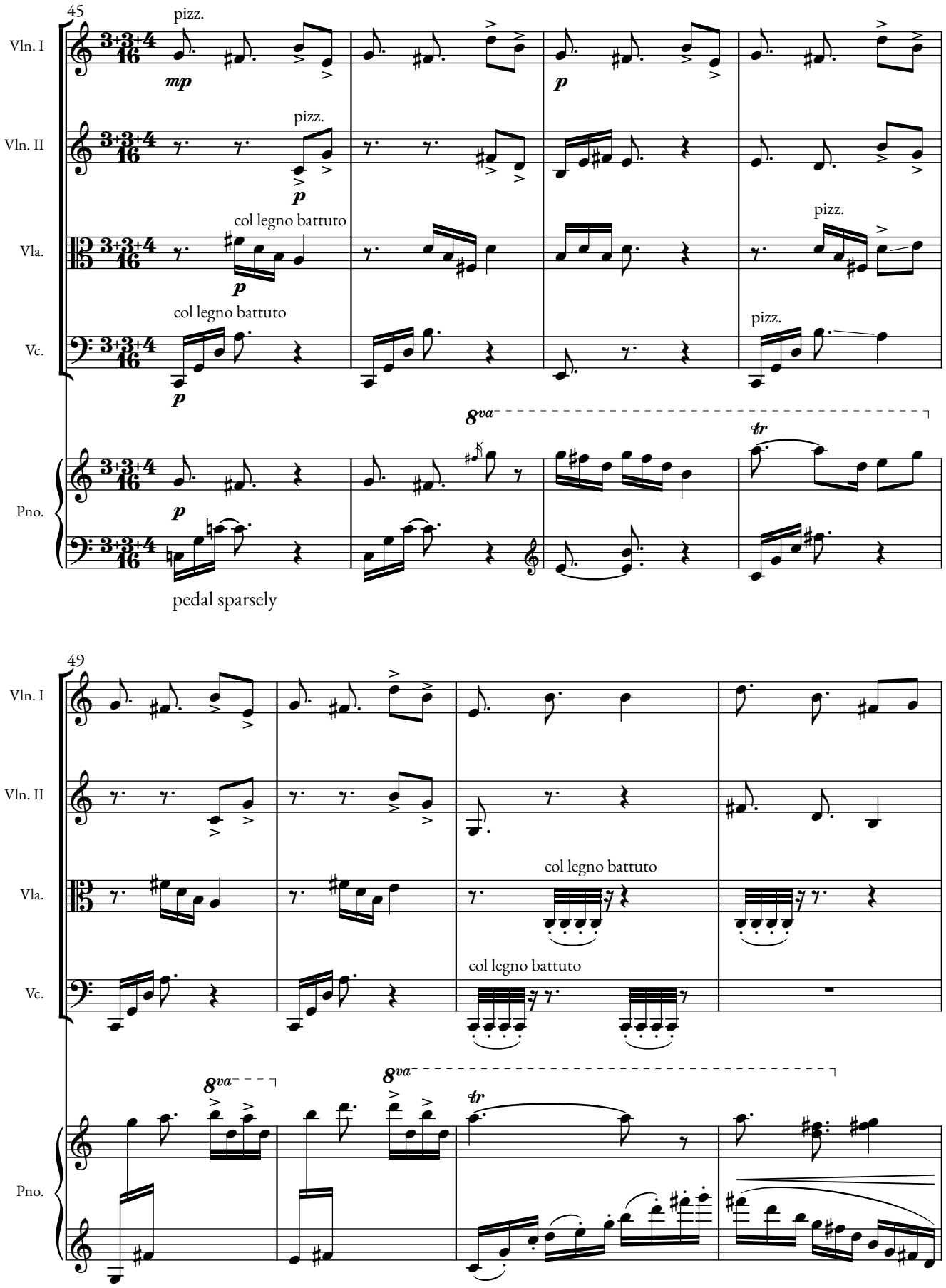

19
Vln. I
p.s.p.
arco
mp
Vln. II
p.s.p.
arco
mp
Vla.
arco
Vc.
arco
Pno.
8va
mp
22
Vln. I
ord.
mp
p
mp
Vln. II
ord.
mp
p
ricochet
Vla.
Vc.
p
Pno.

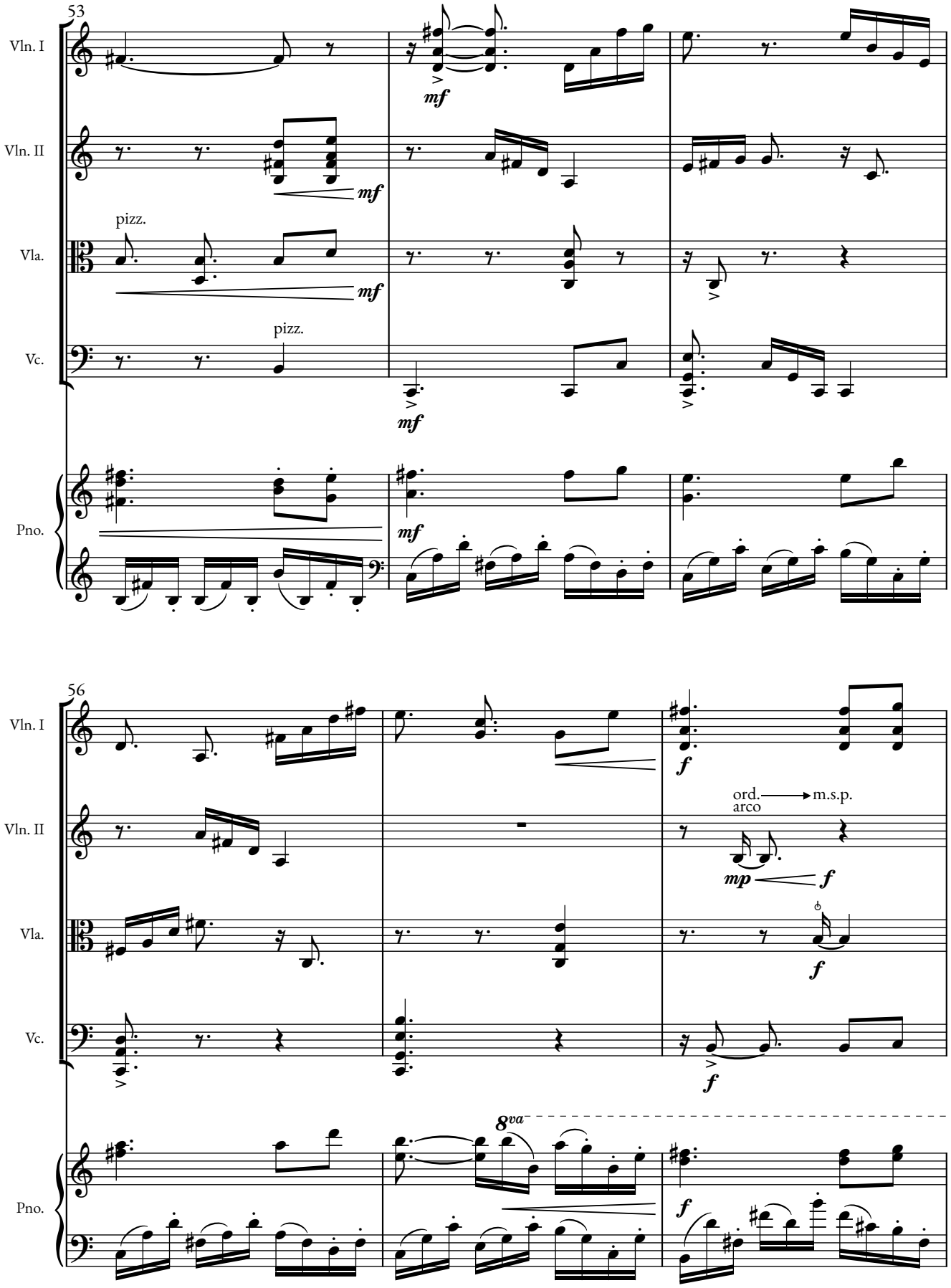

25
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
pizz.
arco
ricochet
mp
p
28
p.s.p.
arco

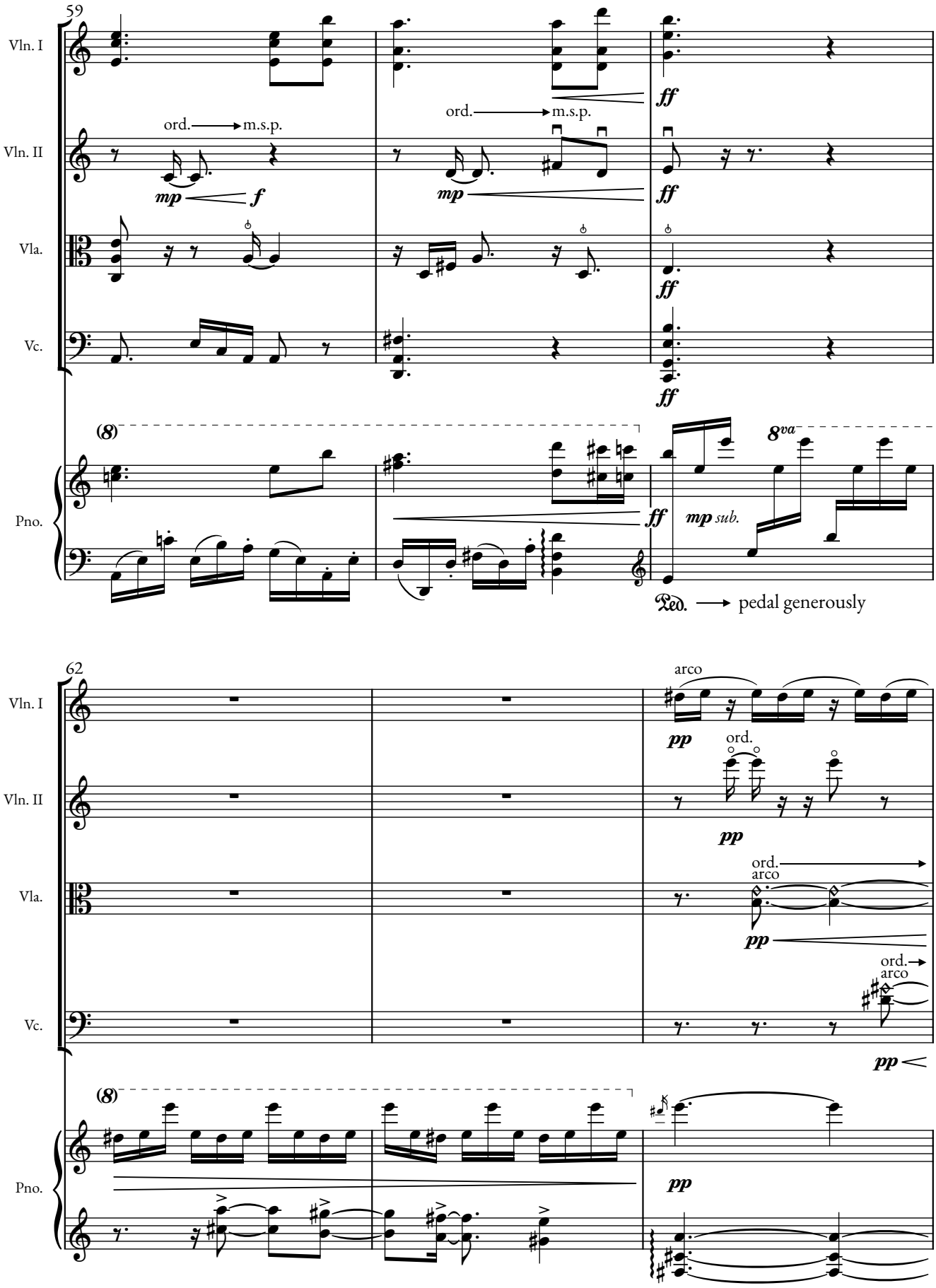

31
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
pizz.
arco
ricochet
pizz.
mp
mf
mp
mf
mp
mp
mf
mp
p
mp
8va
mf
mp
34
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mf
mp
mf
mp
mf
mp
8va
mf

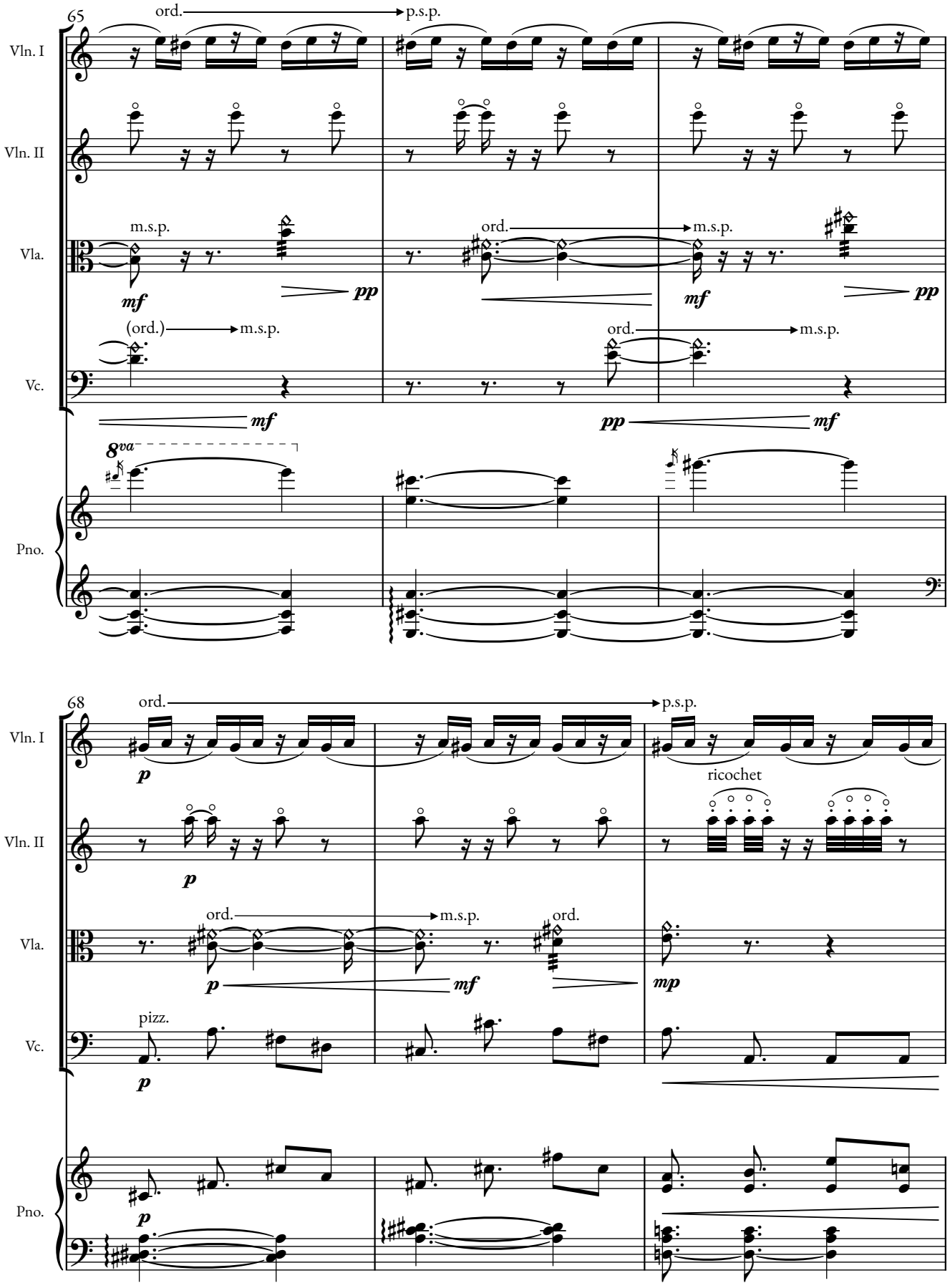

36
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
arco
p
mf
mp
8va
38
pizz.

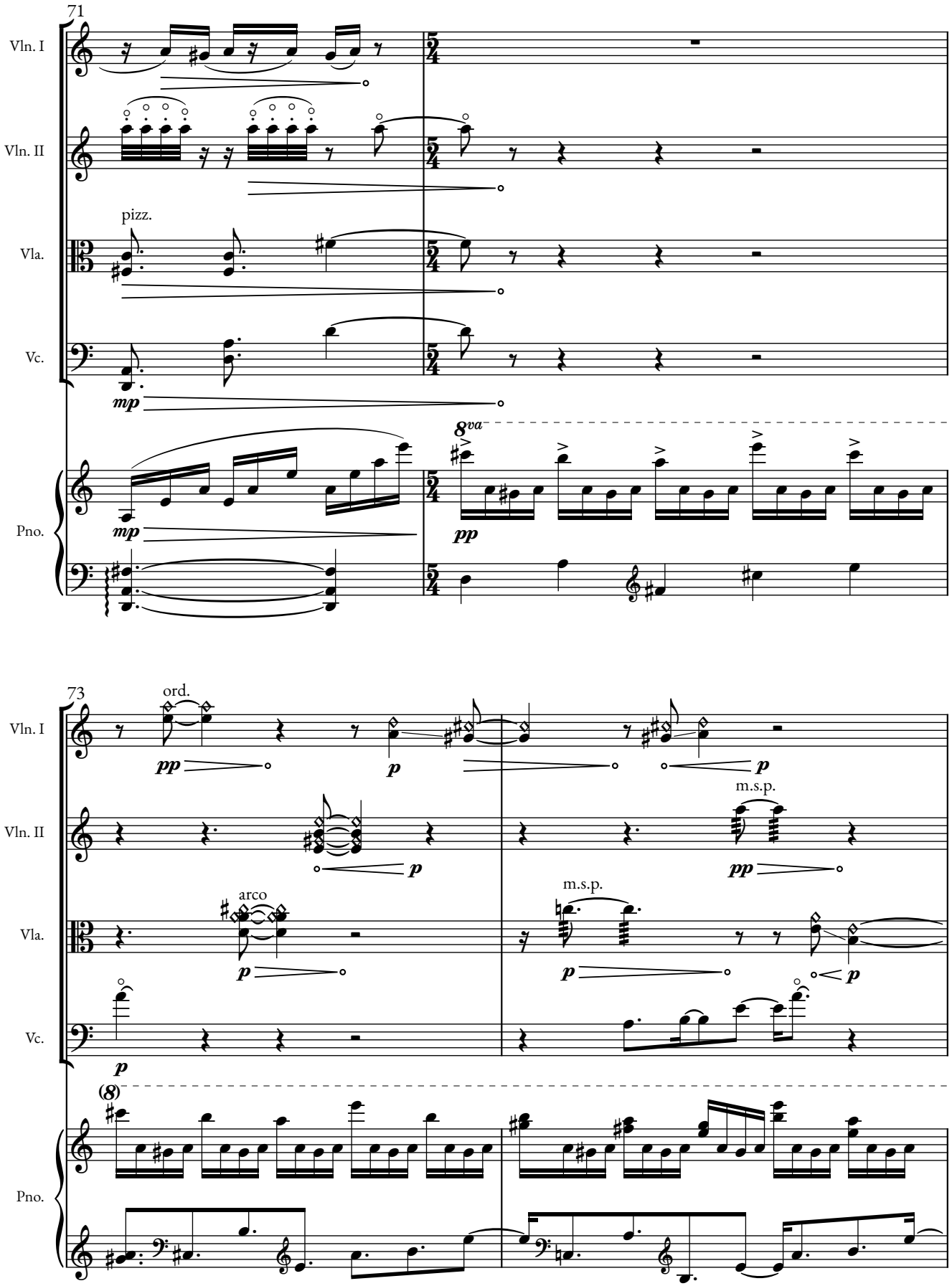

40
Vln. I
Vln. II
arco
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
42
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.

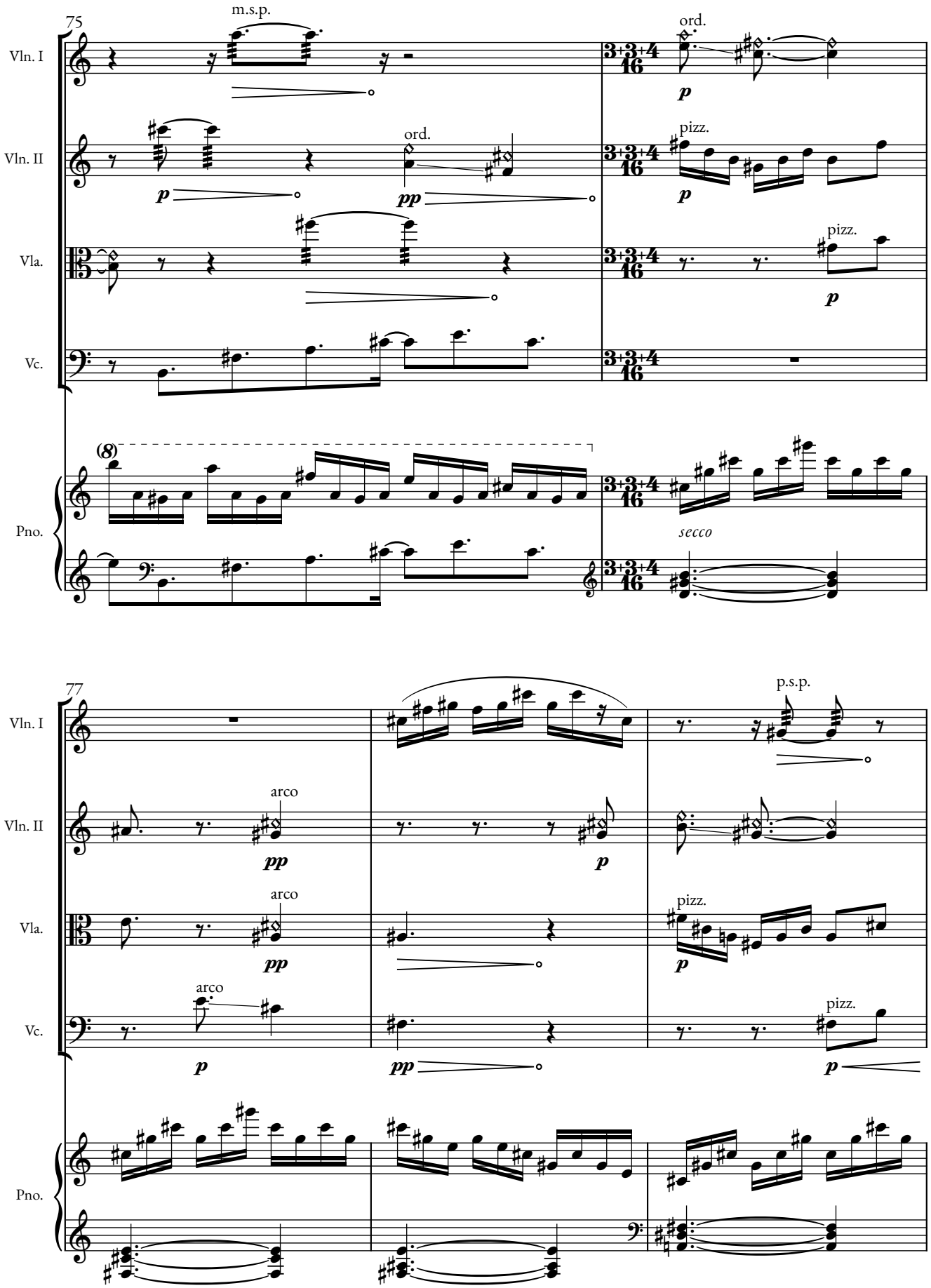

45
Vln. I
pizz.
mp
p
Vln. II
pizz.
p
Vla.
col legno battuto
p
pizz.
Vc.
col legno battuto
p
pizz.
Pno.
8va
tr
p
pedal sparsely
49
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
col legno battuto
Vc.
col legno battuto
Pno.
8va
8va
tr

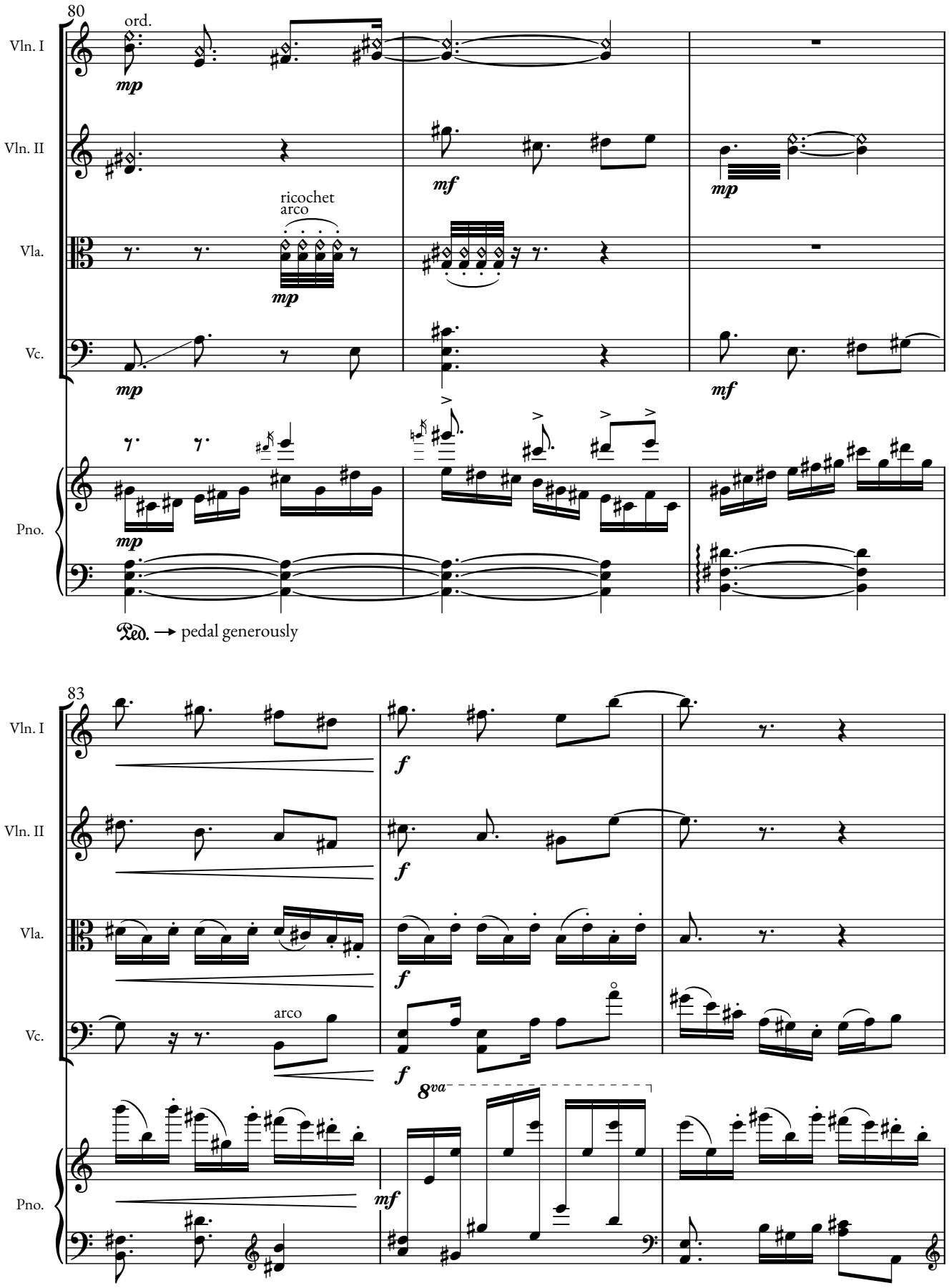

53
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
pizz.
pizz.
mf
56
ord.
arco
m.s.p.
mp
f
8va

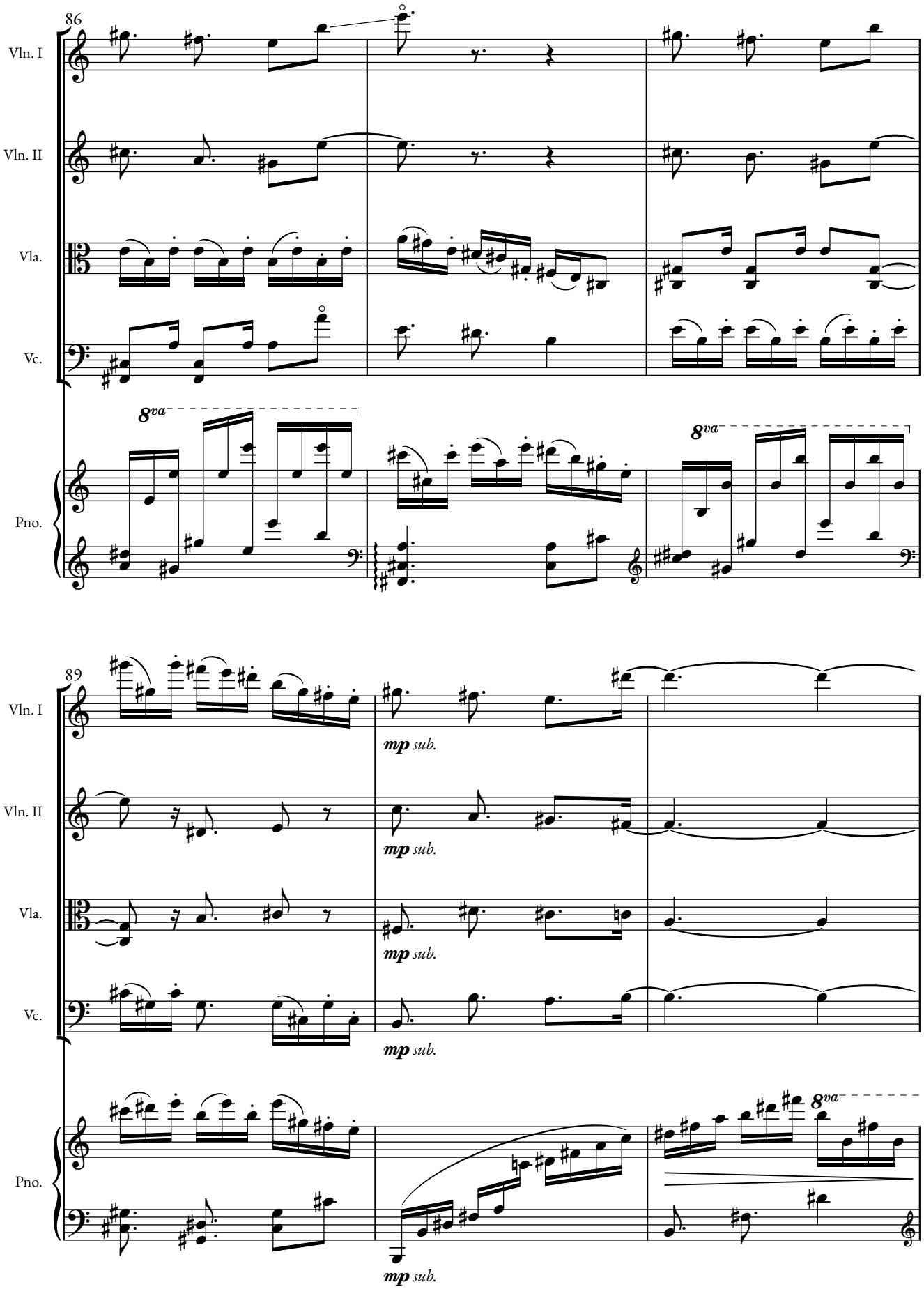

59
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
m.s.p.
mp
f
ff
(8)
8va
mp sub.
Ped.
pedal generously
62
arco
pp
ord.
arco

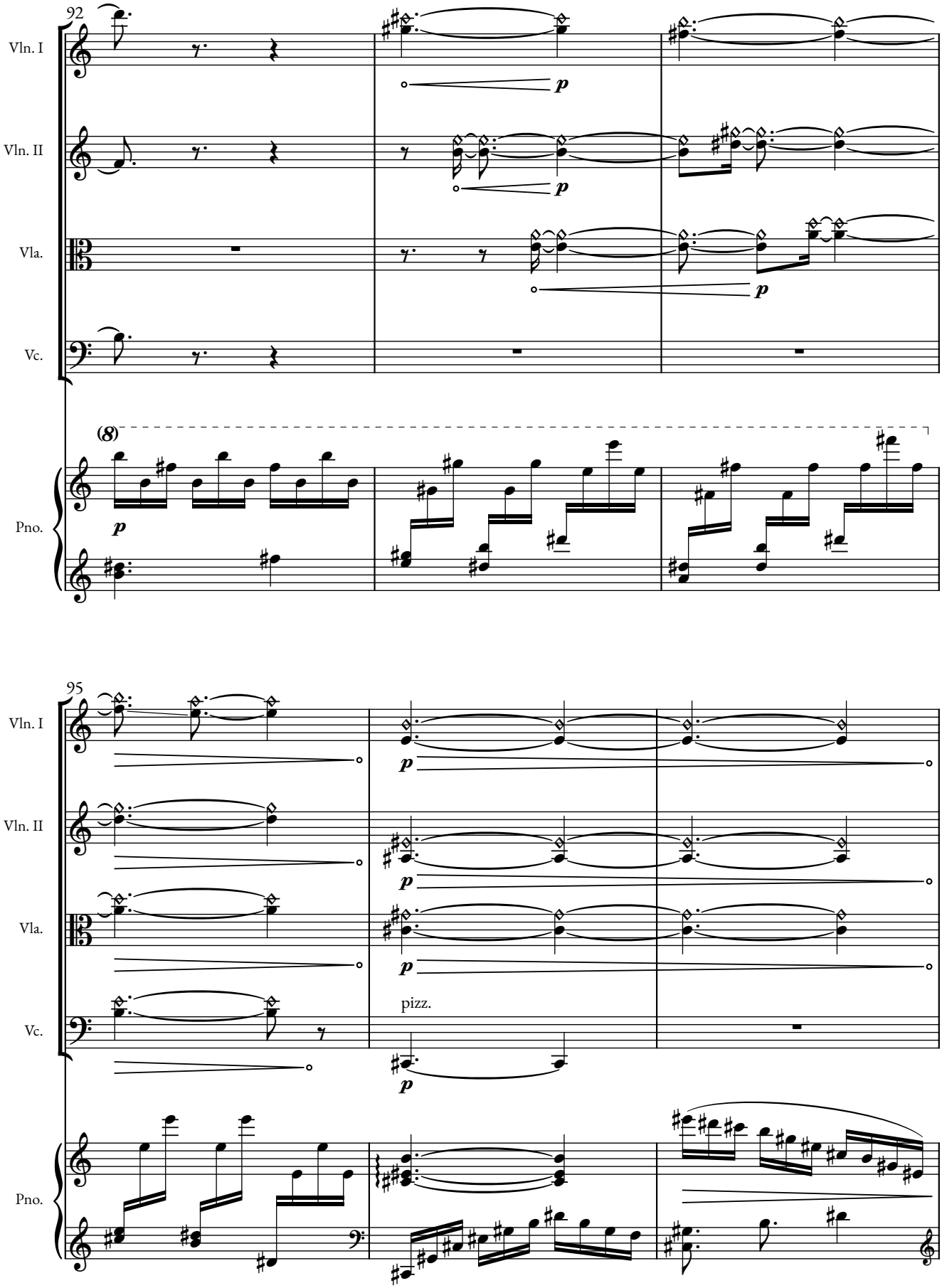

65
Vln. I
ord.
p.s.p.
Vln. II
Vla.
m.s.p.
mf
pp
ord.
m.s.p.
mf
pp
Vc.
(ord.)
m.s.p.
mf
ord.
m.s.p.
pp
mf
Pno.
8va
68
Vln. I
ord.
p.s.p.
p
ricochet
Vln. II
p
Vla.
ord.
m.s.p.
ord.
p
mf
mp
Vc.
pizz.
p
Pno.
p

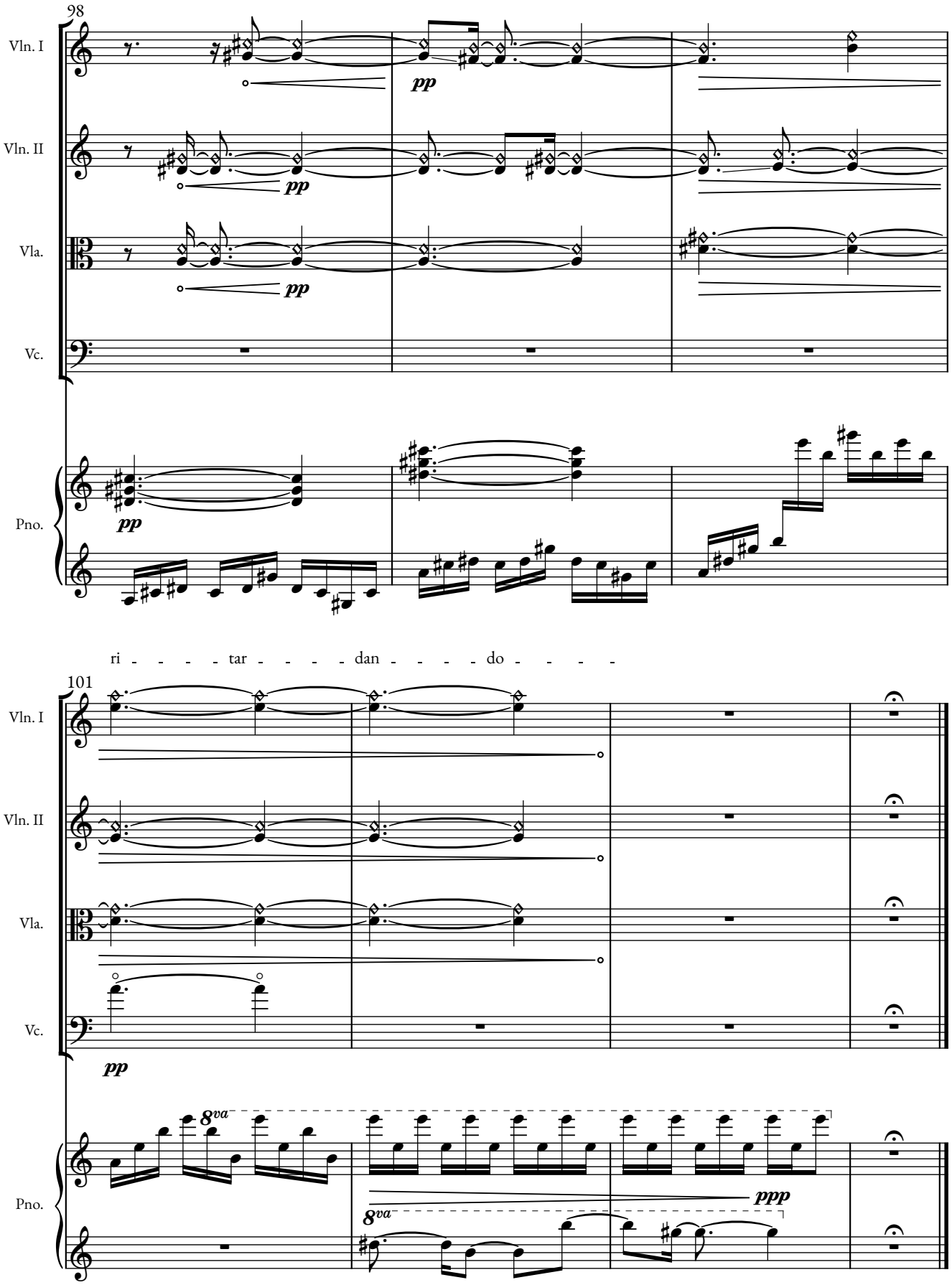

71
Vln. I
Vln. II
pizz.
Vla.
Vc.
mp
Pno.
mp
8va
pp
73
ord.
Vln. I
pp
p
p
Vln. II
p
m.s.p.
pp
arco
Vla.
p
m.s.p.
p
p
Vc.
p
(8)
Pno.


75
Vln. I
m.s.p.
ord.
p
Vln. II
p
ord.
pp
pizz.
p
Vla.
pizz.
p
Vc.
Pno.
(8)
secco
77
Vln. I
p.s.p.
Vln. II
arco
pp
p
Vla.
arco
pp
pizz.
p
Vc.
arco
p
pp
pizz.
p
Pno.

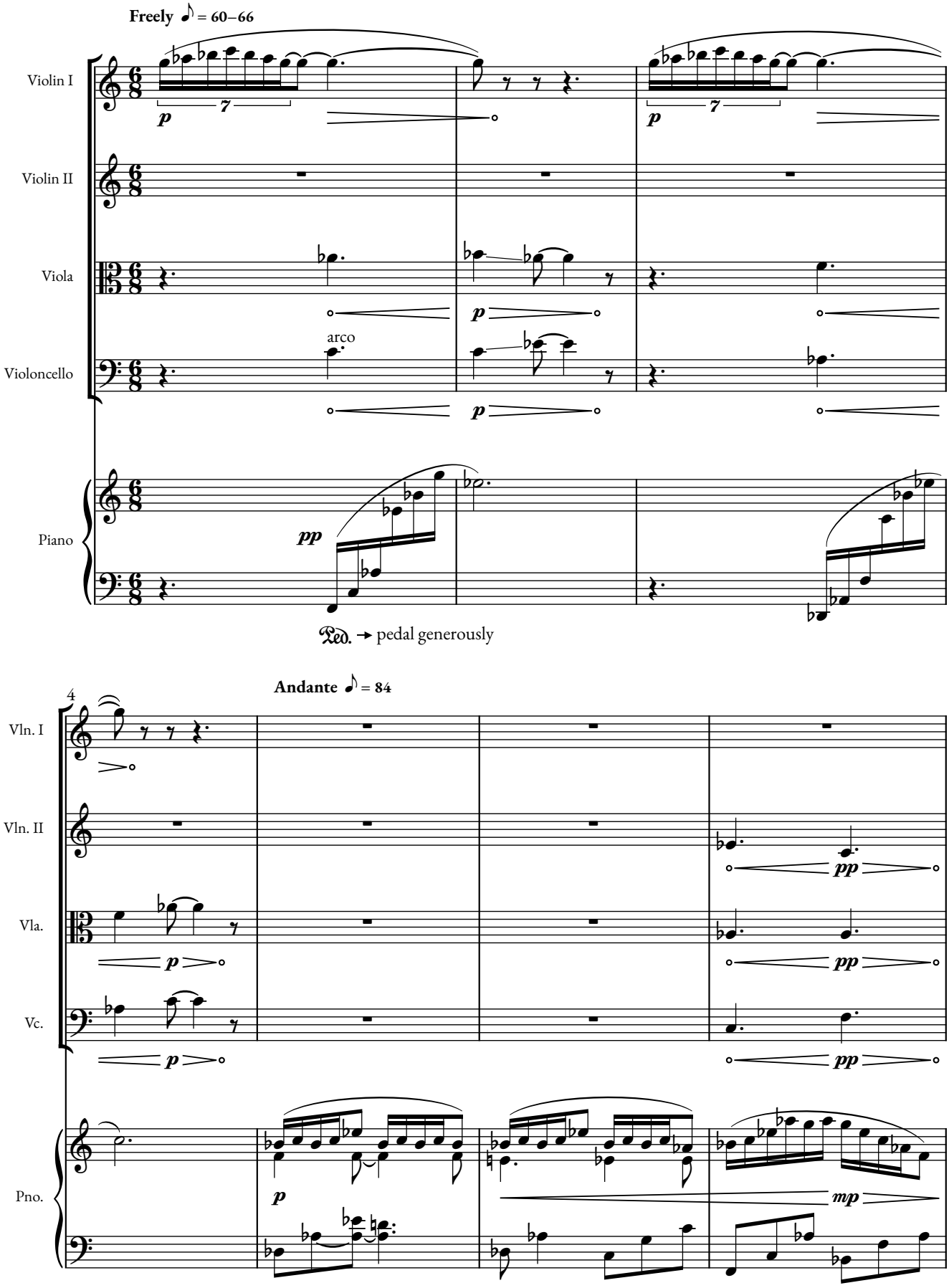

80
Vln. I
ord.
mp
Vln. II
mf
mp
Vla.
ricochet
arco
mp
Vc.
mp
mf
Pno.
mp
Ped. → pedal generously
83
Vln. I
f
Vln. II
f
Vla.
f
Vc.
arco
f
8va
Pno.
mf

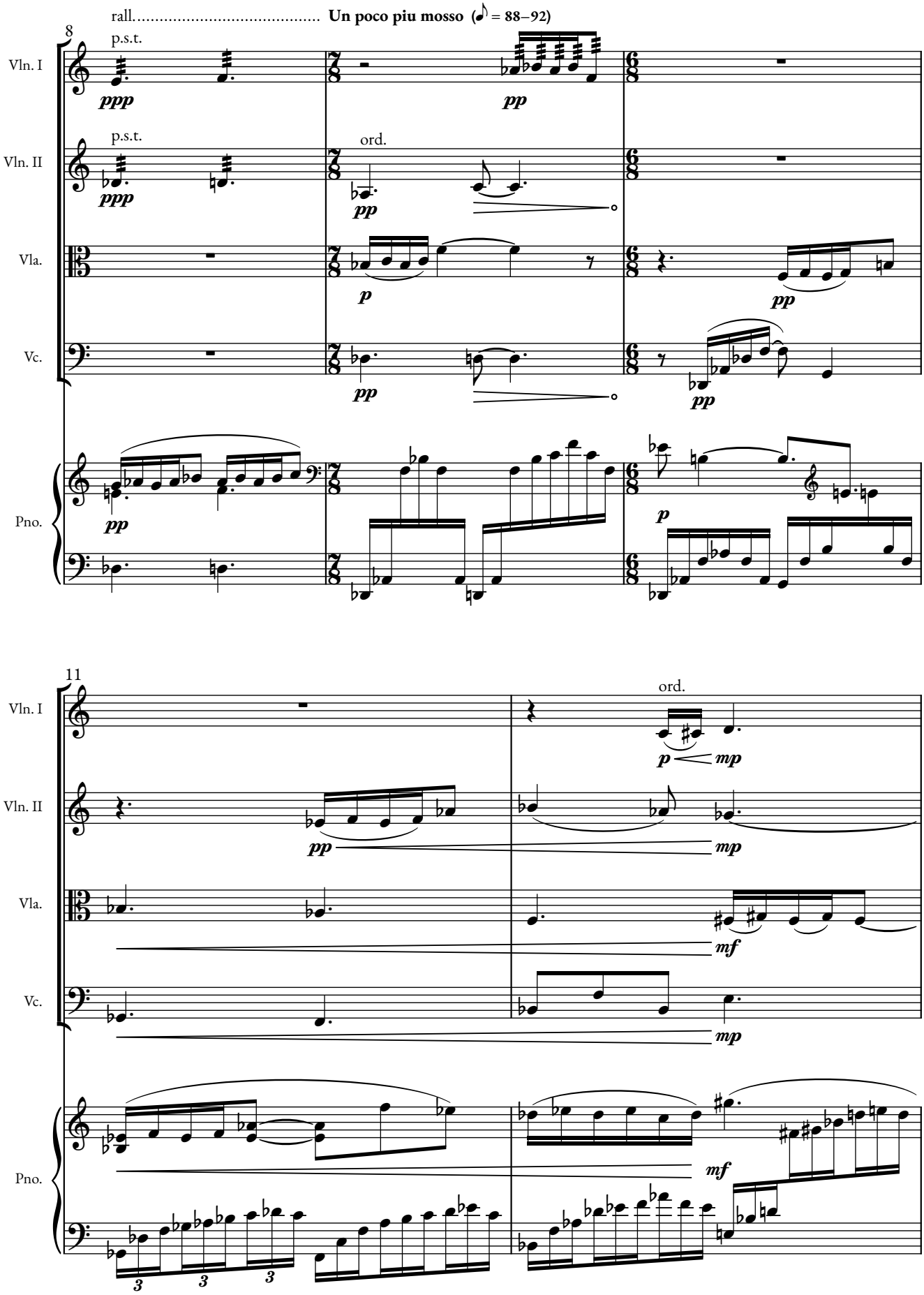

86
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
8va
8va
89
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mp sub.
mp sub.
mp sub.
mp sub.
mp sub.
8va

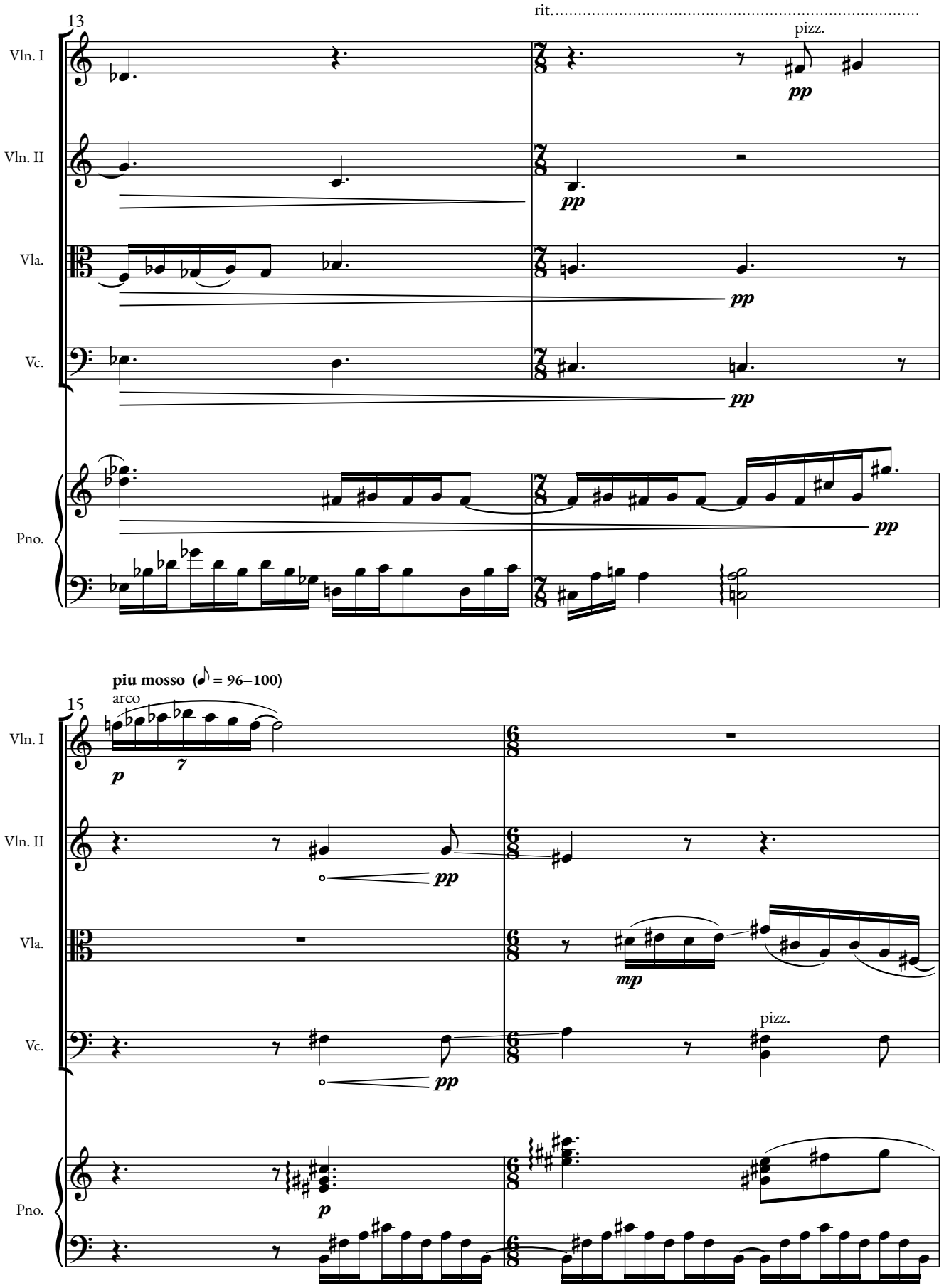

92
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
(8)
p
95
pizz.

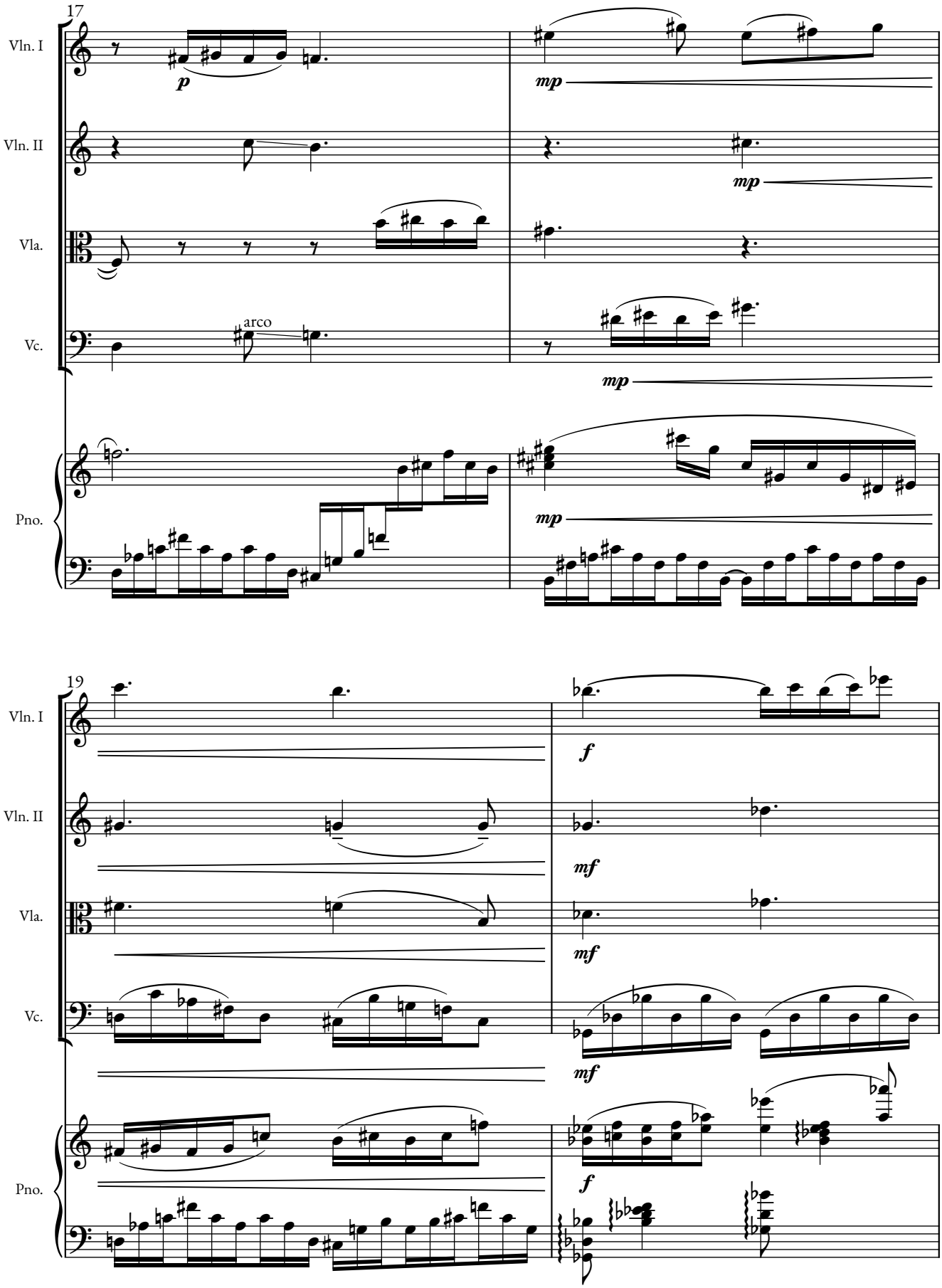

98
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
pp
ri - - - - tar - - - - dan - - - - do - - - -
101
8va
ppp

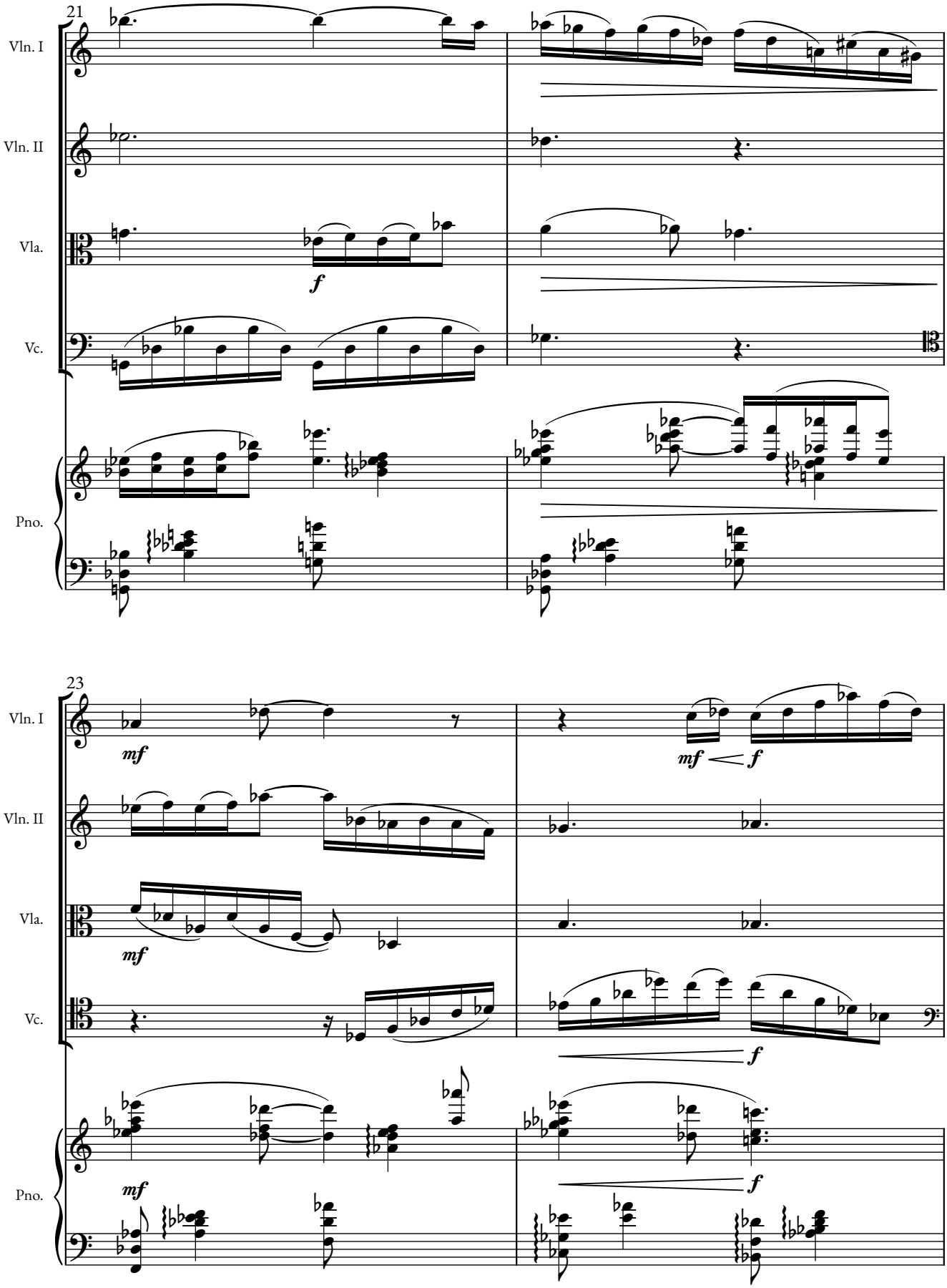
II. Distant memories

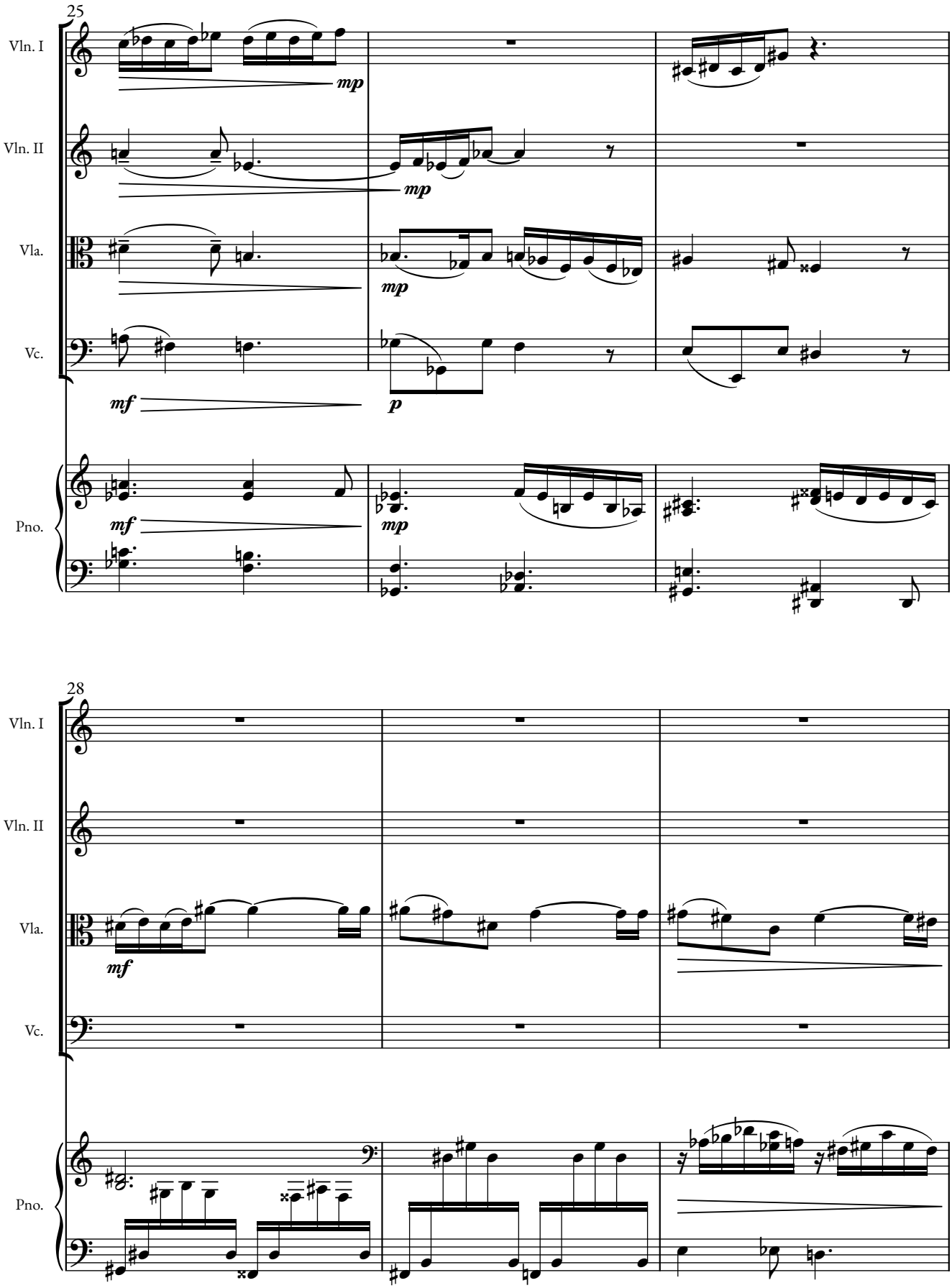


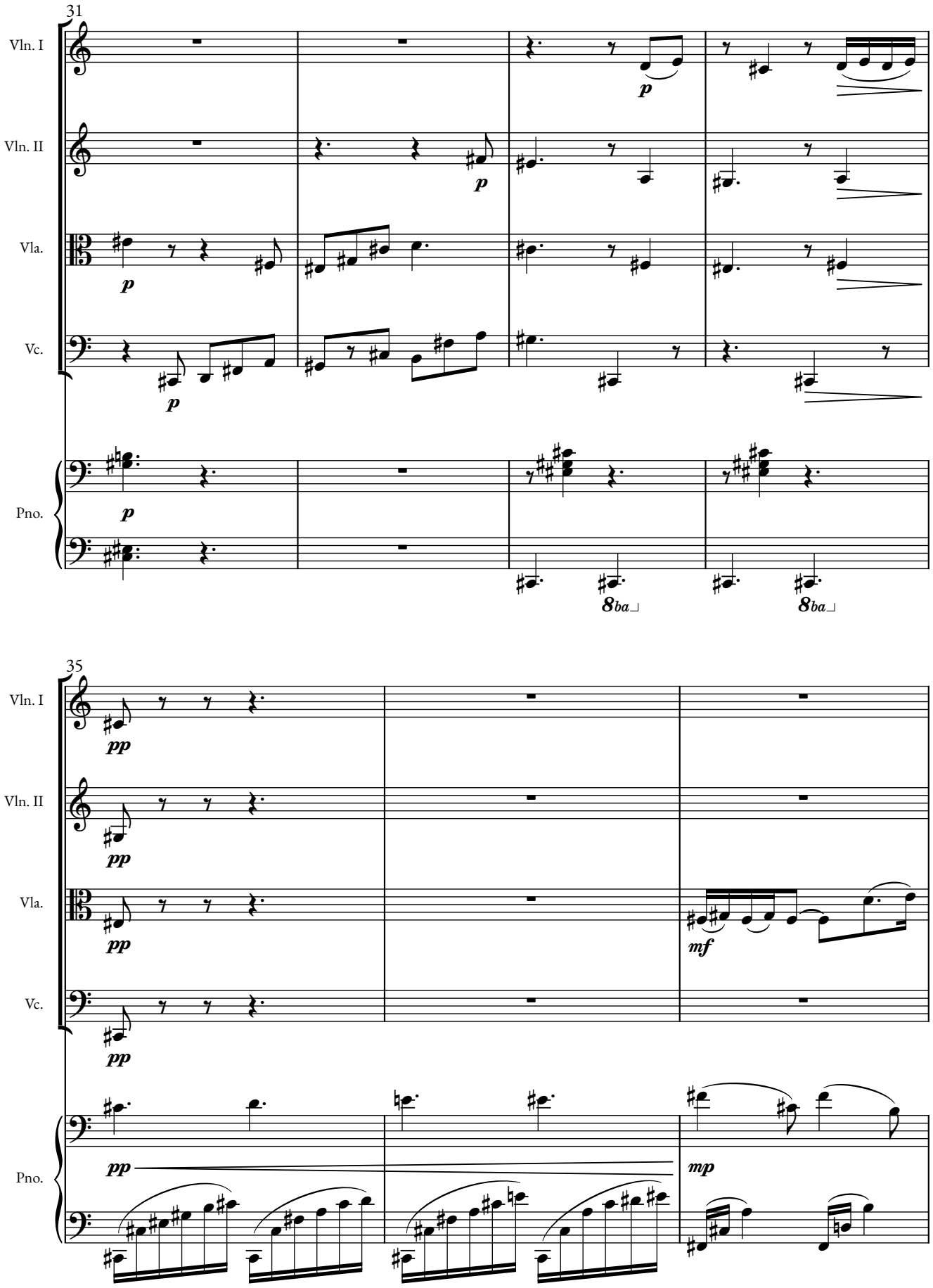

rall.
Un poco piu mosso (♪ = 88–92)
8
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.t.
ord.
ppp
pp
p
11
mp
mf

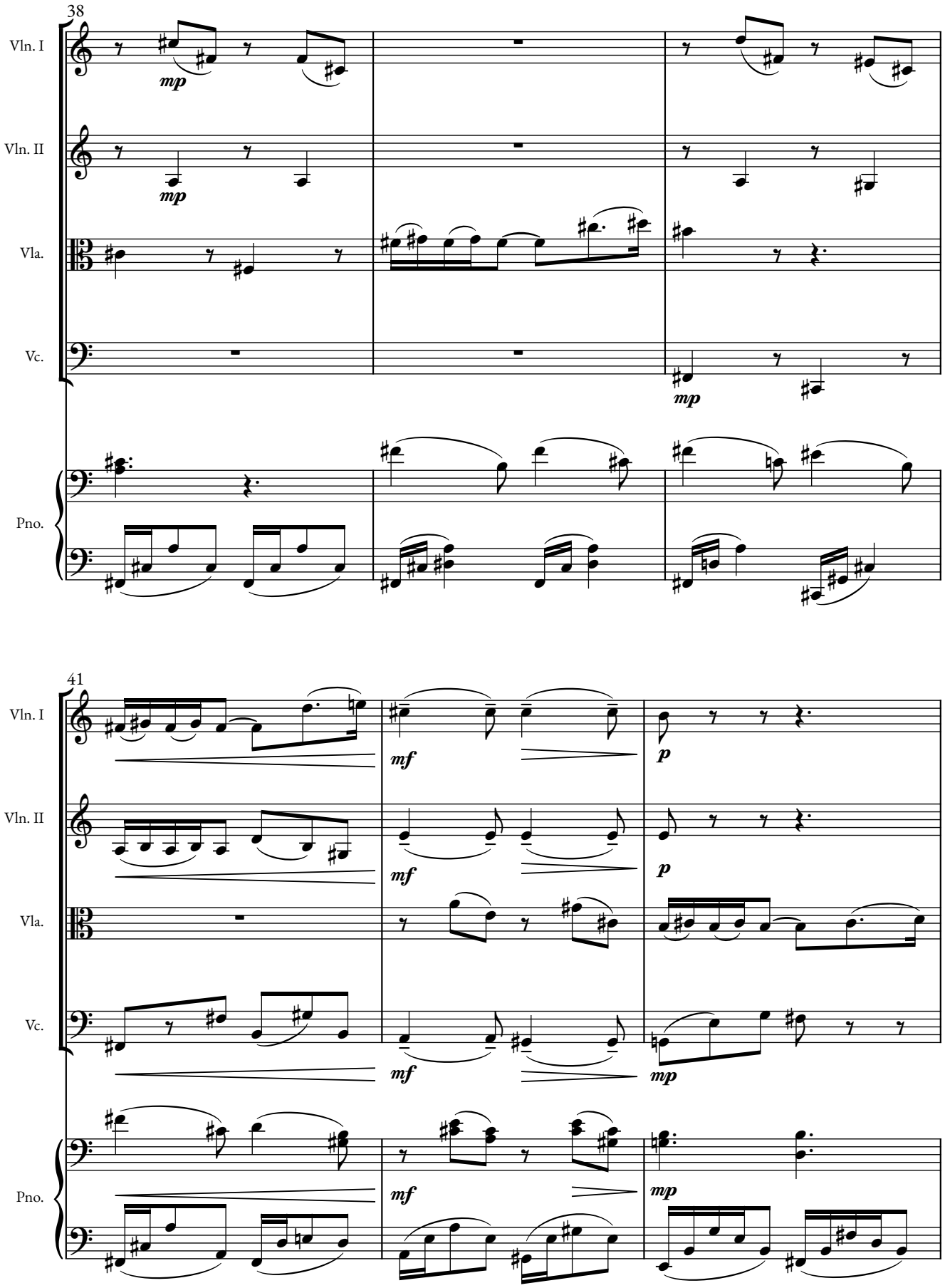

13
rit.
pizz.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
pp
piu mosso (♪ = 96–100)
arco
15
p
7
mp
pizz.

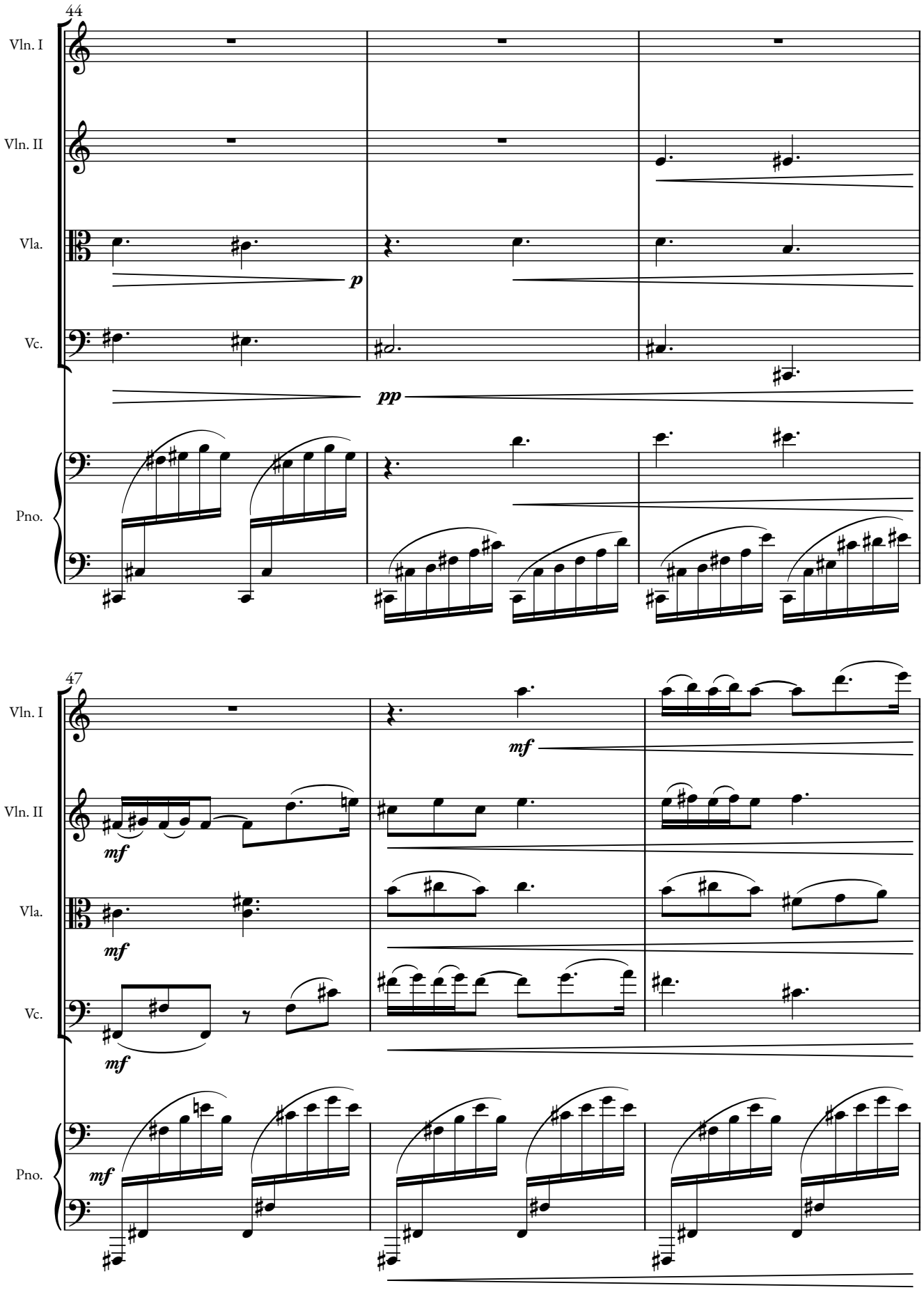

17
Vln. I
p
mp
Vln. II
mp
Vla.
Vc.
arco
mp
Pno.
mp
19
Vln. I
f
Vln. II
mf
Vla.
mf
Vc.
mf
Pno.
f

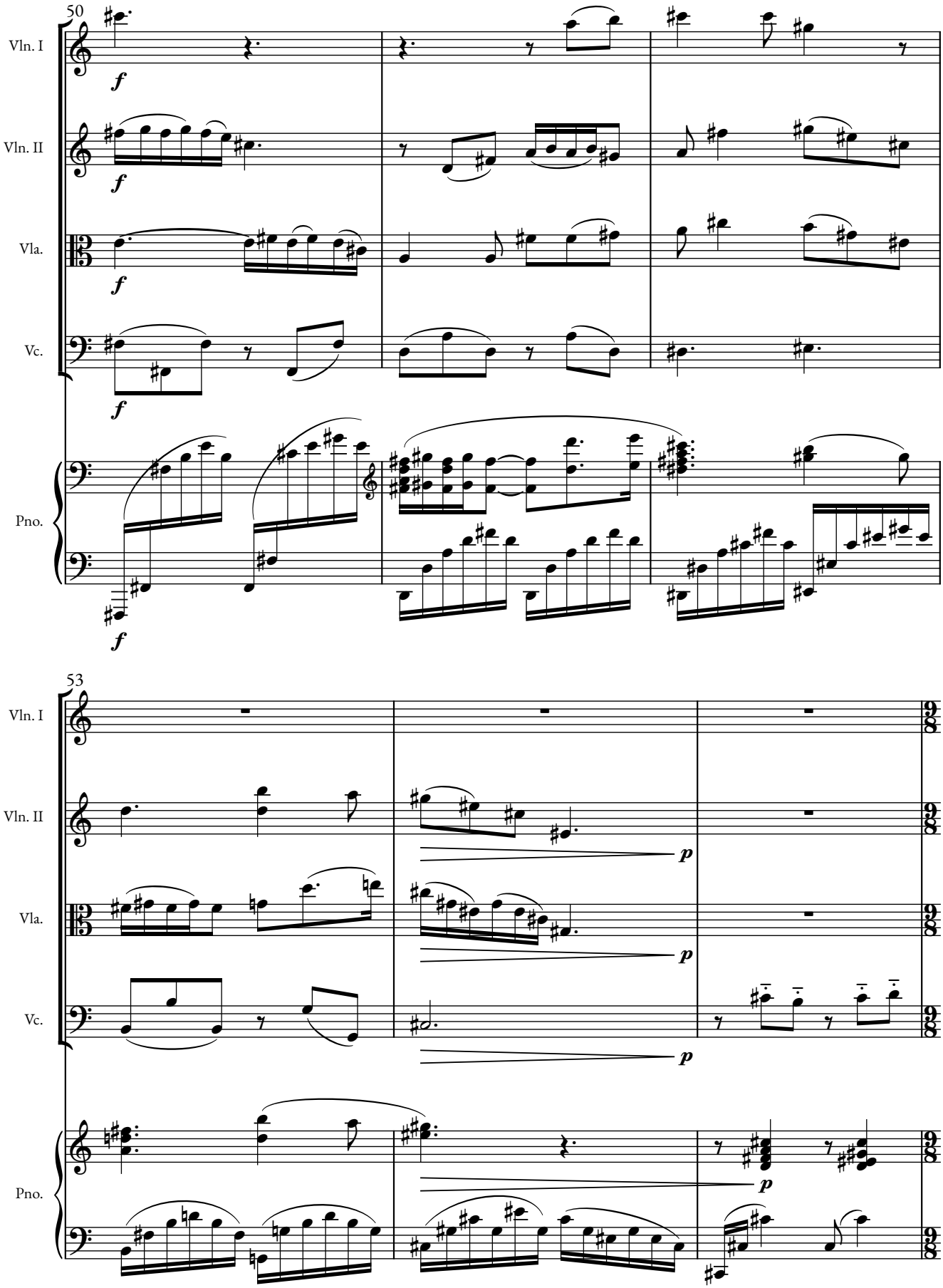

21
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
f
23
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mf
mf
f
mf
f
mf
f

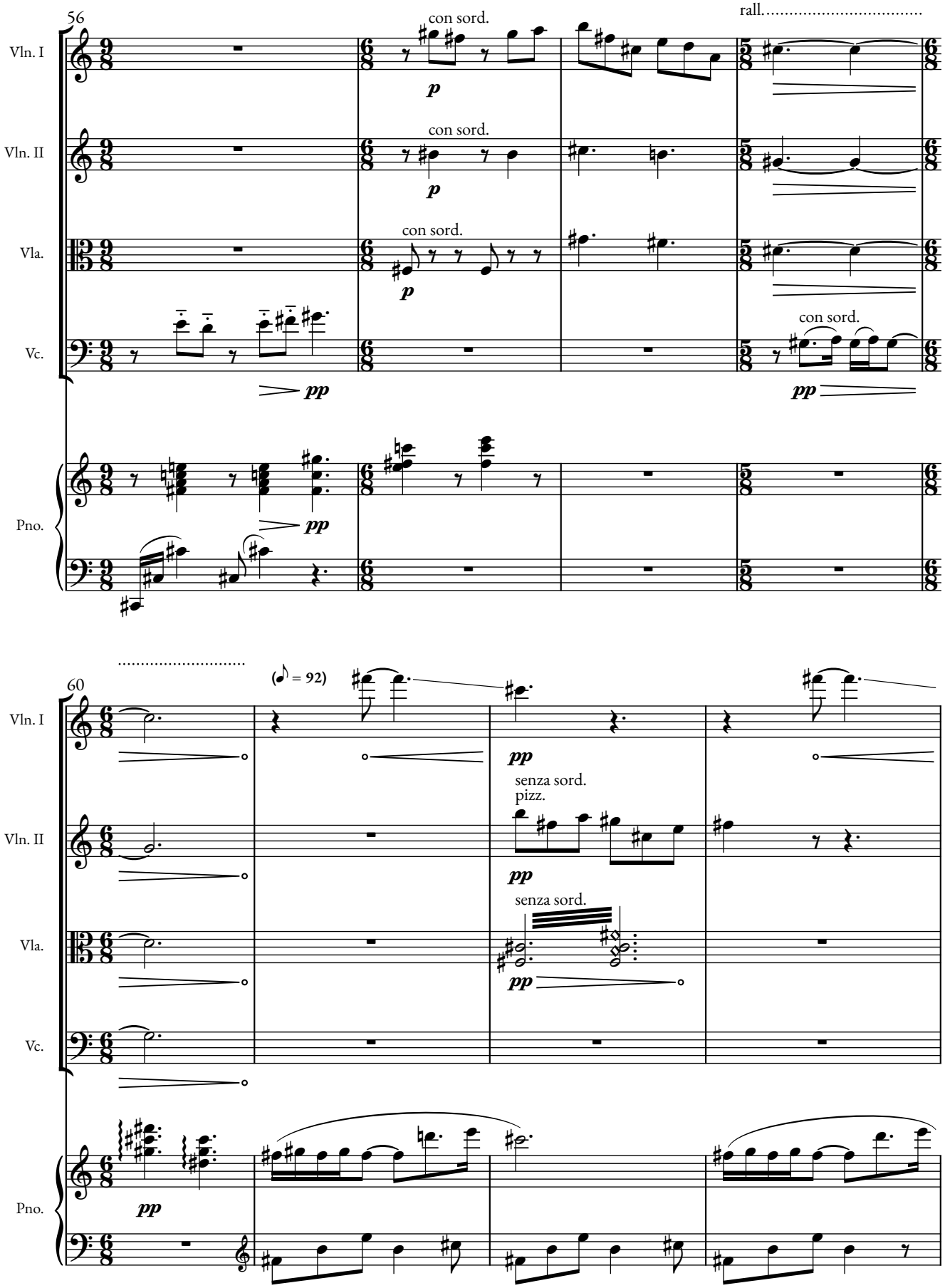

25
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mp
mp
mp
mf
p
mf
mp
28
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mf

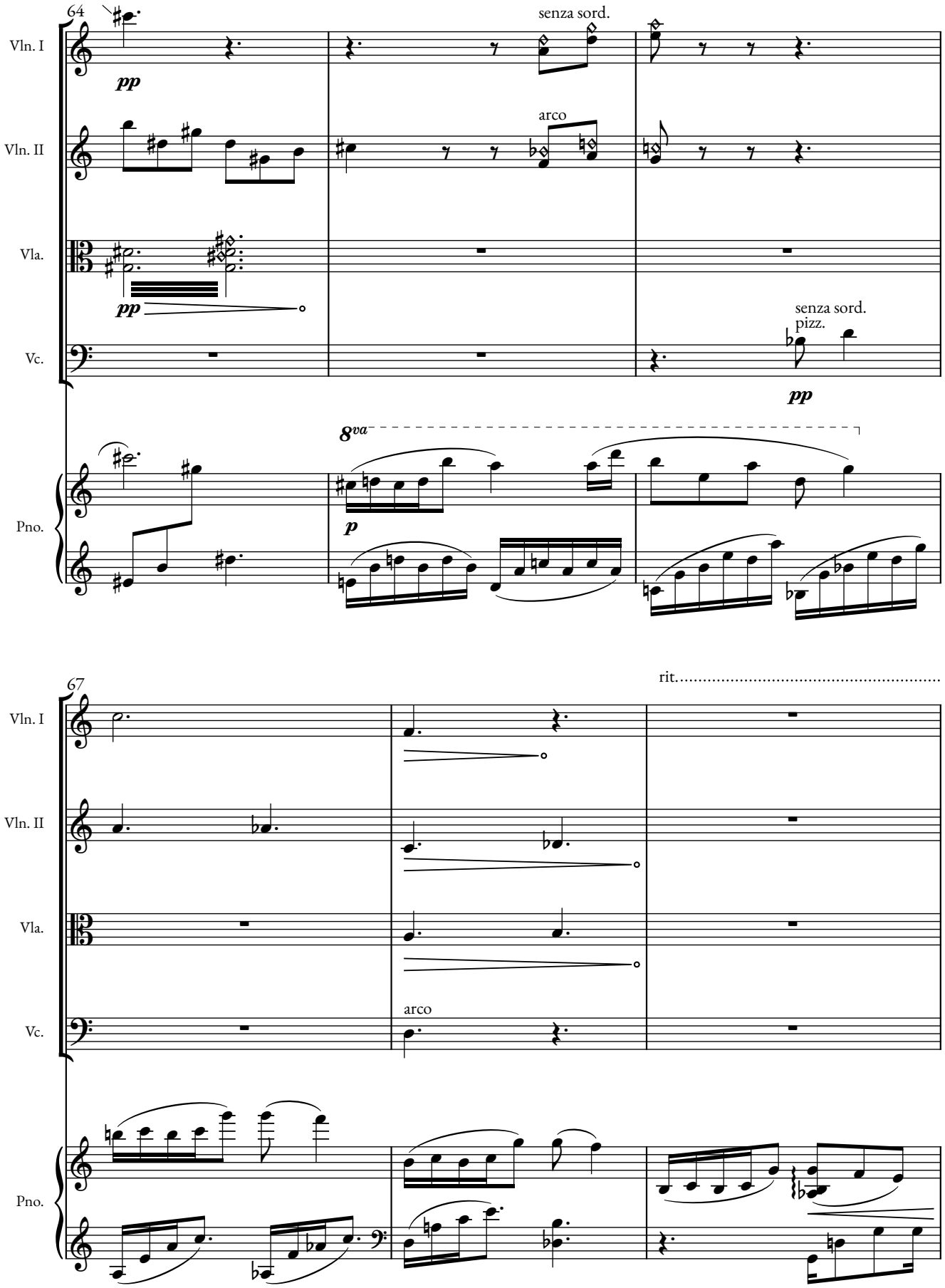

31
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p
8ba
35
pp
mf
mp

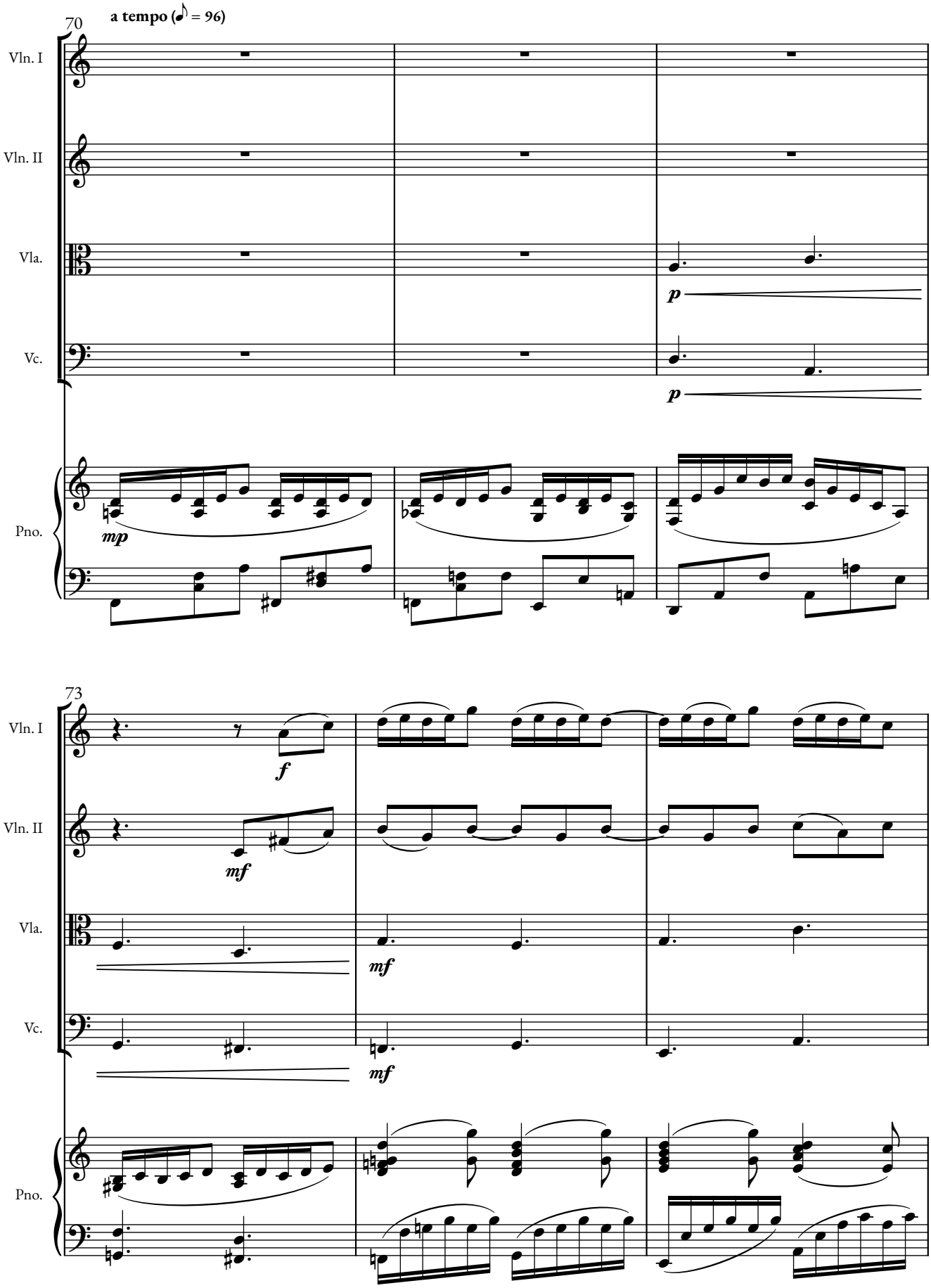

38
Vln. I
mp
Vln. II
mp
Vla.
Vc.
mp
Pno.
41
Vln. I
mf
p
Vln. II
mf
p
Vla.
Vc.
mf
mp
Pno.
mf
mp

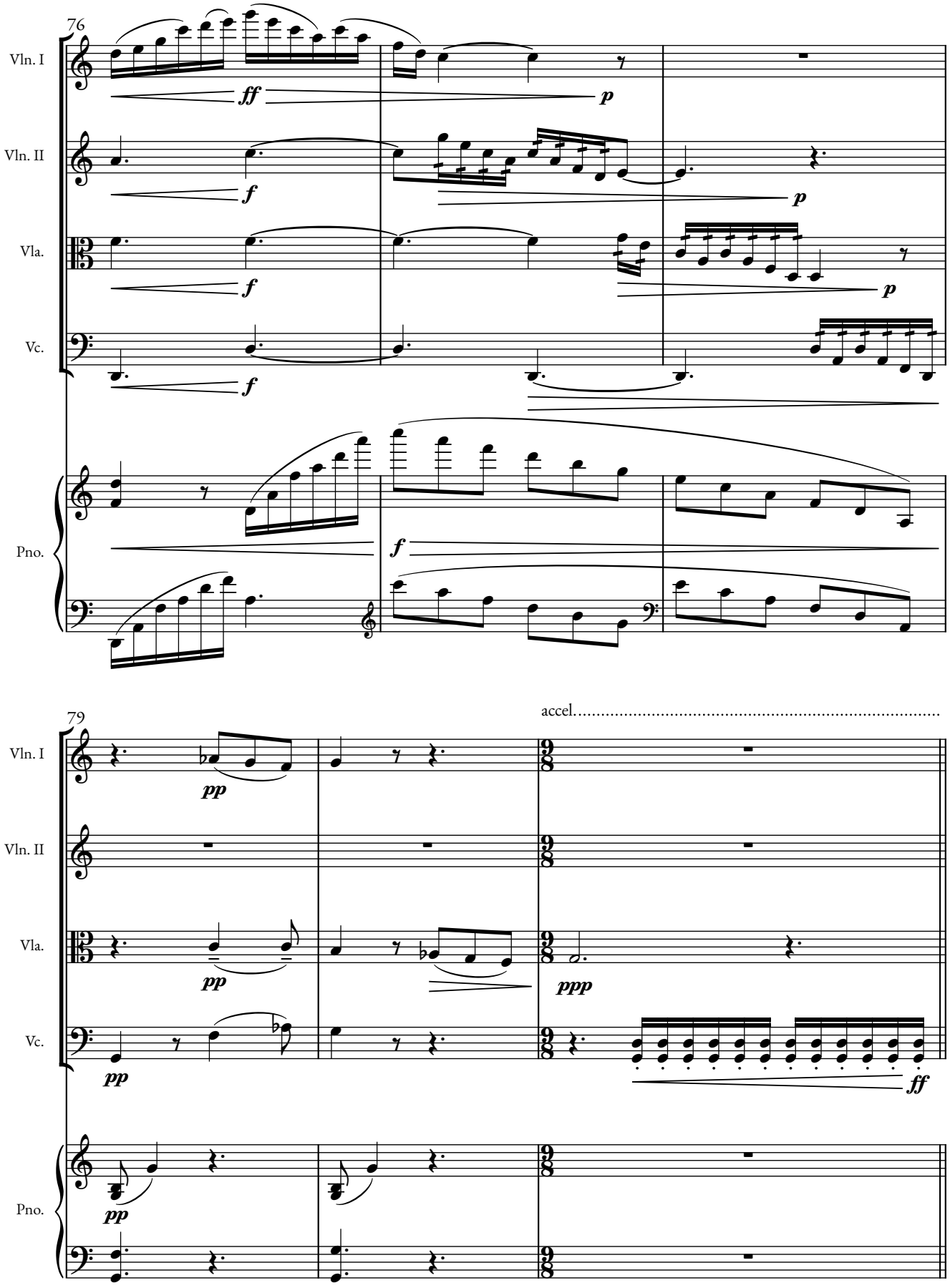

44
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p
pp
47
mf


50
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
53
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.

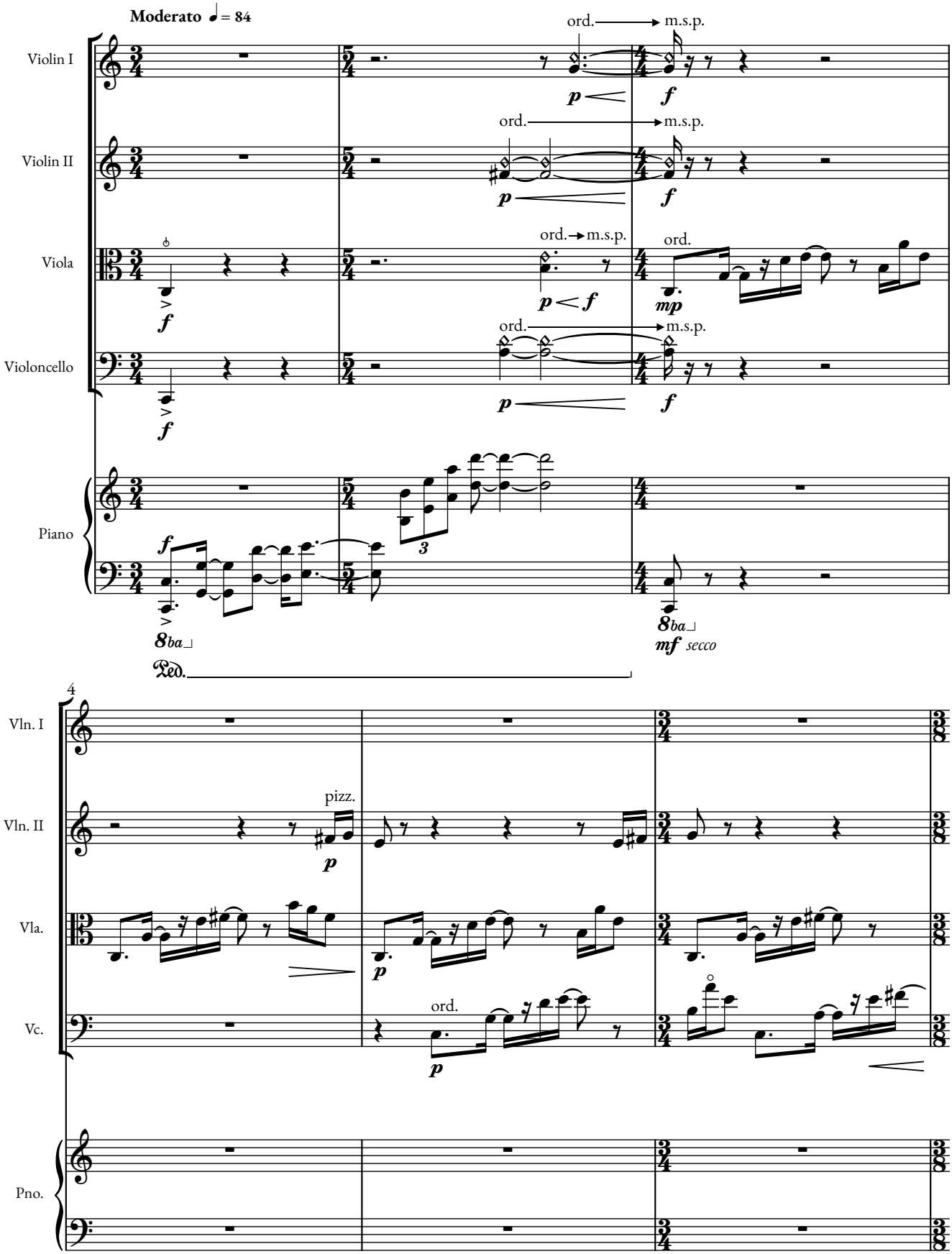

56
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
con sord.
p
pp
rall.
60
(♪ = 92)
senza sord.
pizz.

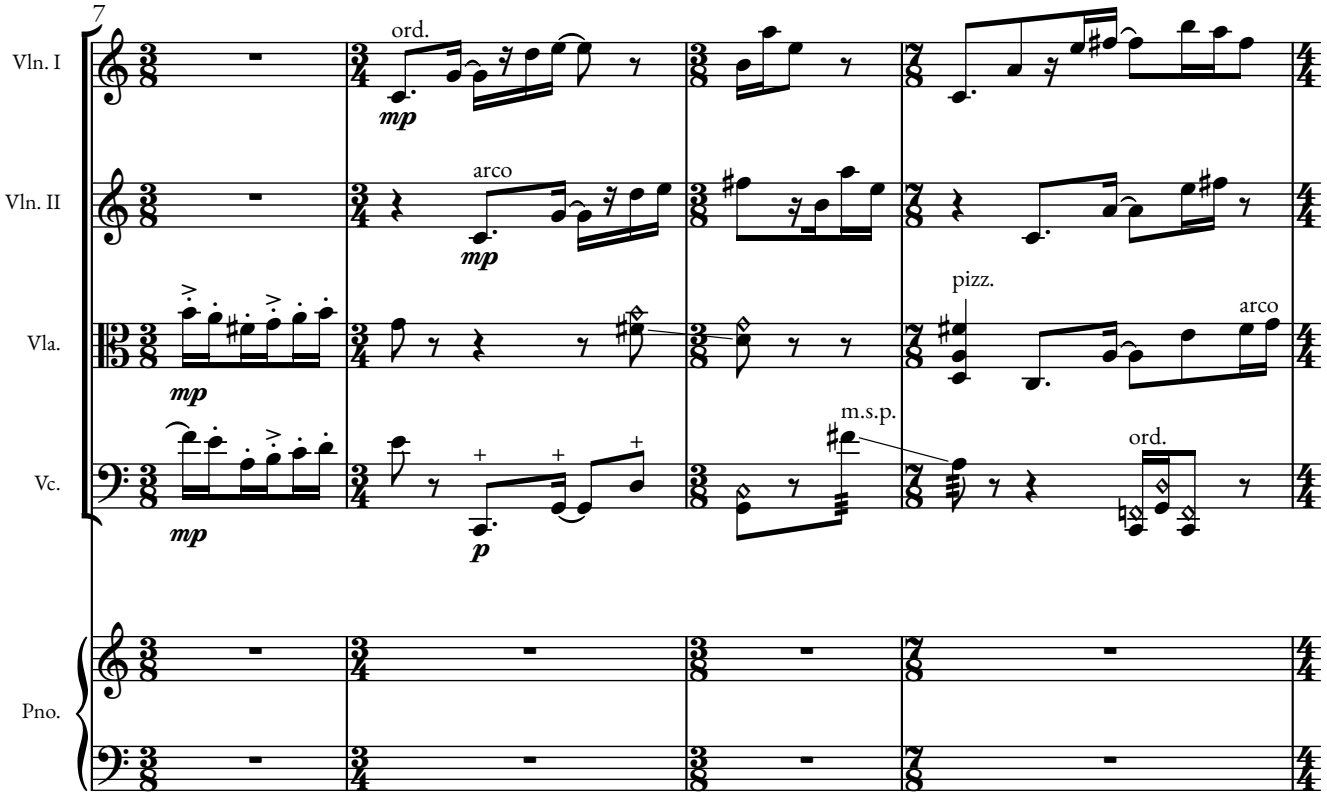

64
Vln. I
pp
senza sord.
Vln. II
arco
Vla.
pp
senza sord.
pizz.
Vc.
pp
8va
Pno.
p
67
rit.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
arco
Pno.

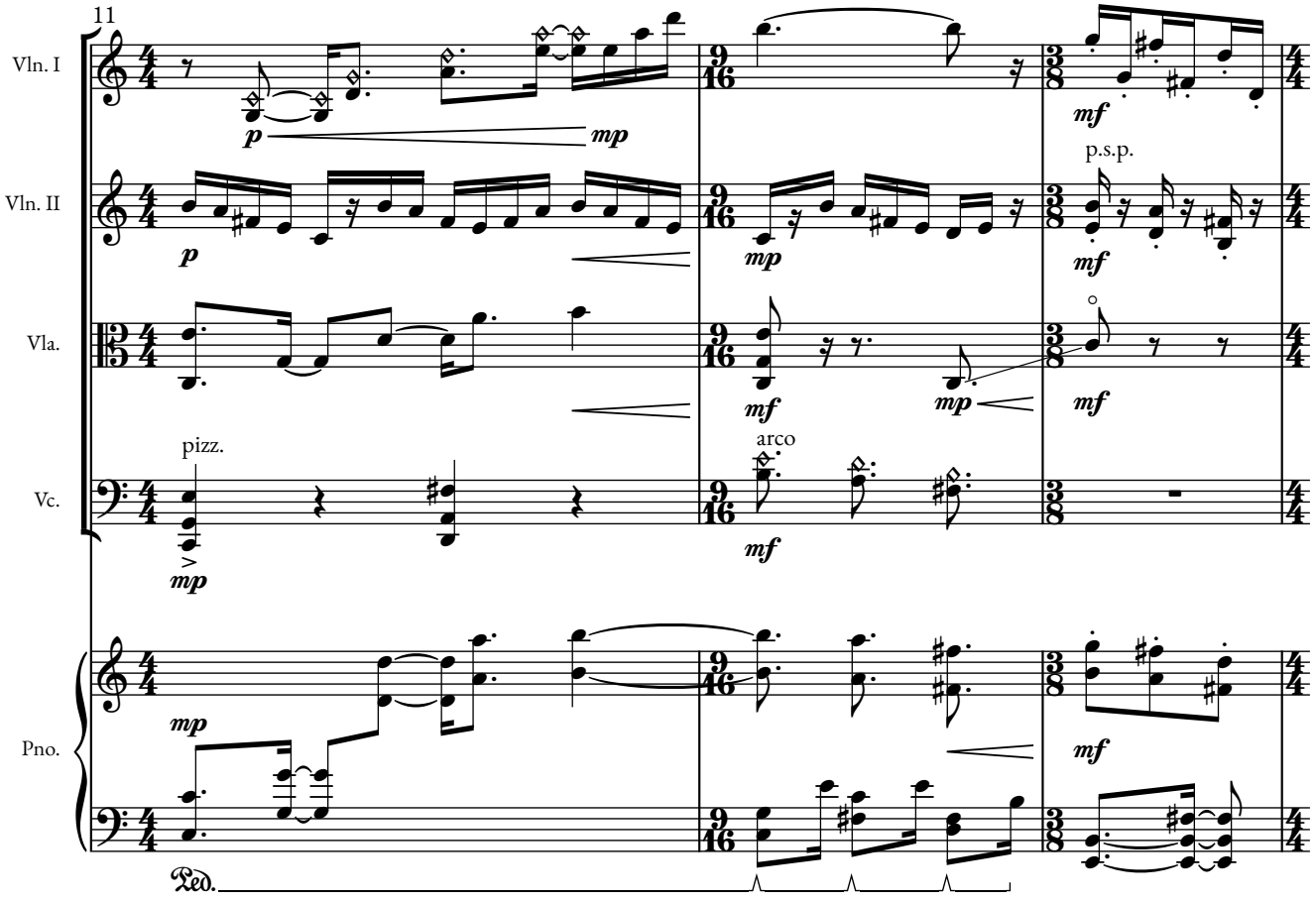

70
a tempo (♪ = 96)
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p
p
mp
73
f
mf
mf
mf

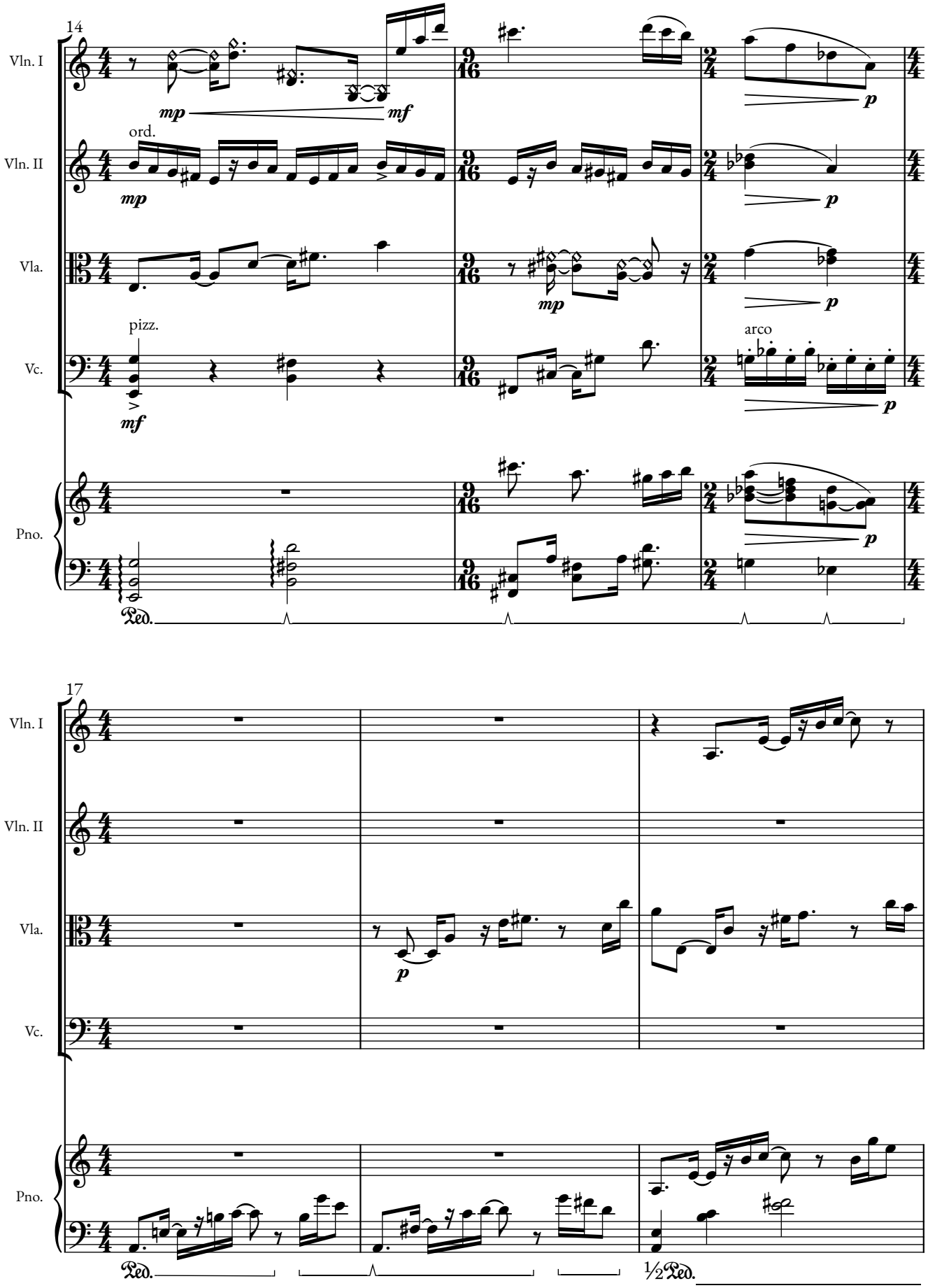

76
Vln. I
ff
p
Vln. II
f
p
Vla.
f
p
Vc.
f
Pno.
f
79
accel.
Vln. I
pp
Vln. II
Vla.
pp
ppp
Vc.
pp
ff
Pno.
pp
attacca

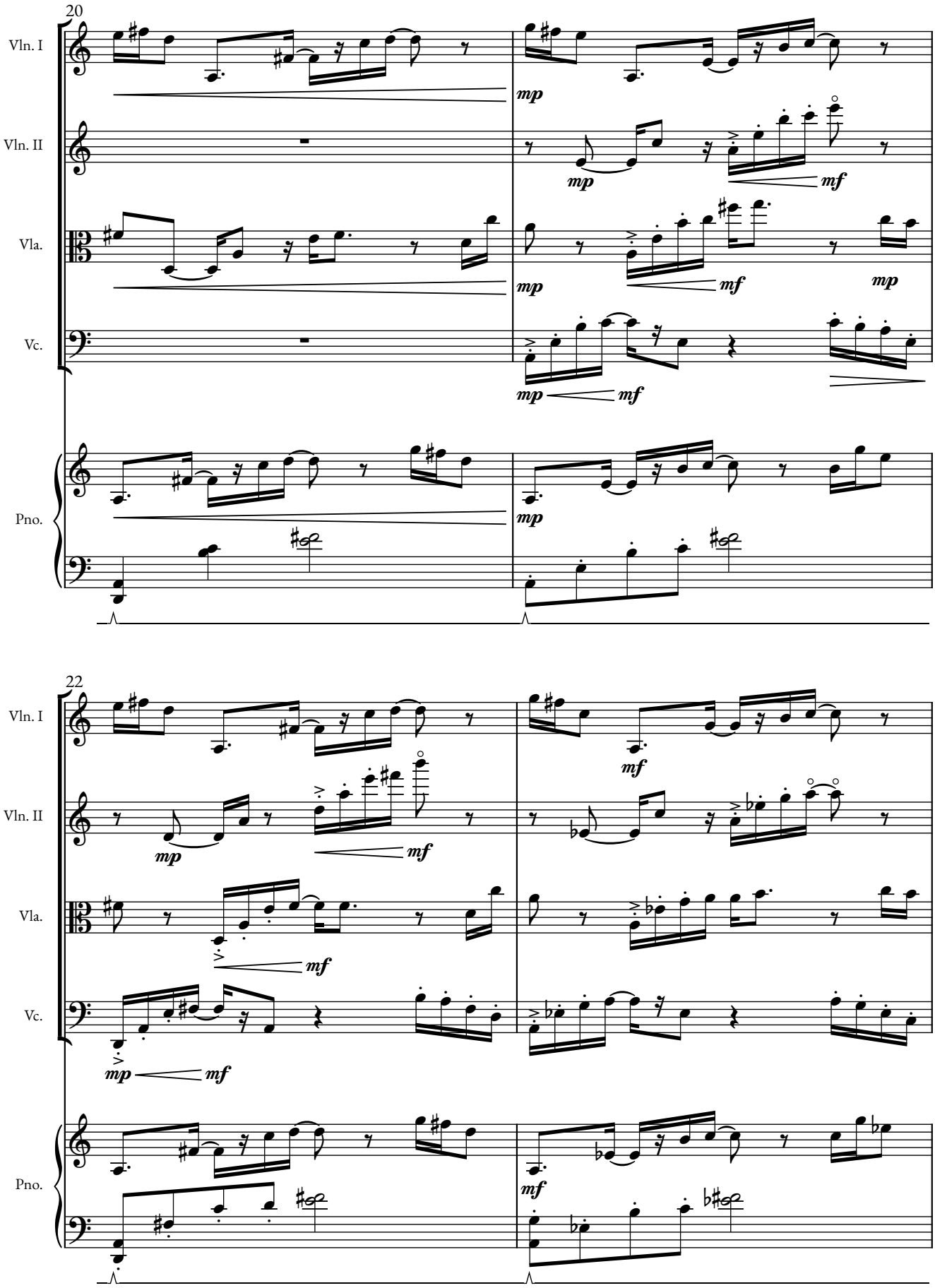
III. Time is a matrix

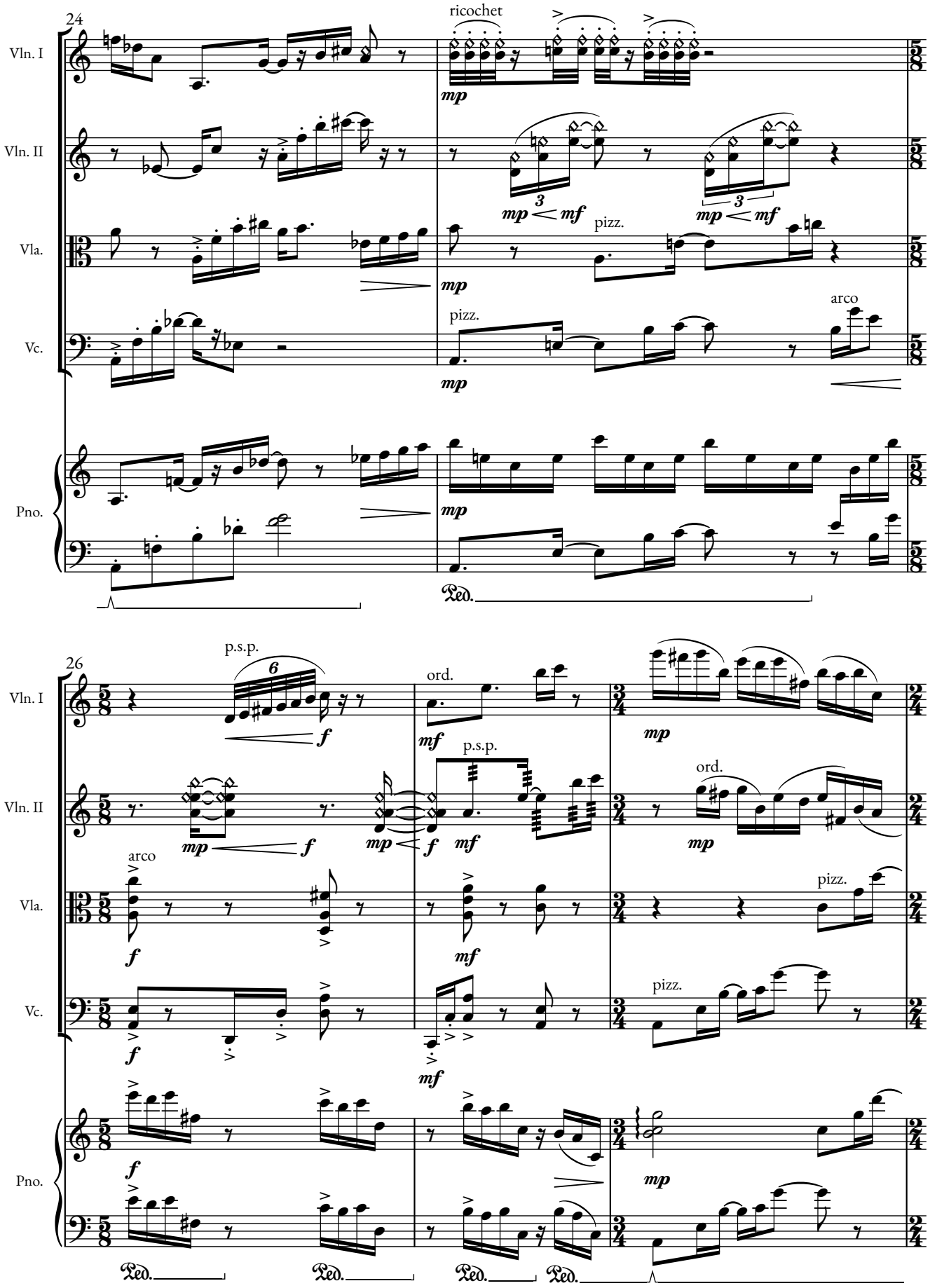


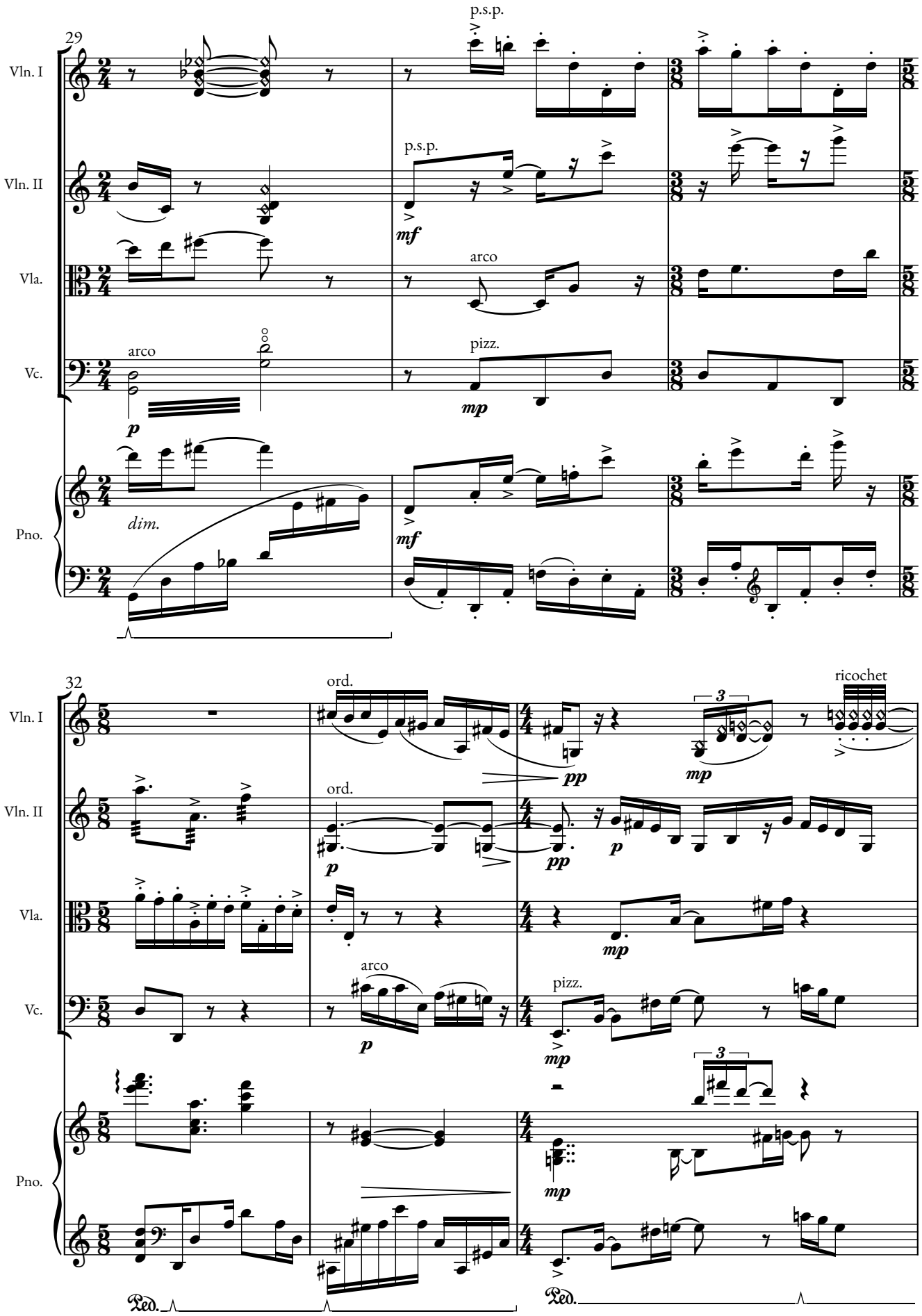

7
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
arco
pizz.
arco
m.s.p.
ord.

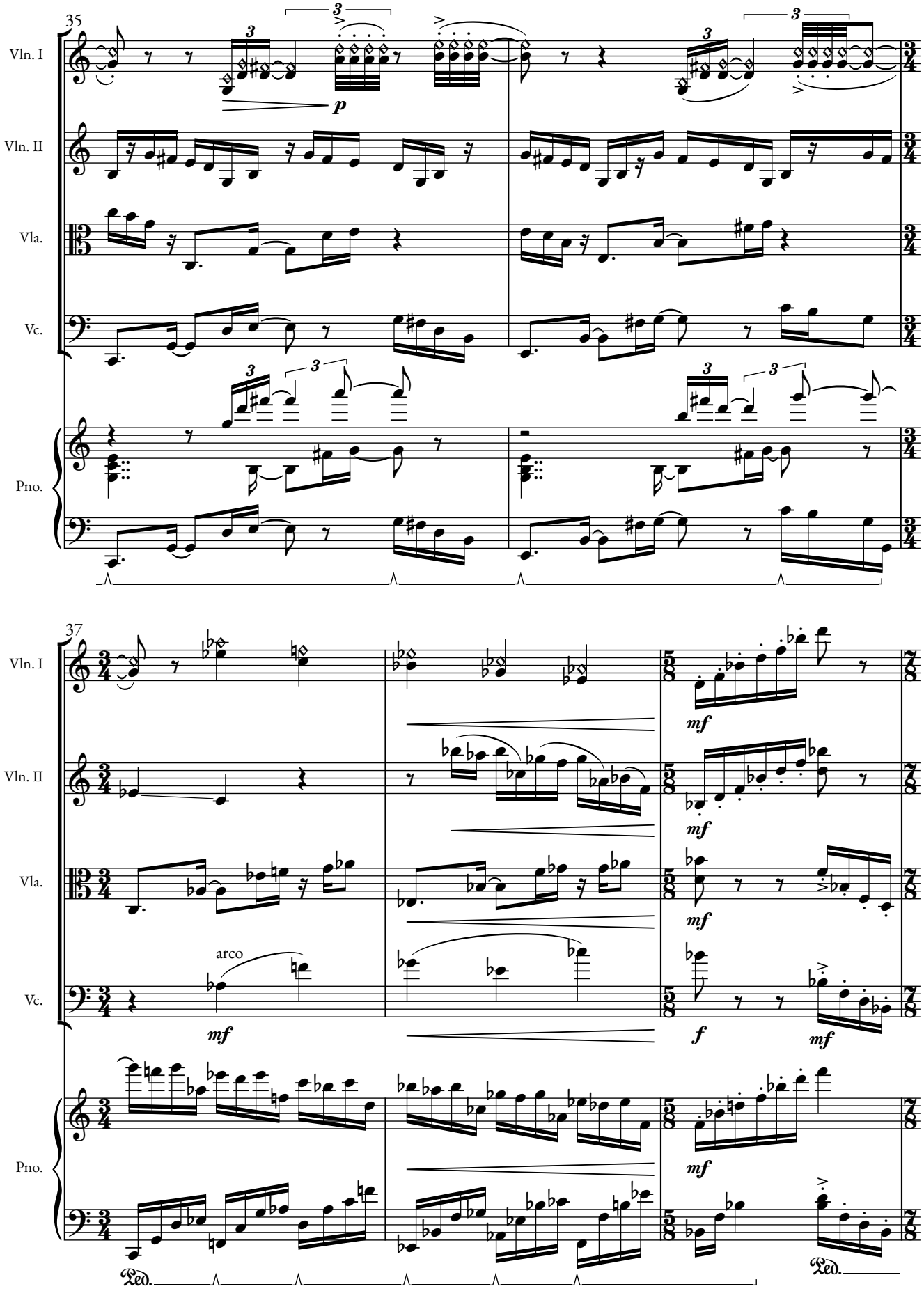

11
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.p.
pizz.
arco
Ped.

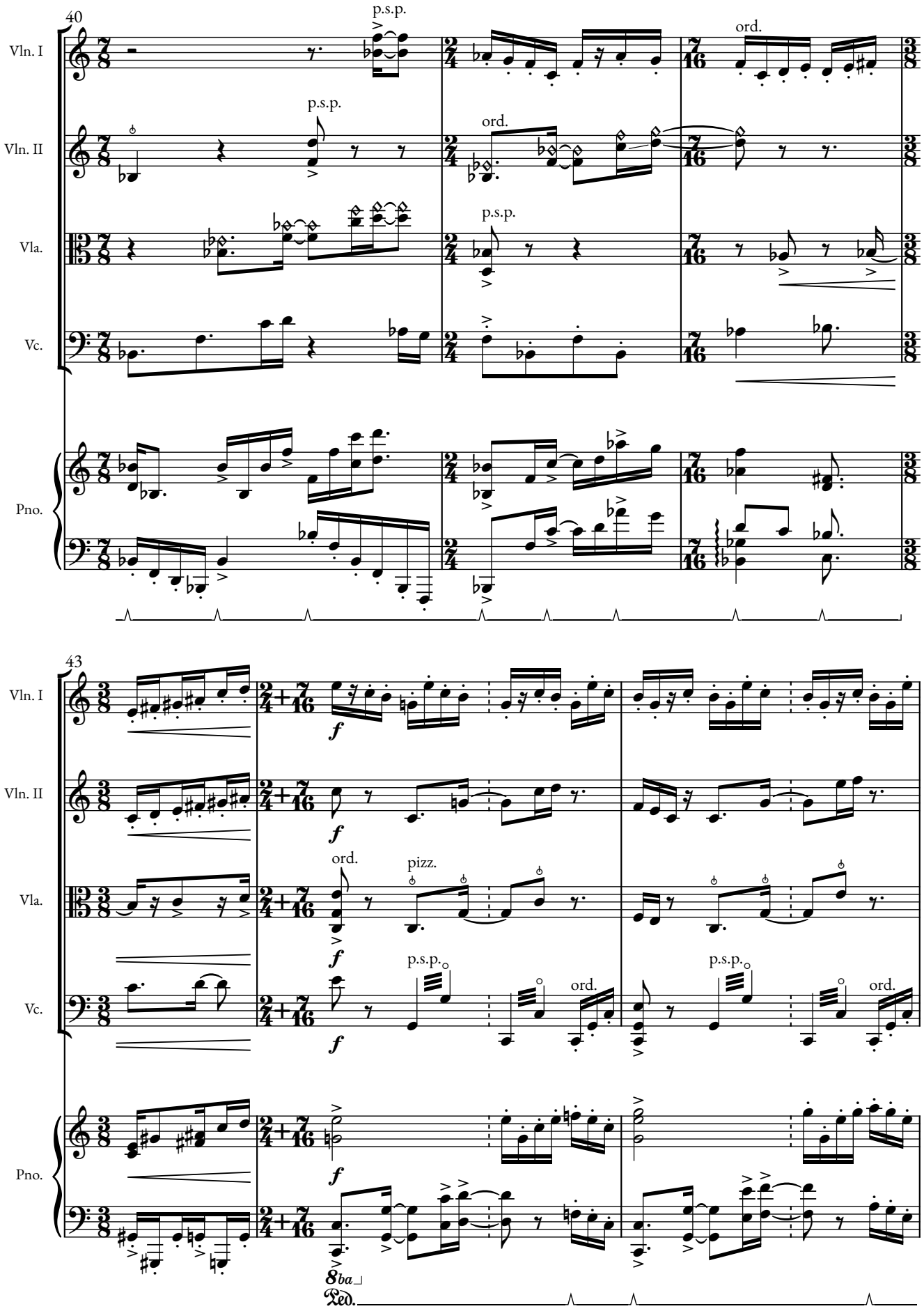

14
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mp
mf
p
ord.
pizz.
arco
Ped.
17
½Ped.

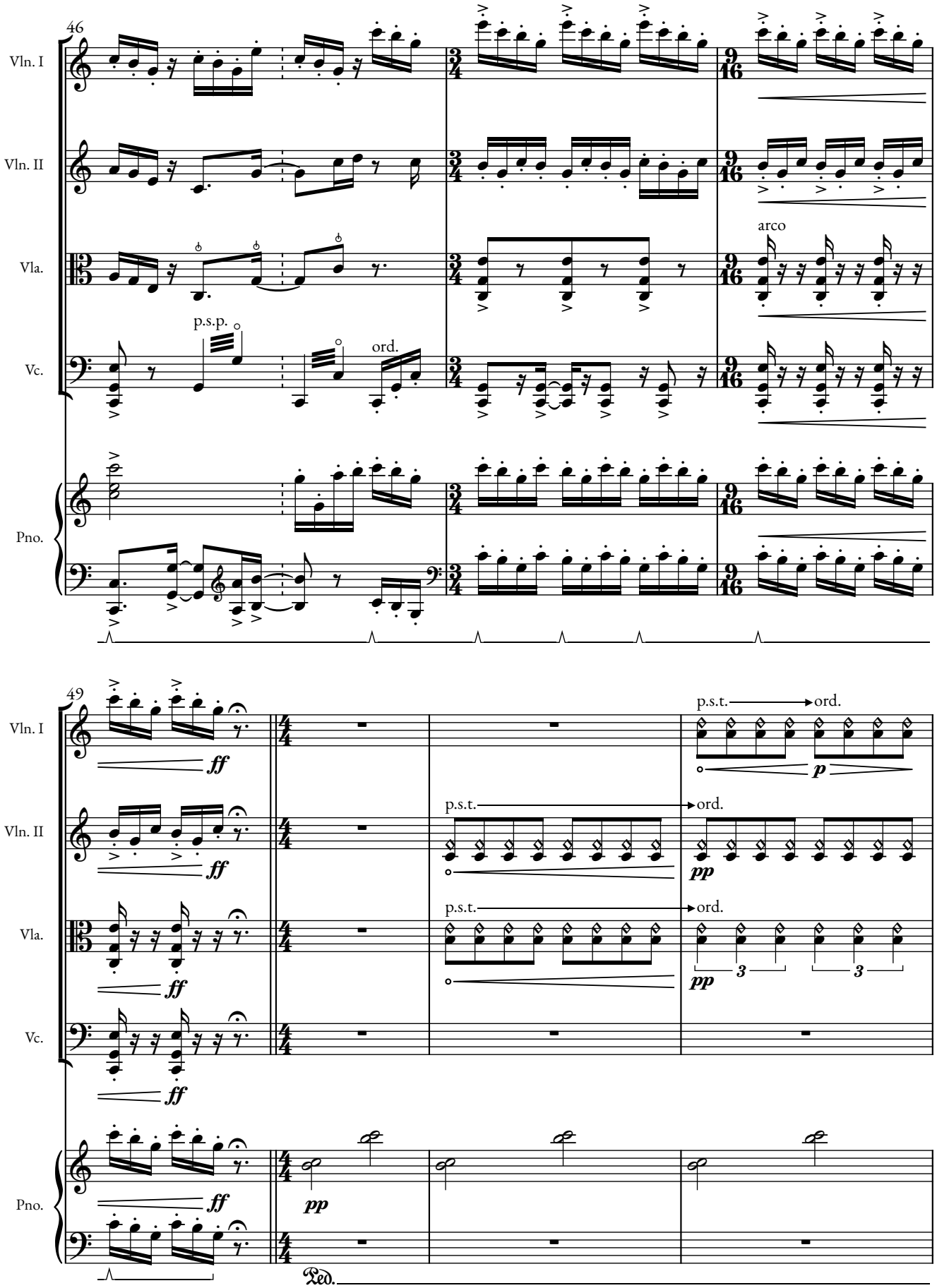

20
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mp
mf
22
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mp
mf

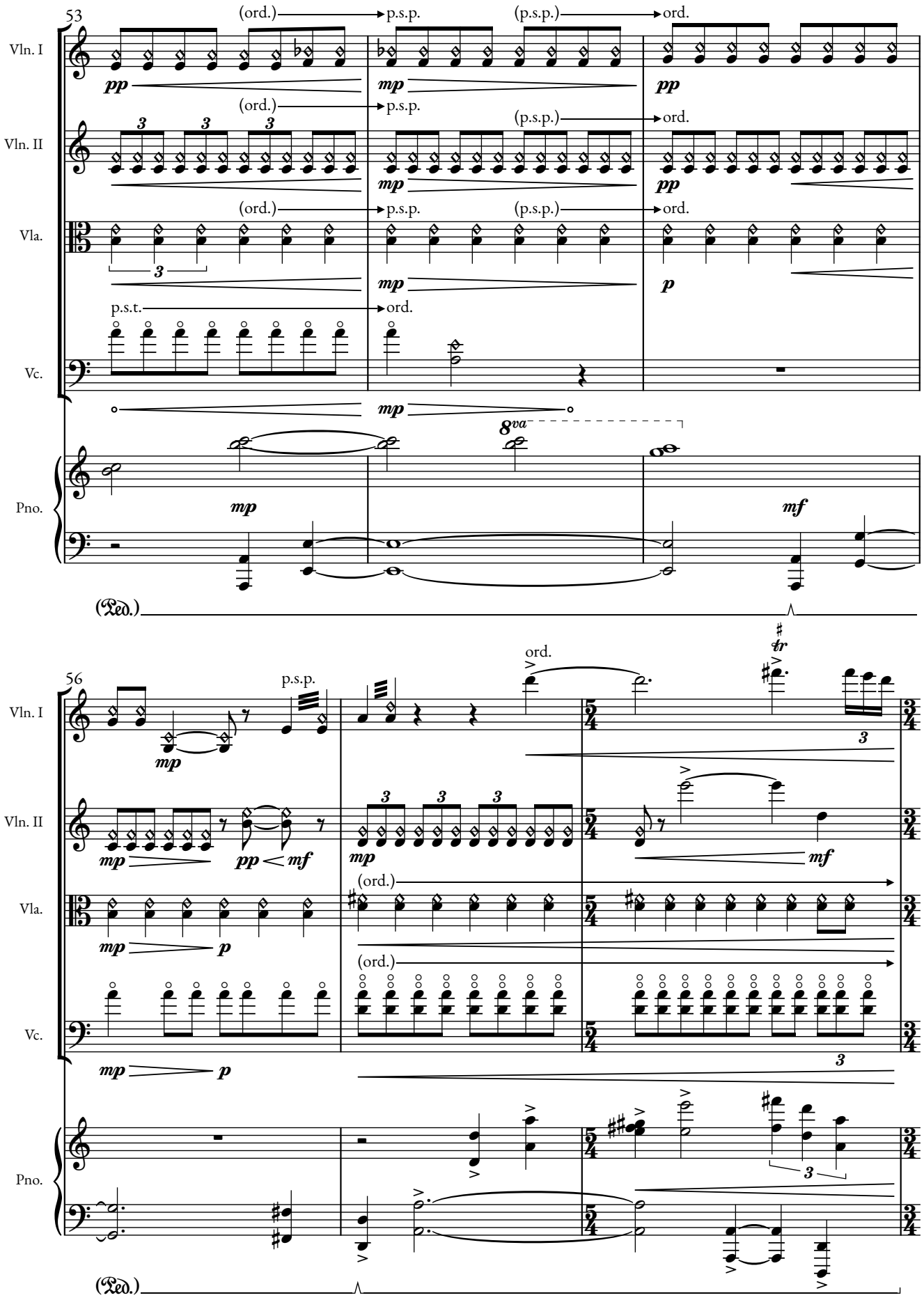

24
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ricochet
mp
mp < mf
pizz.
arco
26
p.s.p.
ord.
f
mf
mp

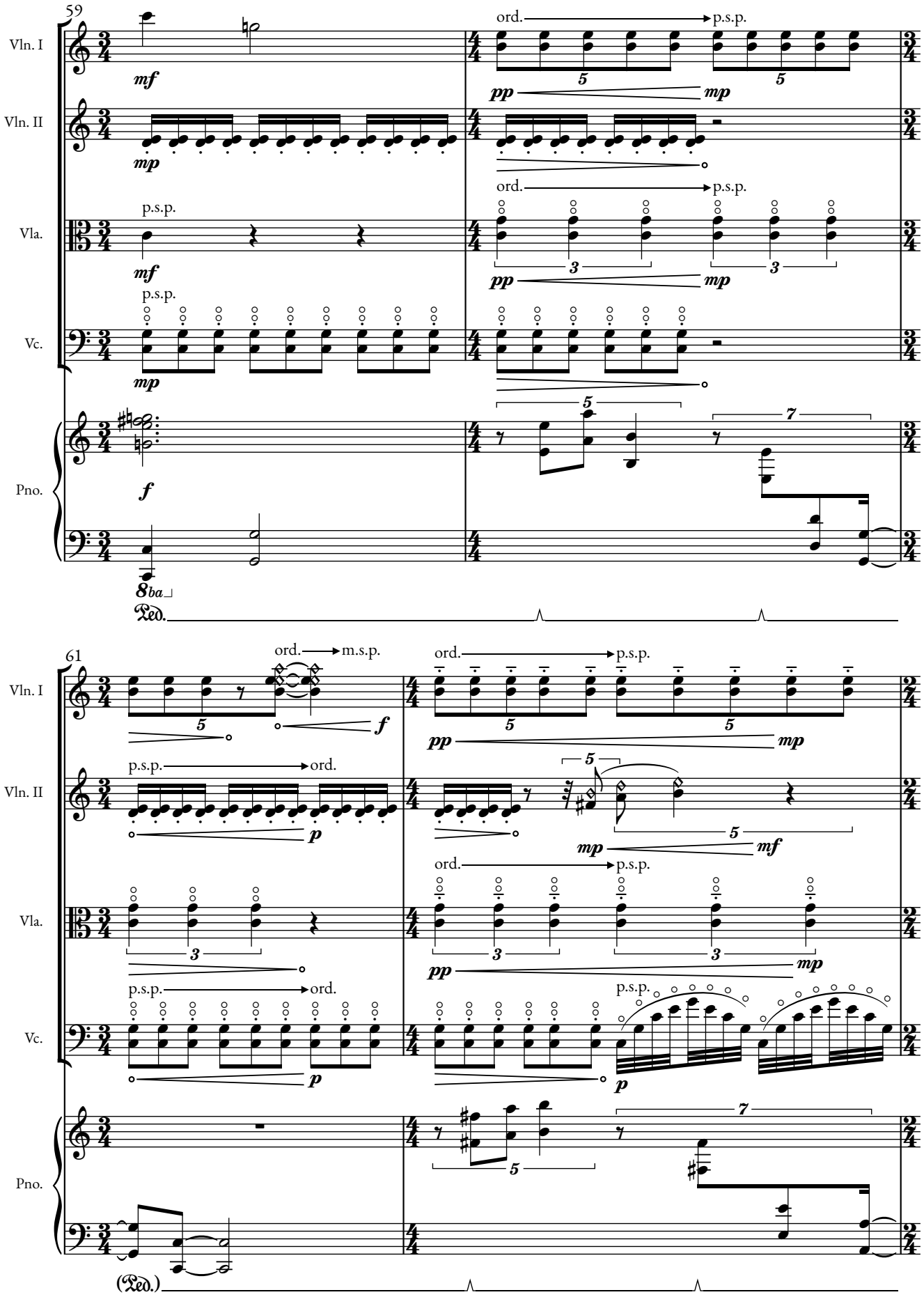

29
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.p.
p.s.p.
mf
arco
arco
pizz.
p
mp
dim.
mf
32
ord.
ord.
ricochet
pp
mp
p
pp
p
mp
arco
pizz.
p
mp
mp
Ped.
Ped.

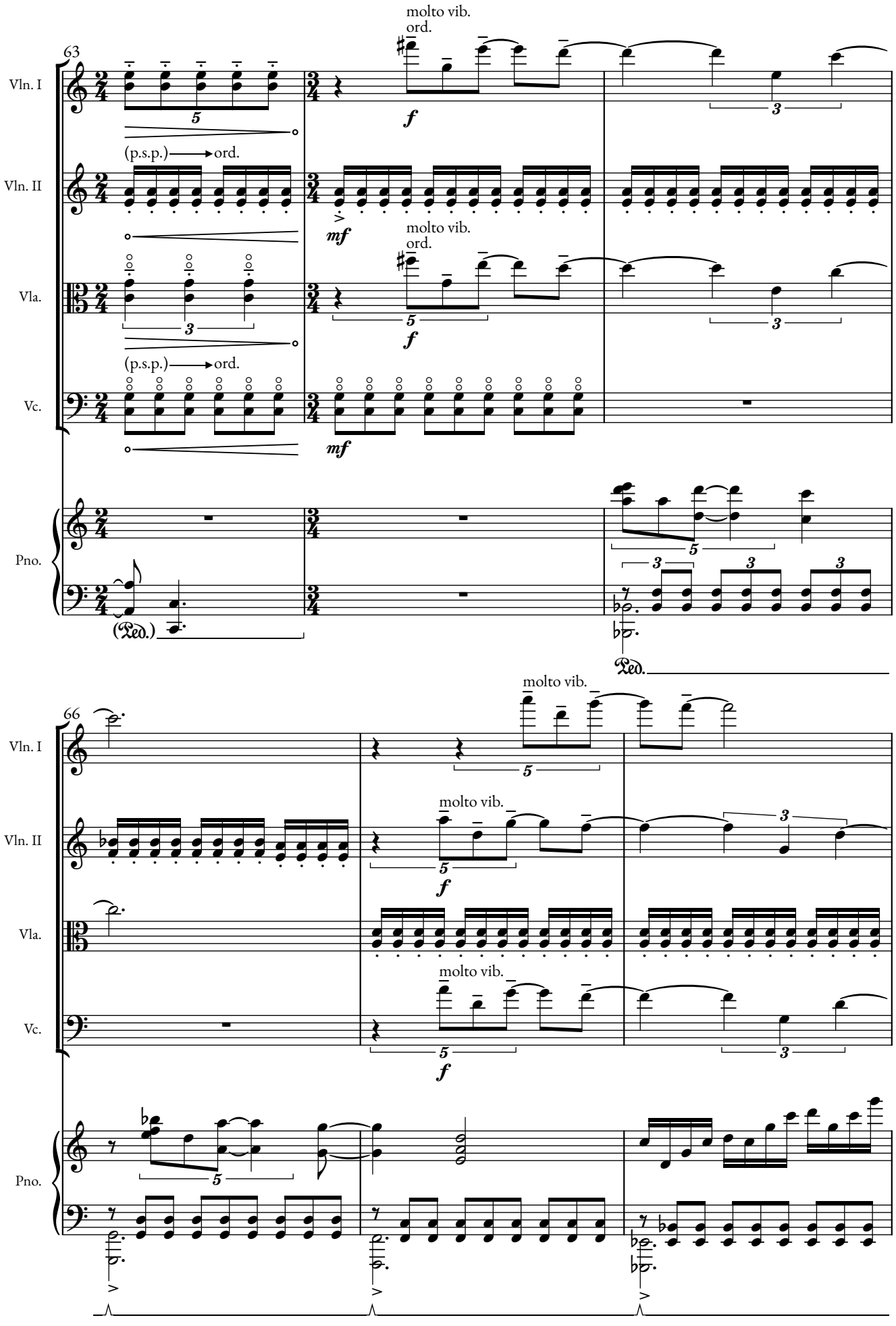

35
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p
37
mf
arco
f
Ped.

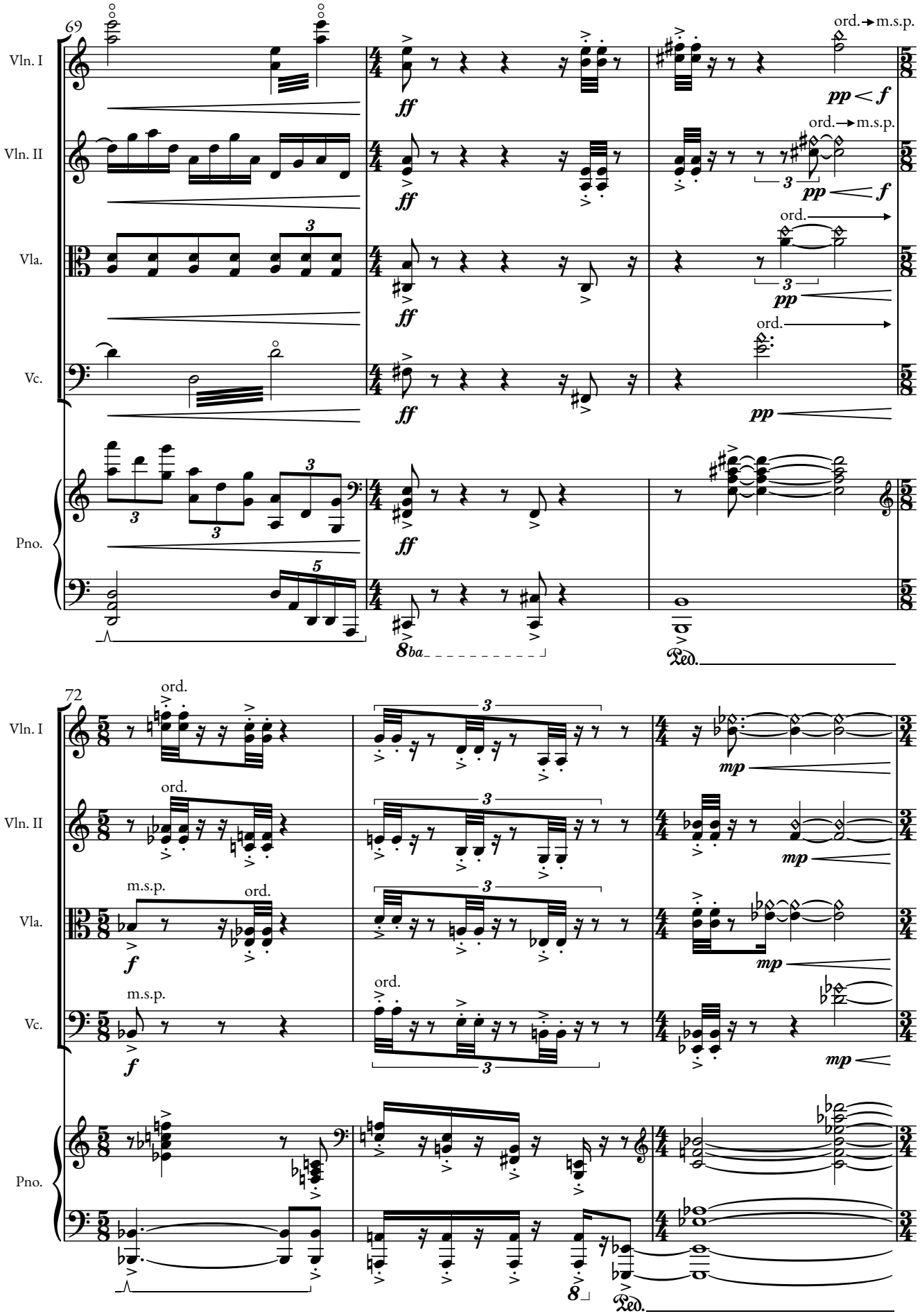

40
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.p.
ord.
43
pizz.
8ba
Ped.

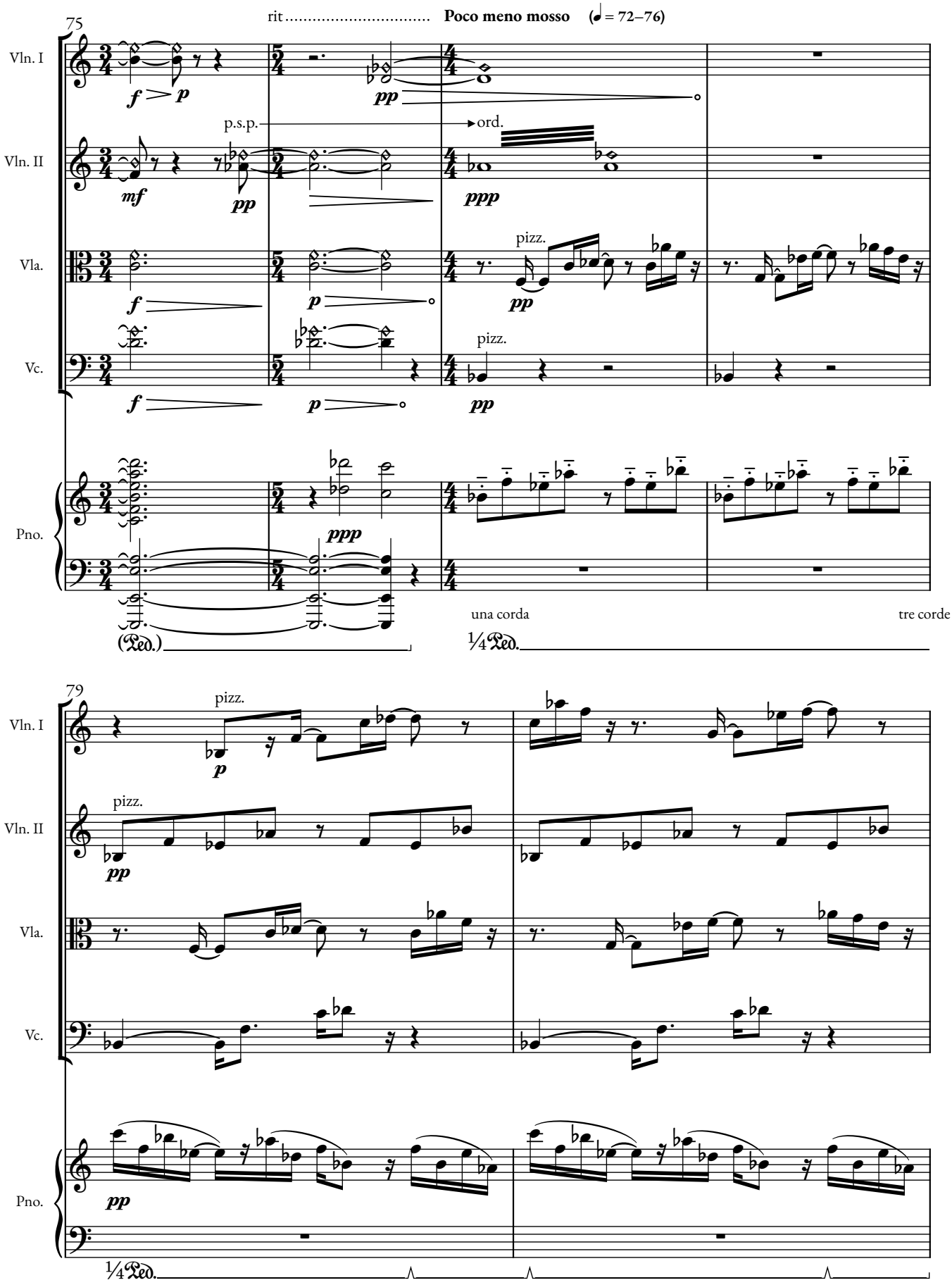

46
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.p.
ord.
arco
49
ff
p.s.t.
ord.
p
pp
3
Ped.

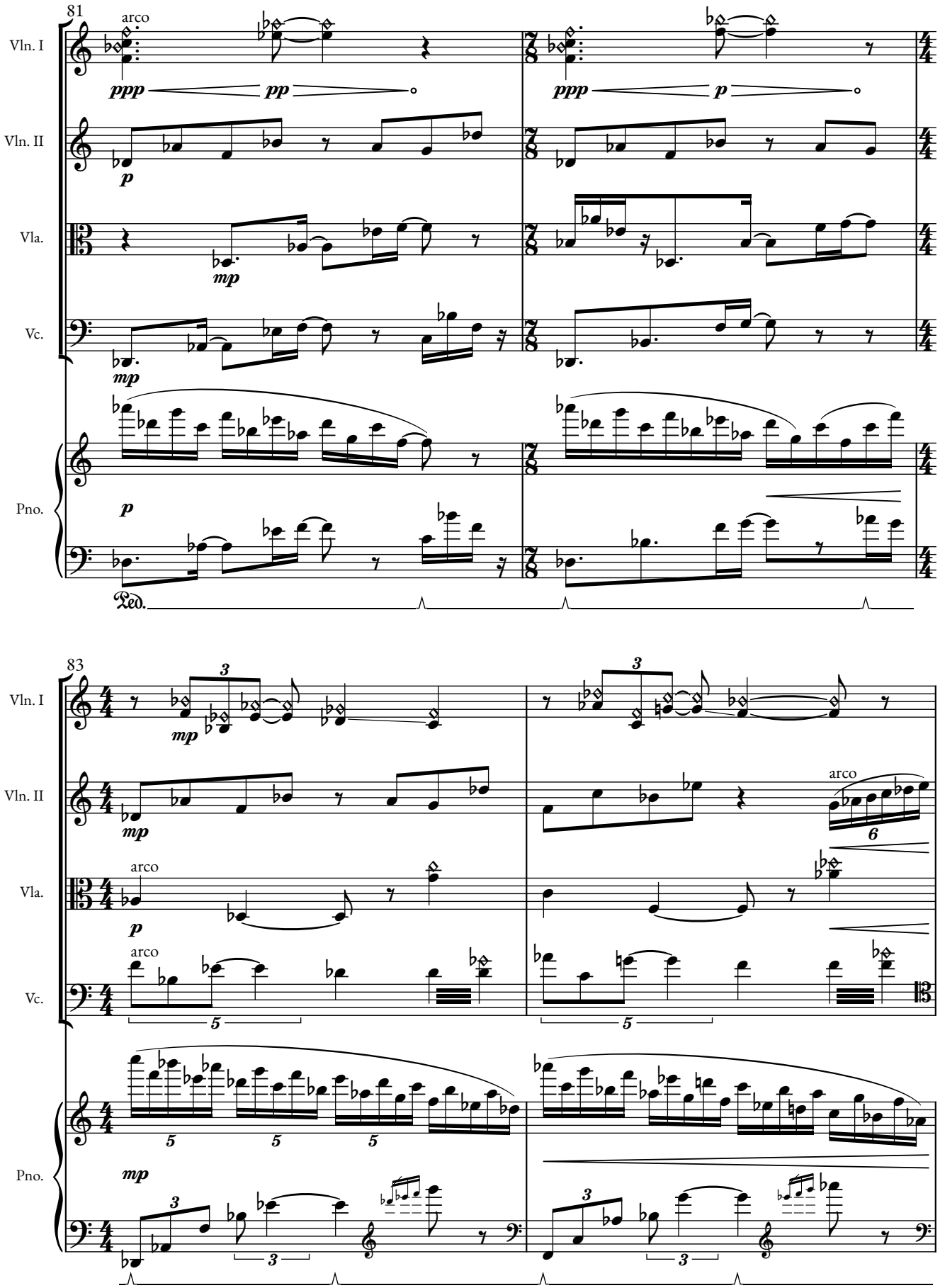

53
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
(ord.)
p.s.p.
(p.s.p.)
ord.
p.s.t.
pp
mp
p
mf
8va
(Ped.)
56
tr

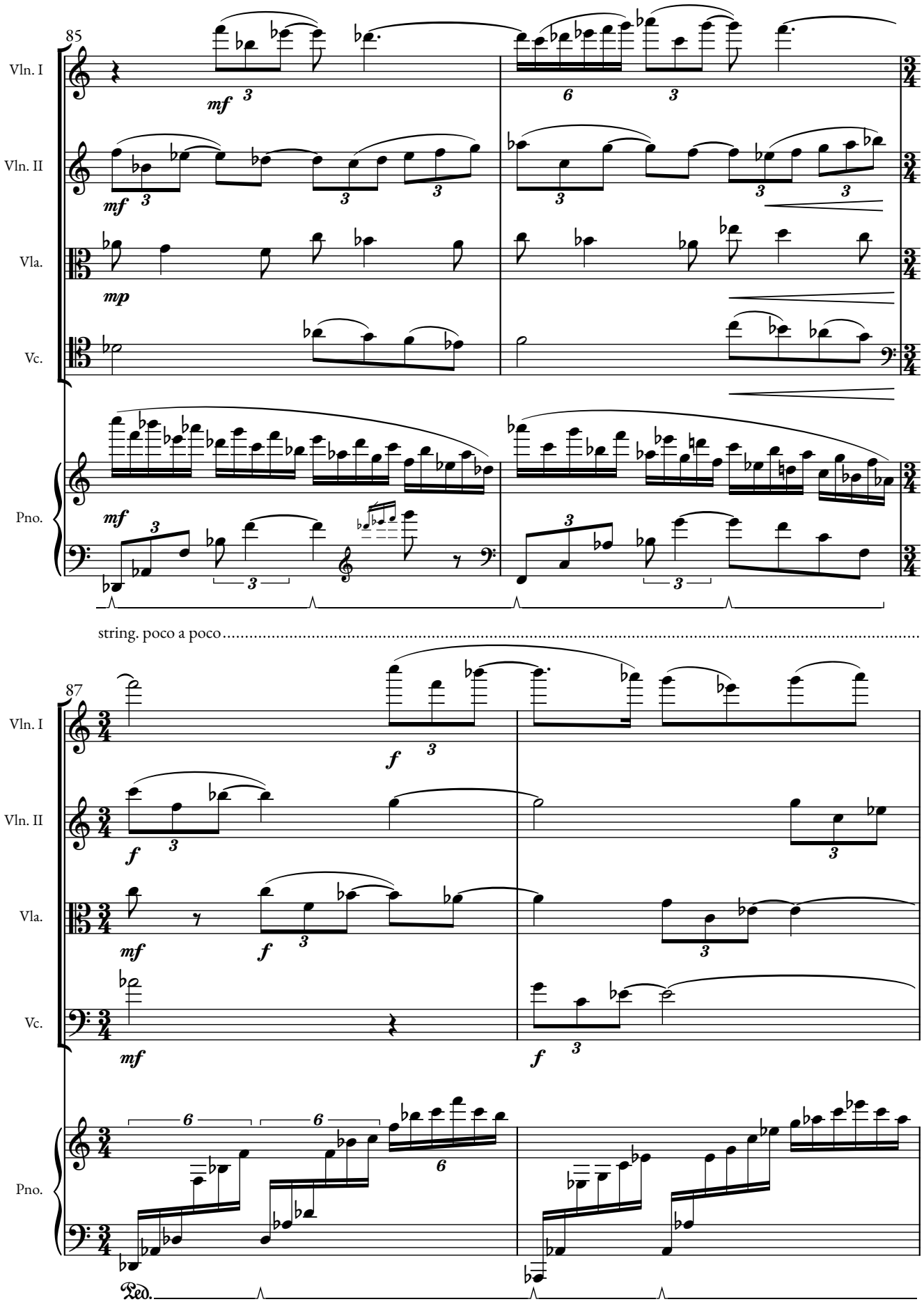

59
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
p.s.p.
mf
mp
pp
f
8ba
Ped.
61
m.s.p.
p
(Ped.)

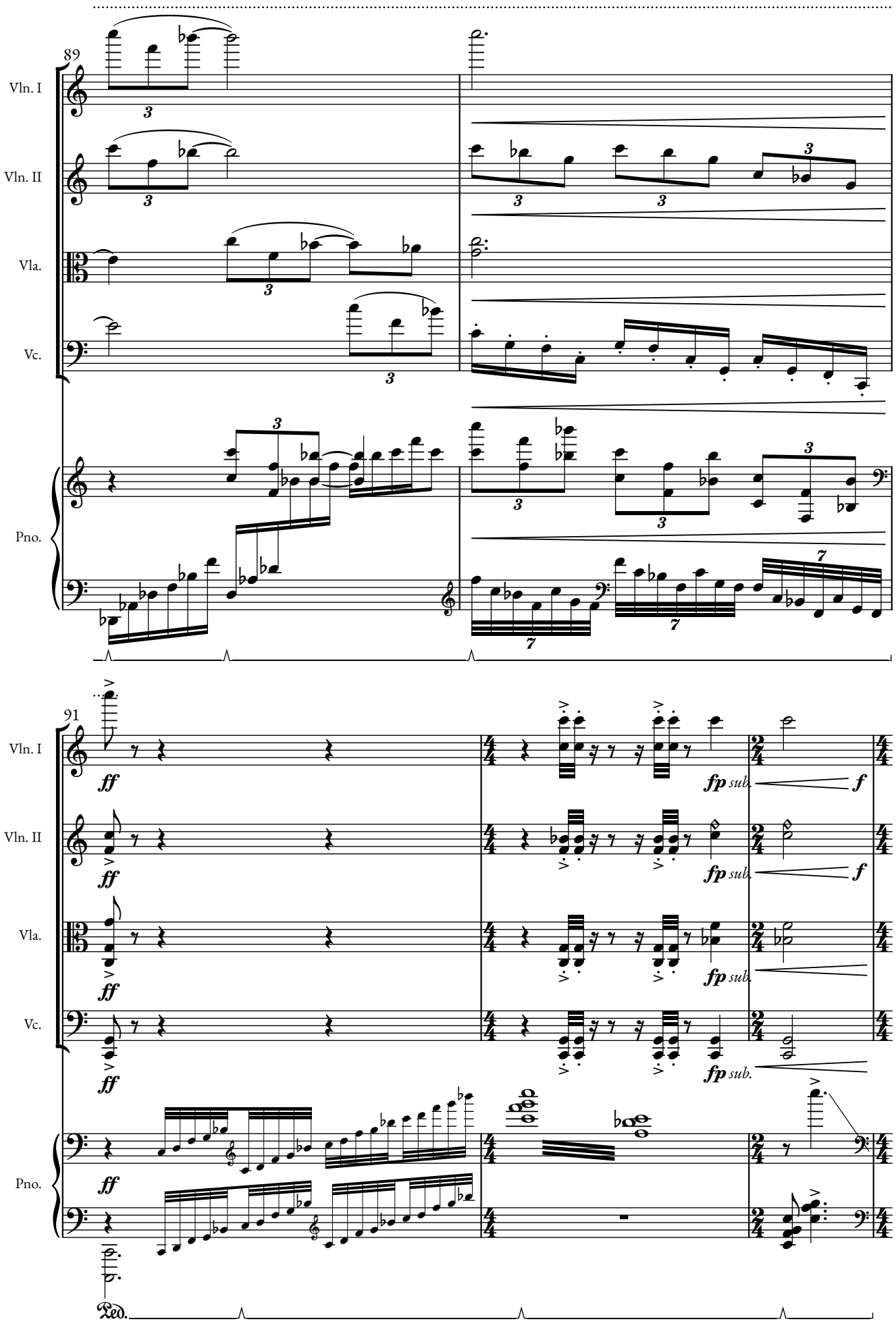

63
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
molto vib.
ord.
(p.s.p.)
ord.
molto vib.
ord.
(p.s.p.)
ord.
(Ped.)
Ped.
66
molto vib.
molto vib.
molto vib.
molto vib.

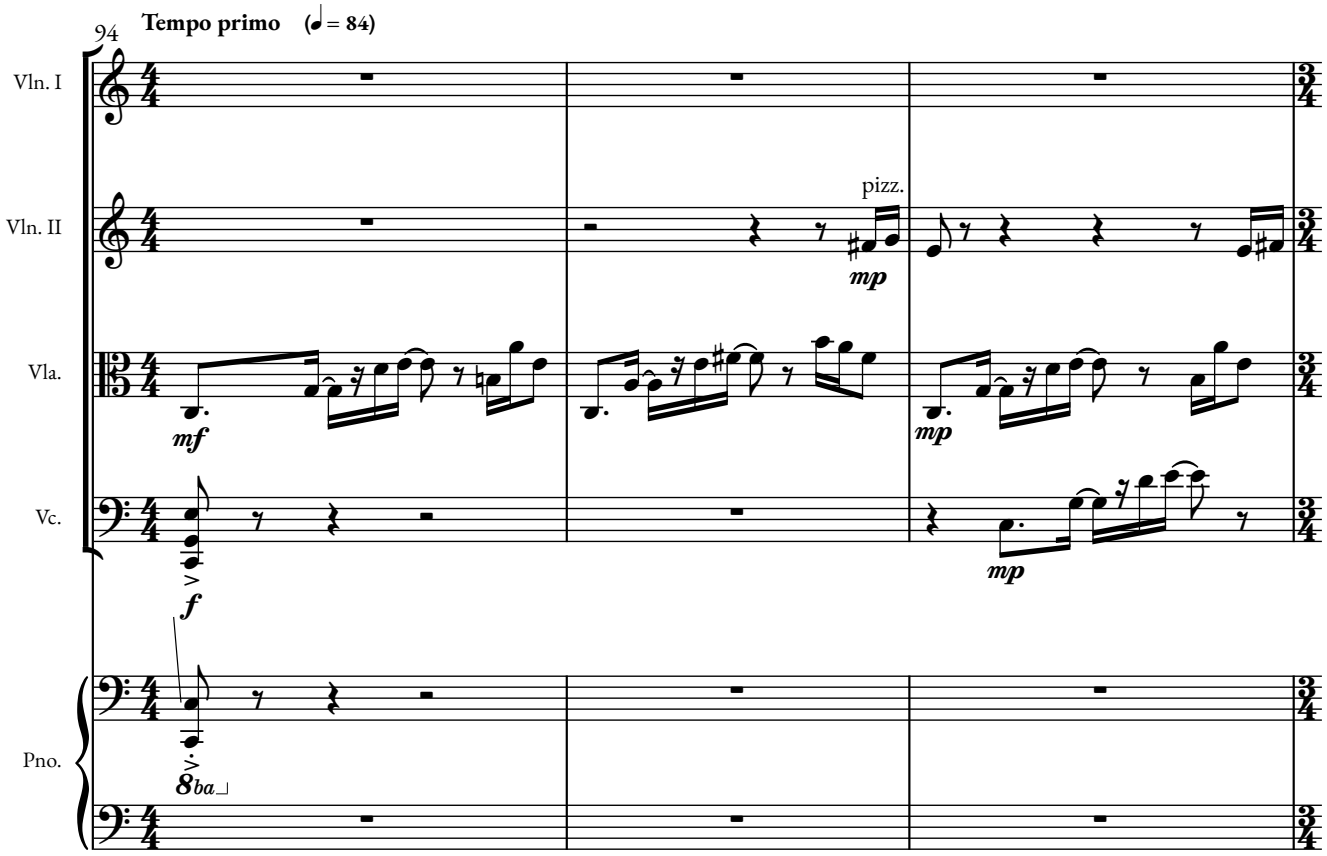

69
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.→m.s.p.
ord.→m.s.p.
ord.
ord.
ff
pp < f
pp
72
ord.
m.s.p.
mp
f

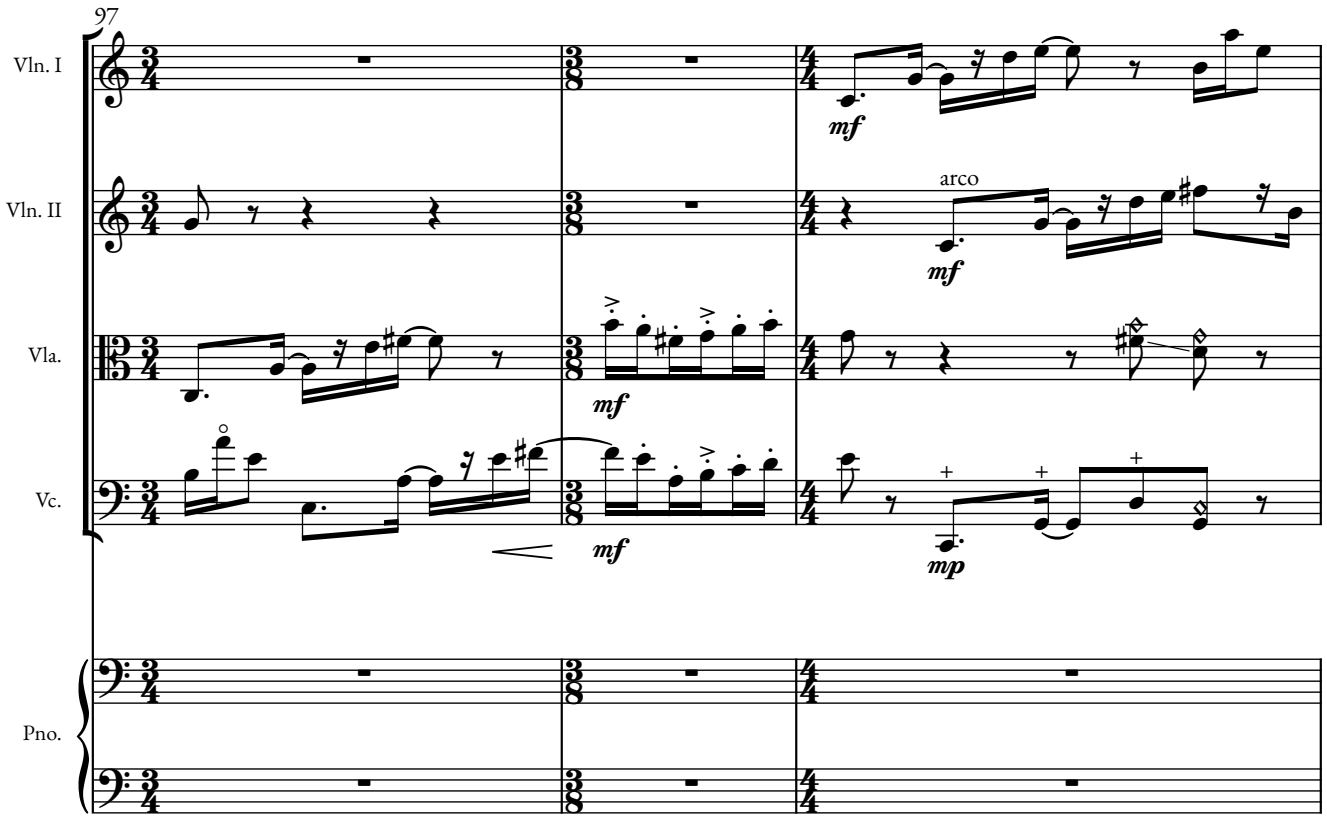

75
rit
Poco meno mosso
(♩ = 72–76)
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.p.
ord.
pizz.
una corda
tre corde
79

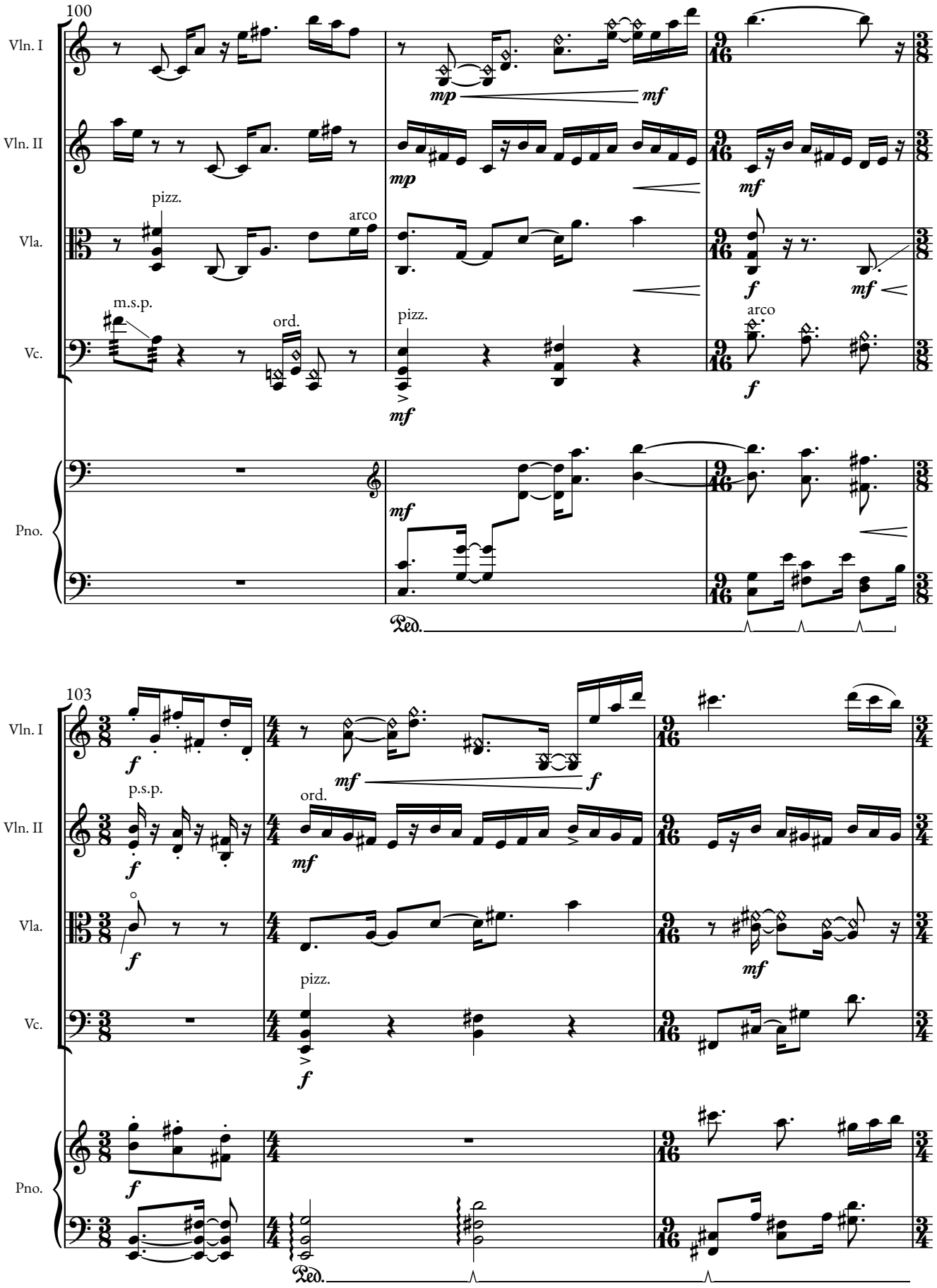

81
Vln. I
arco
ppp
pp
ppp
p
Vln. II
p
Vla.
mp
Vc.
mp
Pno.
p
Ped.
83
Vln. I
mp
Vln. II
mp
arco
Vla.
arco
p
Vc.
arco
Pno.
mp

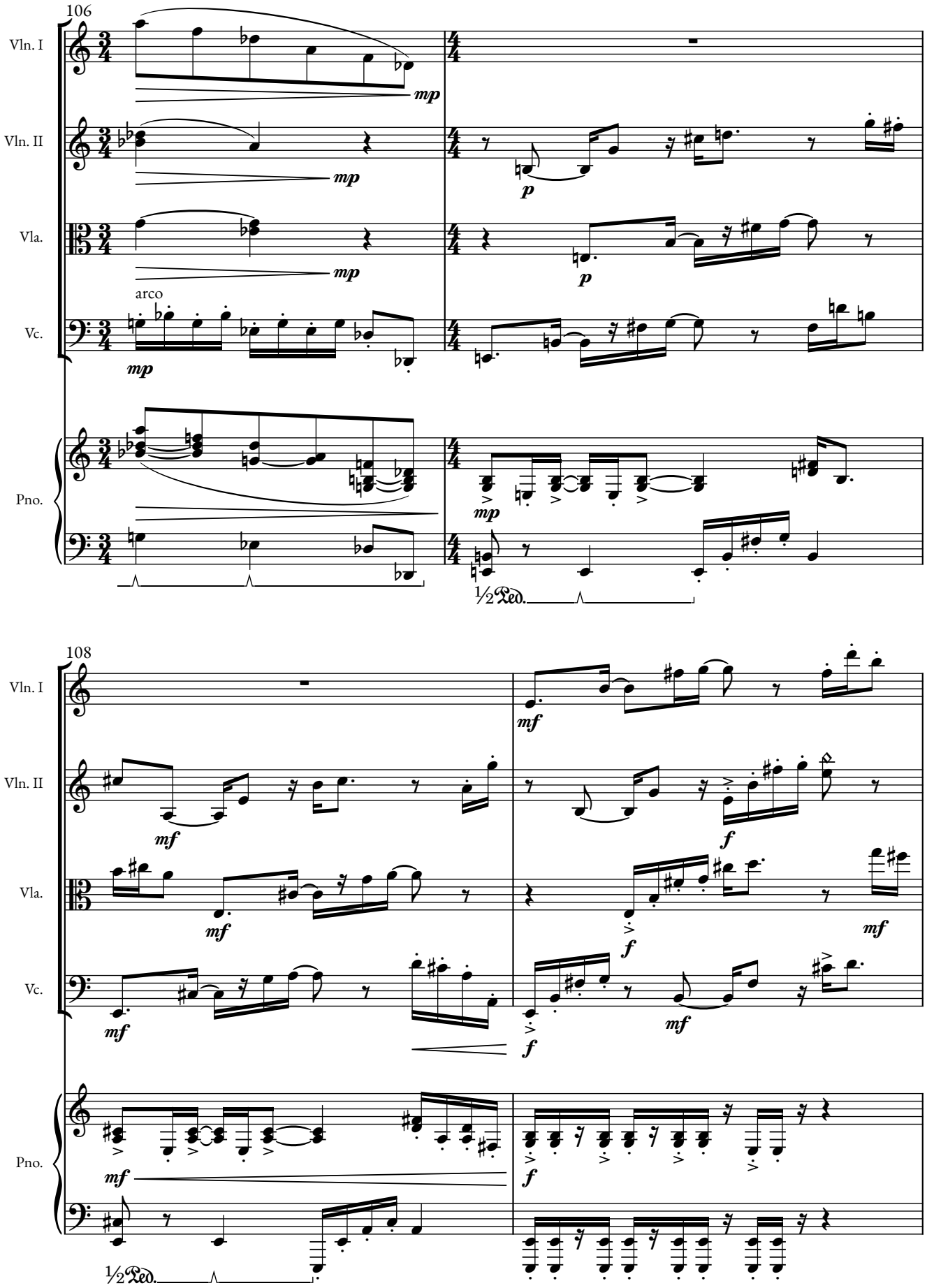

85
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mf
mp
string. poco a poco
87
f
Ped.

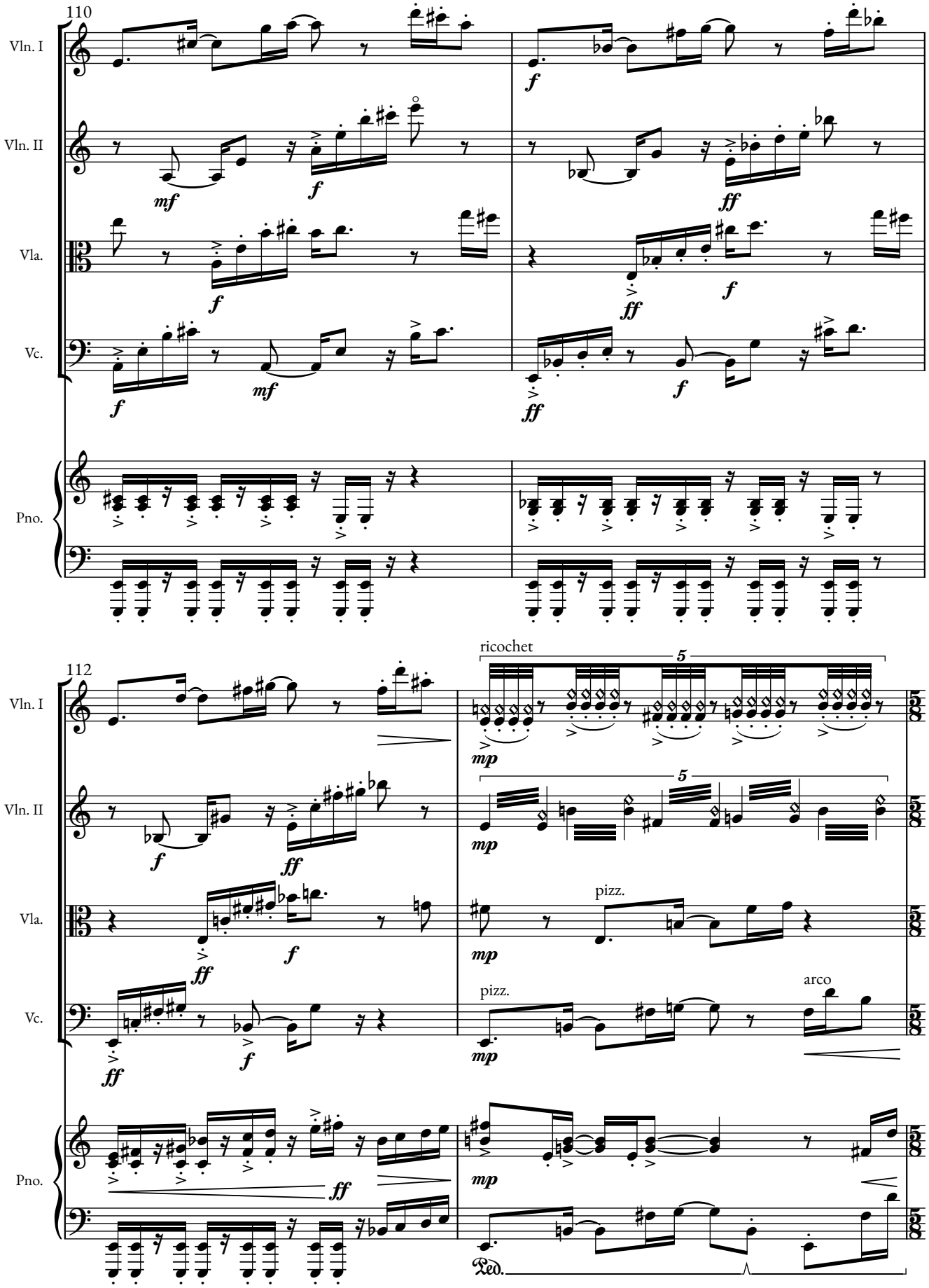

89
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
91
ff
fp sub.
f
Ped.

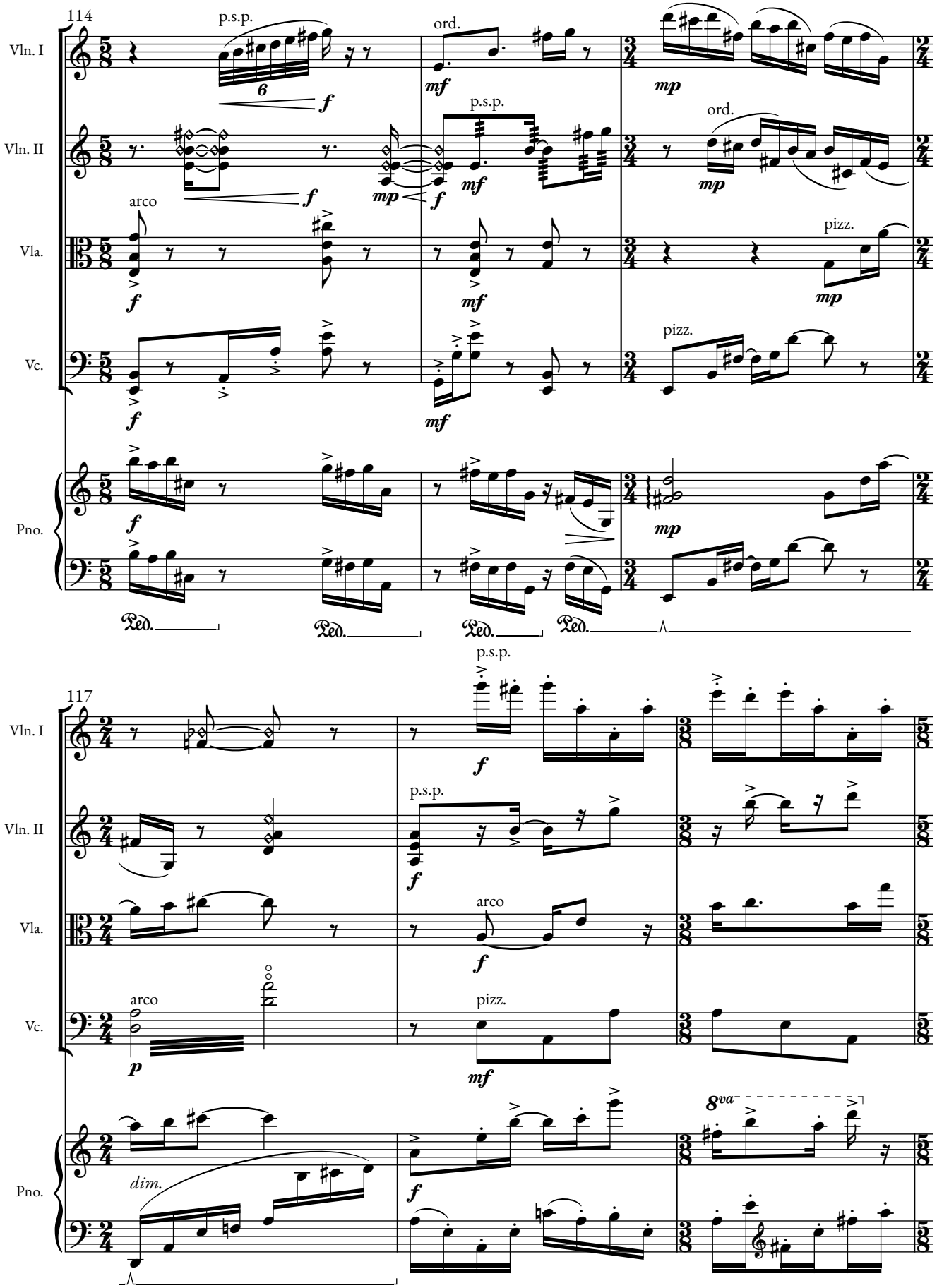

94
Tempo primo (♩ = 84)
Vln. I
Vln. II
pizz.
mp
Vla.
mf
mp
Vc.
mp
f
Pno.
8ba

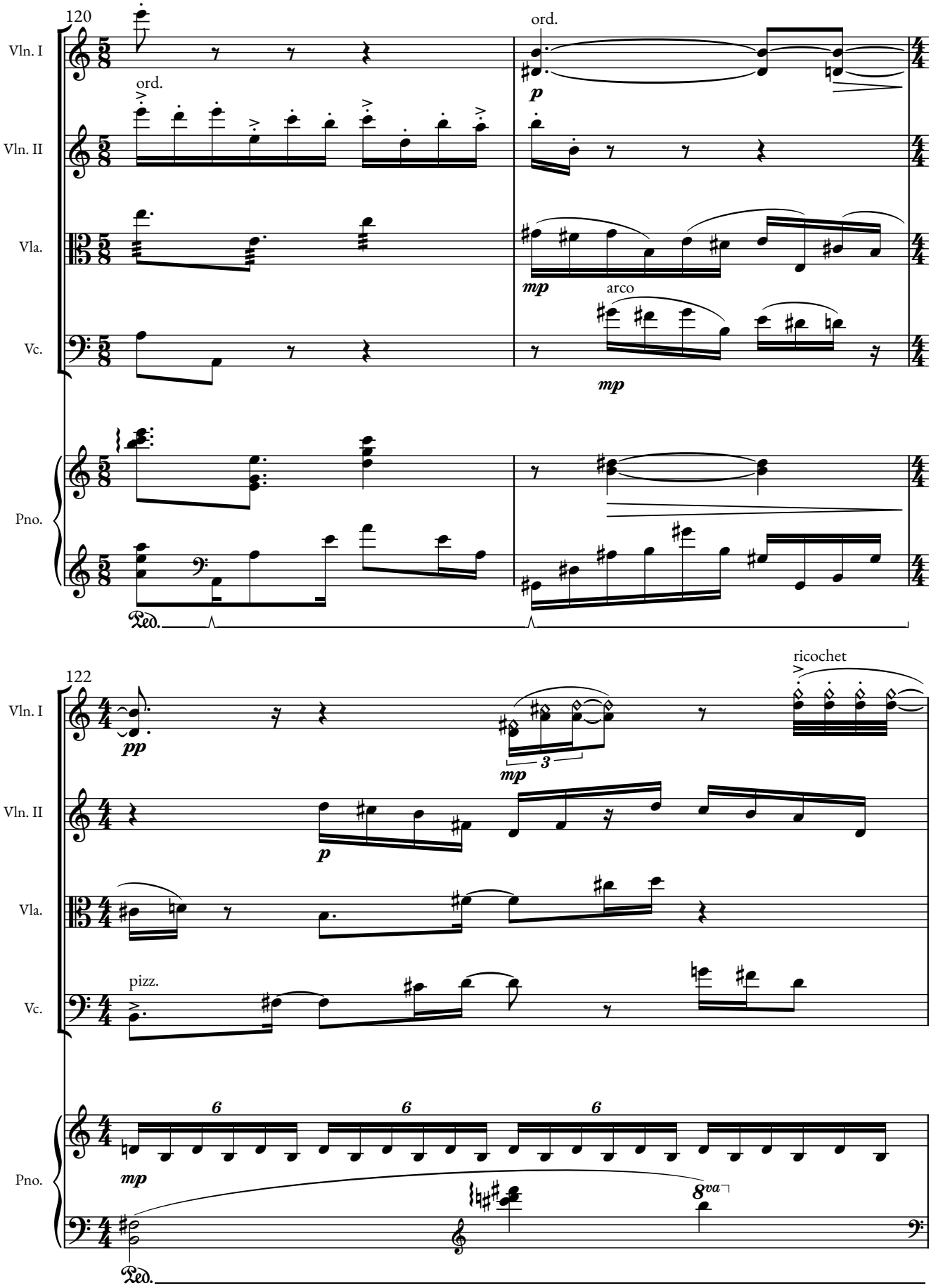

97
Vln. I
mf
Vln. II
arco
mf
Vla.
mf
Vc.
mf
mp
Pno.

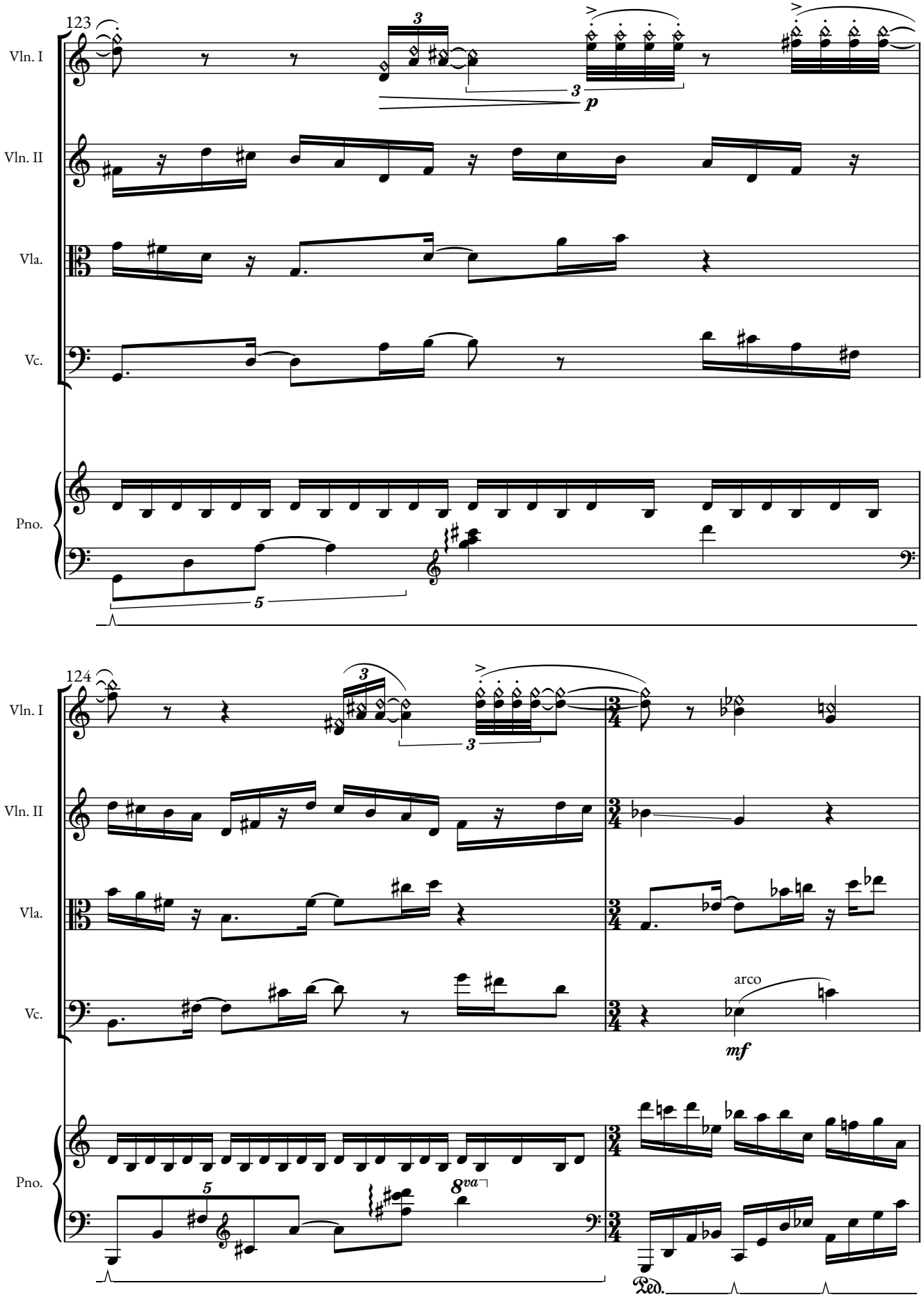

100
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
pizz.
arco
m.s.p.
ord.
pizz.
arco
103
p.s.p.
ord.
pizz.

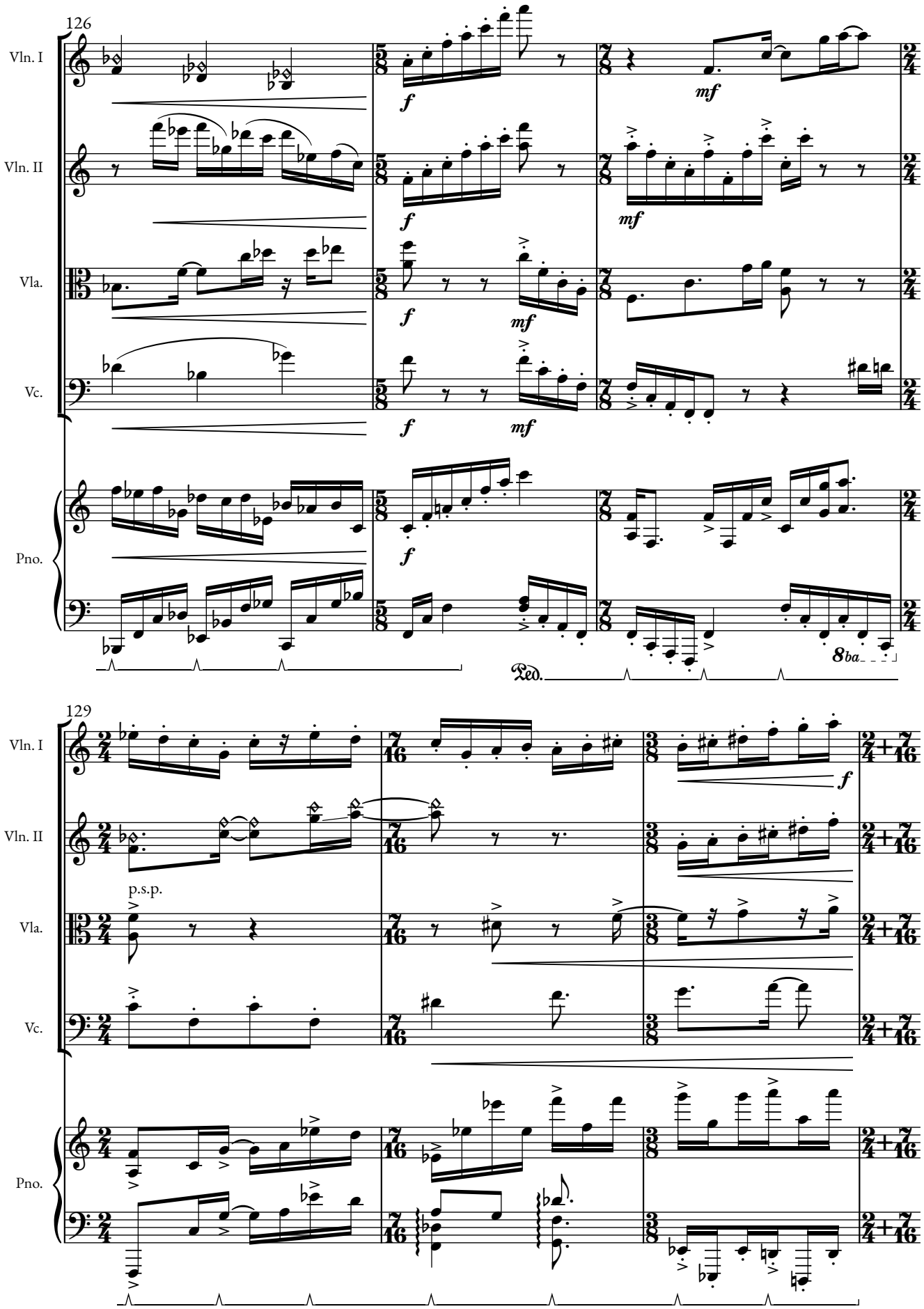

106
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
mp
p
arco
108
mf
f

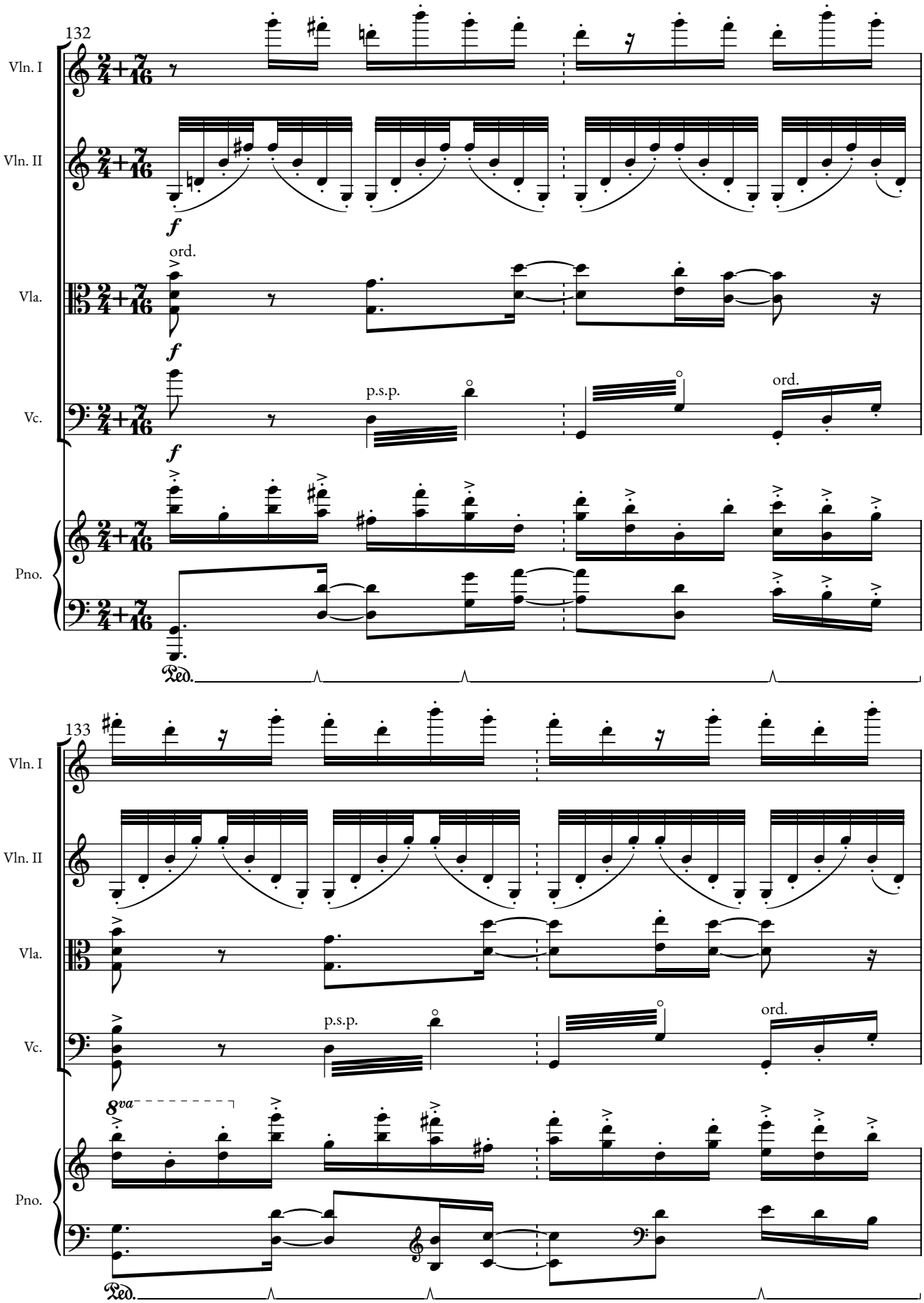

110
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
112
ricochet
5
pizz.
arco

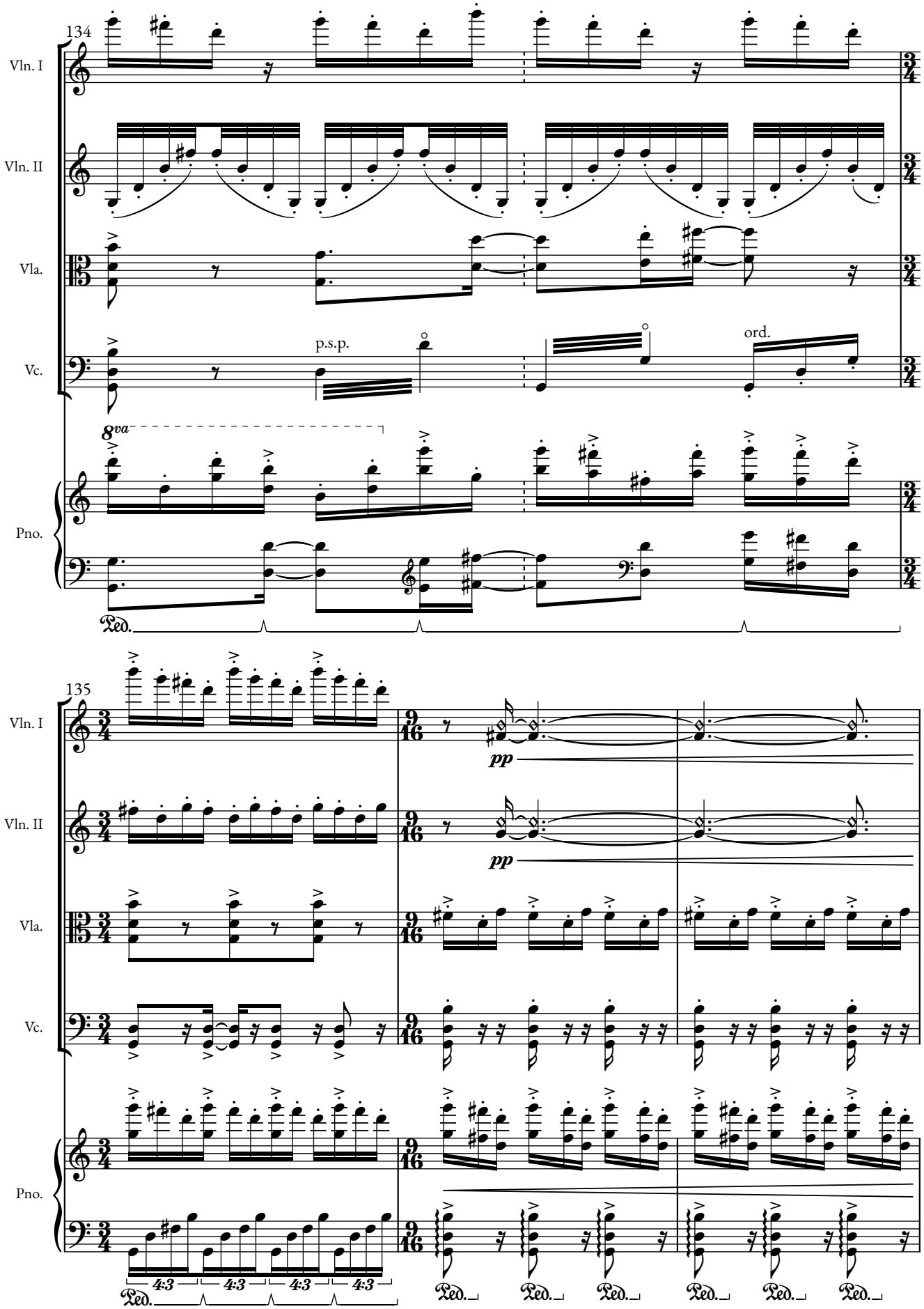

114
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.p.
ord.
arco
pizz.
117
dim.
8va

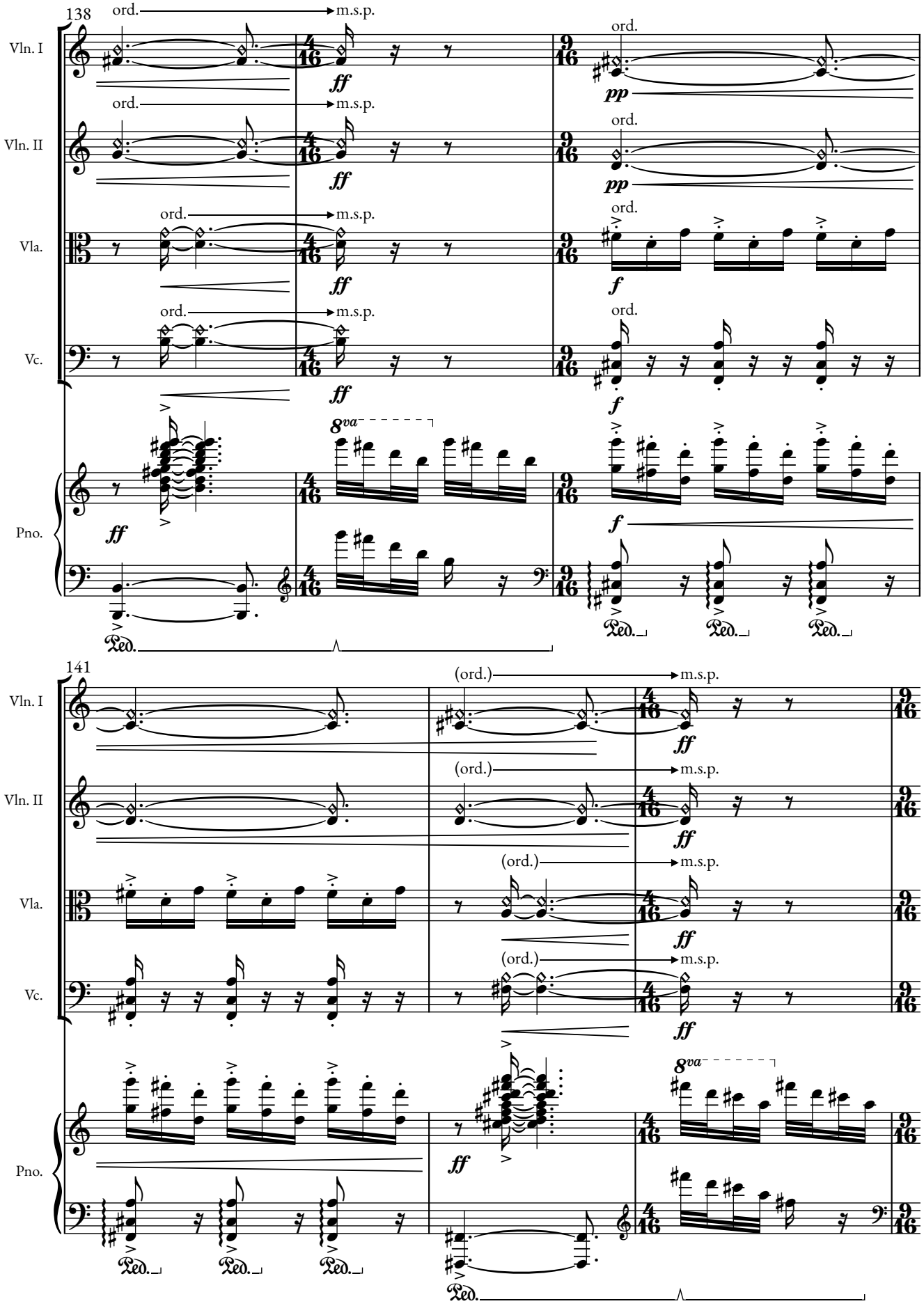

120
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
ord.
p
mp
arco
mp
Ped.
122
ricochet
pp
mp
3
p
pizz.
6
6
6
mp
8va
Ped.

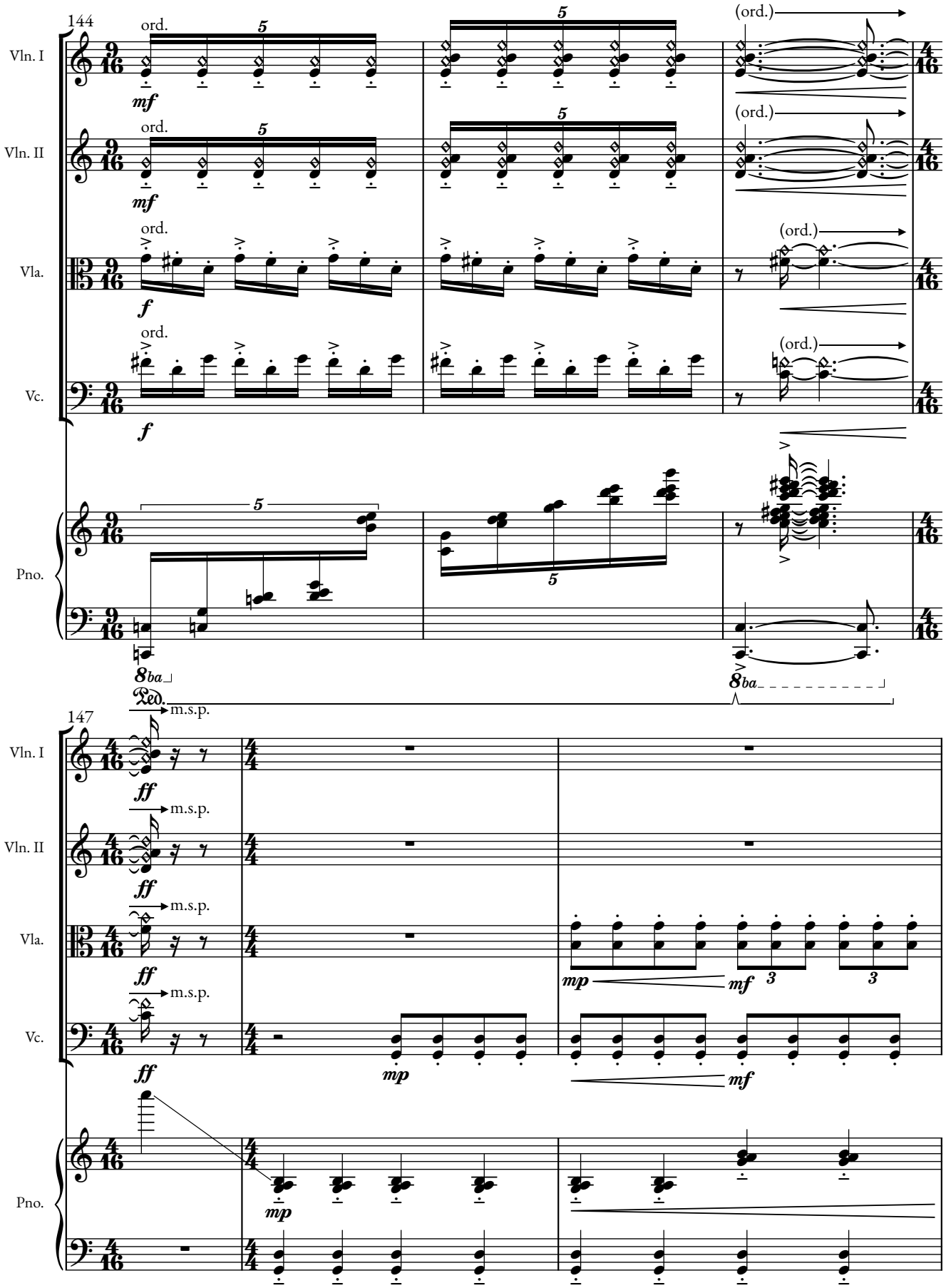

123
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p
124
arco
mf
8va
Ped.

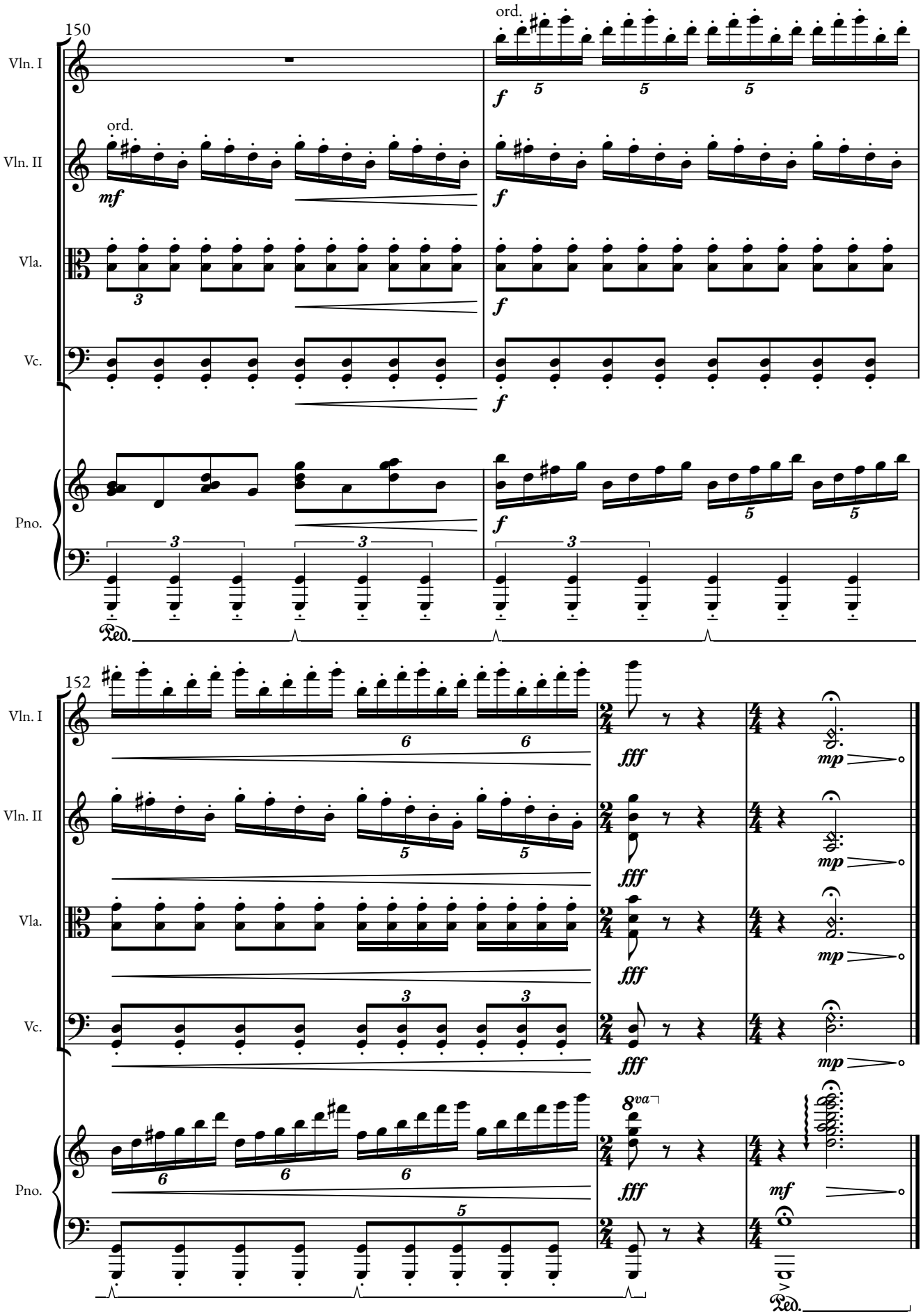

126
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
f
mf
Ped.
8ba
129
p.s.p.


132
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
f
ord.
p.s.p.
133
8va


134
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
p.s.p.
ord.
8va
Ped.
135
pp
4:3
4:3
4:3
4:3


138
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
m.s.p.
ff
pp
f
8va
141
(ord.)


144
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
(ord.)
mf
f
5
8ba
Ped.
m.s.p.
147
ff
mp
mf
3


150
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
Pno.
ord.
ord.
mf
f
152
fff
mp
mf
8va